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Supplementary information

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A randomized controlled trial on the effect of administrative burden and information costs on social inequalities in early childcare access in France

In the format provided by the authors and unedited

Table of Contents

1 Part 1: Early childcare supply in France and in our study in the areas

Note: All tables and maps are based on national open-access registries from the Caisse Nationale des Allocations Familiales at this link (https://data.caf.fr/explore/dataset/txcouv_pe_com/table/?disjunctive.annee). All calucations and data transformations were done by the first author of this paper.

The average coverage rate in our sample is 55.3 slots for 100 children aged 0-3 years. The average coverage rate in each province, excluding cities not included in our sample, is shown in Table 1.1. The coverage rate is the number of available slots for 100 children aged 0-3 years in a given area. The highest coverage rate is found in Paris, with 71.6 slots in 2021, and the lowest in Seine-Saint-Denis, with 38.5 slots. The average coverage rate in France in 2021 is 59.1 slots per 100 children aged 0-3 years. Each province's coverage rate is higher for daycare than for private childminders, with varying proportions.

Table 1.1: Average Coverage Rates per province in our sample, based on 2021 data

Province	**National Average Coverage (2021)**	**Average Coverage of the Sample (2021)**	**Average Coverage in daycare in the sample**	**Average Coverage in childminders in the sample**
Paris	59.1	80.1	59.1	4.1
Val-de-Marne	59.1	52.6	31.8	15.3
Seine-Saint-Denis	59.1	35.0	20.0	11.4

This data can be compared to the average coverage rate in all provinces in 2021 (i.e., including cities where none of the households in our sample reside but are located in the same province), as shown in Table 1.2. The results are about the same. The highest coverage rate is found in Paris, with 80.1 slots, and the lowest in Seine-Saint-Denis, with 34.5 slots.

Table 1.2: Average Coverage in Provinces (2021)

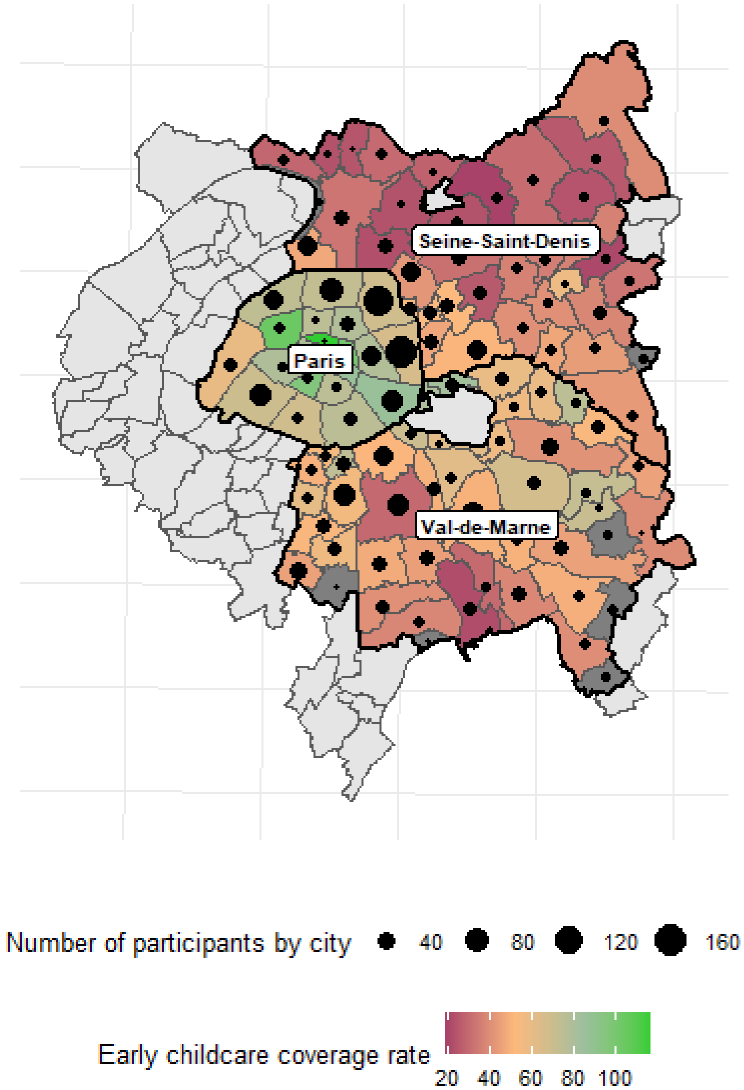
Province	Average Coverage of the Province (2021)	Average Coverage in daycare of the province	Average Coverage in childminders of the province
Paris	80.1	59.1	4.1
Val-de-Marne	52.6	31.8	15.3
Seine-Saint-Denis	34.6	19.9	11.3

The average coverage rate in our sample is 55.3 slots for 100 children aged 0-3 years, which is slightly lower than the national rate, displayed in Table 1.3. The national coverage rates in daycare and private childminders can also be found in Table 1.3. Our provinces have a higher coverage rate in daycare than the national average but a lower coverage rate in private childminders. Unlike in the provinces included in our sample, the most available early childcare option in France is private childminders, with 27.3 slots per 100 children aged 0-3 years in 2021, compared to 26 slots in daycare.

Table 1.3: French national average Coverage rates (2021)

Average coverage in France	Average coverage daycare in France	Average coverage private childminders in France
59.1	26	27.3

Map 1 shows the distribution of the sample across our study area.



Map 1: Distribution of the sample across the Paris metropolitan area. The map was built by the first author, based on open-access data from the Cnaf

2 Part 2: Descriptive statistics

For all analyses on the baseline sample, N = 1849. For all analyses using endline measurements, N = 1453. All tests are two-sided. All analyses are our own.

2.1 Descriptive tables of the main variables

2.1.0.1 Distribution of the variables

Table 2.1: Descriptive Statistics

Variable	**n = 1849**[1]
The mother is high-SES (Post-secondary education)	1,120 (60.6%)
Single-parent family	159 (8.6%)
Age of the mother	
Mean (SD)	32.3 (5.6)
Range	17.0, 52.0
The household is primiparous	784 (42.5%)
Unknown	3
Number of children in the household	
Mean (SD)	1.0 (1.2)
Range	0.0, 11.0
Unknown	3
The mother has a migration background	865 (46.8%)
The household earns less than €2,500 per month	606 (35.9%)
Unknown	159
The mother is present biased	861 (46.6%)
Mother s knowledge about early childcare	227 (12.3%)
The mother is active at the baseline	1,291 (69.8%)
The mother wants to work after the maternity leave	1,641 (88.8%)
The household already accessed early childcare in the past	745 (40.3%)
The mother wants to use early childcare	1,491 (80.6%)
The household has access to a computer	1,564 (84.6%)
The mother believes in early childcare benefits	1,042 (56.4%)
The mother trusts early childcare	1,502 (81.2%)
The majority of friends and relatives use early childcare	
No	1,849 (100.0%)
The mother perceives social approval for using early childcare	778 (42.1%)
The mother lives in Paris	692 (37.4%)
Early childcare coverage in the area of residence	750 (40.6%)
Gender of the child	
Boy	723 (48.3%)
Girl	774 (51.7%)
Unknown	352

Variable	**n = 1849**[1]
Applied to any early childcare facility at endline	1,104 (76.0%)
Unknown	396
Applied to any daycare center at endline	898 (48.6%)
Accessed any early childcare facility at endline	817 (56.2%)
Unknown	396
Accessed any daycare center at endline	327 (17.7%)

[1]n (%)

2.1.0.2 Distribution of all variables by SES

Table 2.2: Differences by SES across the variables used in this study

		Socio-Economic Status			
Variable	Overall[1]	Low-SES[1]	High-SES[1]	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
Single-parent family	8.6% (159)	15% (110)	4.4% (49)	11%	<0.001***
Age of the mother	32.3 (5.6)	30.8 (6.2)	33.2 (5.0)	-2.4	<0.001***
The household is primiparous	42% (784)	35% (255)	47% (529)	-12%	<0.001***
Number of children in the household	1.0 (1.2)	1.3 (1.3)	0.8 (1.0)	0.50	<0.001***
The mother has a migration background	47% (865)	60% (434)	38% (431)	21%	<0.001***
The household earns less than €2,500 per month	36% (606)	62% (381)	21% (225)	41%	<0.001***
The mother is present biased	47% (861)	60% (434)	38% (427)	21%	<0.001***
Mother s knowledge about early childcare	12% (227)	22% (162)	5.8% (65)	16%	<0.001***
The mother is active at the baseline	70% (1,291)	54% (396)	80% (895)	-26%	<0.001***

		Socio-Economic Status			
Variable	Overall[1]	Low-SES[1]	High-SES[1]	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
The mother wants to work after the maternity leave	89% (1,641)	82% (597)	93% (1,044)	-11%	<0.001***
The household has already used early childcare	40% (745)	39% (283)	41% (462)	-2.4%	0.6
The mother wants to use early childcare	81% (1,491)	71% (520)	87% (971)	-15%	<0.001***
The household has access to a computer	85% (1,564)	68% (496)	95% (1,068)	-27%	<0.001***
The mother lives in Paris	37% (692)	36% (262)	38% (430)	-2.5%	0.6
Early childcare coverage in the area of residence	41% (750)	36% (260)	44% (490)	-8.1%	0.003***
Gender of the child				0.08	
Boy	48% (723)	46% (265)	50% (458)		
Girl	52% (774)	54% (314)	50% (460)		
Applied to any early childcare facility at endline	76% (1,104)	63% (345)	84% (759)	-20%	<0.001***
Applied to any daycare center at endline	49% (898)	39% (281)	55% (617)	-17%	<0.001***
Accessed any early childcare facility at endline	56% (817)	37% (201)	68% (616)	-31%	<0.001***

		Socio-Economic Status			
Variable	Overall[1]	Low-SES[1]	High-SES[1]	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
Accessed any daycare center at endline	18% (327)	13% (96)	21% (231)	-7.5%	<0.001***

[1]% (n); Mean (SD)

[2]3-sample test for equality of proportions without continuity correction; Welch Two Sample t-test; Standardized Mean Difference

[3]*p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01

Sources: Baseline database. Proportions and number of observations in parentheses for categorical and dichotomous variables and Pearson's Chi-squared test.
We report averages and standard deviations in parentheses for continuous variables and use a Kruskal-Wallis rank sum test.

2.1.0.3 Distribution of all variables by migration background

Table 2.3: Differences by migration background across the variables used in this study

		Migration Background			
Variable	Overall[1]	Born abroad[1]	Born in France[1]	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
High-SES	61% (1,120)	70% (689)	50% (431)	20%	<0.001***
Single-parent family	8.6% (159)	5.8% (57)	12% (102)	-6.0%	<0.001***
Age of the mother	32.3 (5.6)	32.3 (5.5)	32.3 (5.7)	0.05	0.9
The household is primiparous	42% (784)	45% (446)	39% (338)	6.3%	0.024**
Number of children in the household	1.0 (1.2)	0.9 (1.1)	1.1 (1.2)	-0.25	<0.001***
The household earns less than €2,500 per month	36% (606)	18% (169)	57% (437)	-39%	<0.001***
The mother is present biased	47% (861)	31% (308)	64% (553)	-33%	<0.001***

	Migration Background			
Variable	Overall[1]	Born abroad[1]	Born in France[1]	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
Mother s knowledge about early childcare	12% (227)	3.7% (36)	22% (191)	-18%	<0.001***
The mother is active at the baseline	70% (1,291)	83% (814)	55% (477)	28%	<0.001***
The mother wants to work after the maternity leave	89% (1,641)	91% (892)	87% (749)	4.1%	0.022**
The household has already used early childcare	40% (745)	43% (424)	37% (321)	6.0%	0.033**
The mother wants to use early childcare	81% (1,491)	84% (825)	77% (666)	6.8%	<0.001***
The household has access to a computer	85% (1,564)	96% (948)	71% (616)	25%	<0.001***
The mother lives in Paris	37% (692)	36% (356)	39% (336)	-2.7%	0.5
Early childcare coverage in the area of residence	41% (750)	44% (432)	37% (318)	7.1%	0.008***
Gender of the child				0.03	
Boy	48% (723)	48% (392)	49% (331)		
Girl	52% (774)	52% (432)	51% (342)		
Applied to any early childcare facility at endline	76% (1,104)	81% (667)	69% (437)	11%	<0.001***

		Migration Background			
Variable	Overall[1]	Born abroad[1]	Born in France[1]	**Difference[2]**	**p-value[3]**
Applied to any daycare center at endline	49% (898)	53% (523)	43% (375)	9.8%	<0.001***
Accessed any early childcare facility at endline	56% (817)	67% (549)	43% (268)	24%	<0.001***
Accessed any daycare center at endline	18% (327)	21% (204)	14% (123)	6.5%	0.001***

[1]% (n); Mean (SD)

[2]3-sample test for equality of proportions without continuity correction; Welch Two Sample t-test; Standardized Mean Difference

[3]*p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01

Sources: Baseline database. Proportions and number of observations in parentheses for categorical and dichotomous variables and Pearson's Chi-squared test.
We report averages and standard deviations in parentheses for continuous variables and use a Kruskal-Wallis rank sum test.

2.1.0.4 Distribution of all variables by baseline knowledge

Table 2.4: Differences by level of baseline knowledge across the variables used in this study

		Initial Level of Knowledge			
Variable	Overall[1]	High knowledge[1]	Low knowledge[1]	**Difference[2]**	**p-value[3]**
High-SES	61% (1,120)	65% (1,055)	29% (65)	36%	<0.001***
Single-parent family	8.6% (159)	7.4% (120)	17% (39)	-9.8%	<0.001***
Age of the mother	32.3 (5.6)	32.5 (5.4)	30.8 (6.8)	1.7	<0.001***
The household is primiparous	42% (784)	40% (655)	57% (129)	-16%	<0.001***

	Initial Level of Knowledge				
Variable	Overall[1]	High knowledge[1]	Low knowledge[1]	**Difference[2]**	**p-value[3]**
Number of children in the household	1.0 (1.2)	1.0 (1.1)	0.8 (1.3)	0.17	0.051*
The mother has a migration background	47% (865)	42% (674)	84% (191)	-43%	<0.001***
The household earns less than €2,500 per month	36% (606)	31% (465)	75% (141)	-44%	<0.001***
The mother is present biased	47% (861)	44% (718)	63% (143)	-19%	<0.001***
The mother is active at the baseline	70% (1,291)	74% (1,203)	39% (88)	35%	<0.001***
The mother wants to work after the maternity leave	89% (1,641)	90% (1,453)	83% (188)	6.8%	0.010**
The household has already used early childcare	40% (745)	45% (724)	9.3% (21)	35%	<0.001***
The mother wants to use early childcare	81% (1,491)	84% (1,361)	57% (130)	27%	<0.001***
The household has access to a computer	85% (1,564)	89% (1,441)	54% (123)	35%	<0.001***
The mother lives in Paris	37% (692)	38% (609)	37% (83)	0.98%	>0.9
Early childcare coverage in the area of residence	41% (750)	41% (662)	39% (88)	2.0%	0.8
Gender of the child				0.02	

	Initial Level of Knowledge				
Variable	Overall[1]	High knowledge[1]	Low knowledge[1]	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
Boy	48% (723)	48% (635)	49% (88)		
Girl	52% (774)	52% (683)	51% (91)		
Applied to any early childcare facility at endline	76% (1,104)	79% (1,025)	52% (79)	27%	<0.001***
Applied to any daycare center at endline	49% (898)	51% (824)	33% (74)	18%	<0.001***
Accessed any early childcare facility at endline	56% (817)	60% (781)	24% (36)	37%	<0.001***
Accessed any daycare center at endline	18% (327)	19% (306)	9.3% (21)	9.6%	0.002***

[1]% (n); Mean (SD)

[2]3-sample test for equality of proportions without continuity correction; Welch Two Sample t-test; Standardized Mean Difference

[3]*p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01

Sources: Baseline database. Proportions and number of observations in parentheses for categorical and dichotomous variables and Pearson's Chi-squared test.
We report averages and standard deviations in parentheses for continuous variables and use a Kruskal-Wallis rank sum test.

2.1.0.5 Distribution of all variables by temporal orientation

Table 2.5: Differences by present bias across the variables used in this study

		Temporal Orientation			
Variable	Overall[1]	Not present biased[1]	Present biased[1]	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
High-SES	61% (1,120)	70% (693)	50% (427)	21%	<0.001***
Single-parent family	8.6% (159)	4.7% (46)	13% (113)	-8.5%	<0.001***
Age of the mother	32.3 (5.6)	32.6 (5.5)	31.9 (5.7)	0.71	0.006***
The household is primiparous	42% (784)	45% (449)	39% (335)	6.5%	0.019**
Number of children in the household	1.0 (1.2)	0.9 (1.1)	1.1 (1.2)	-0.22	<0.001***
The mother has a migration background	47% (865)	32% (312)	64% (553)	-33%	<0.001***
The household earns less than €2,500 per month	36% (606)	25% (237)	49% (369)	-24%	<0.001***
Mother s knowledge about early childcare	12% (227)	8.5% (84)	17% (143)	-8.1%	<0.001***
The mother is active at the baseline	70% (1,291)	78% (774)	60% (517)	18%	<0.001***
The mother wants to work after the maternity leave	89% (1,641)	91% (895)	87% (746)	3.9%	0.028**
The household has already used early childcare	40% (745)	40% (396)	41% (349)	-0.45%	>0.9

		Temporal Orientation			
Variable	Overall[1]	Not present biased[1]	Present biased[1]	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
The mother wants to use early childcare	81% (1,491)	84% (833)	76% (658)	7.9%	<0.001***
The household has access to a computer	85% (1,564)	93% (920)	75% (644)	18%	<0.001***
The mother lives in Paris	37% (692)	38% (376)	37% (316)	1.4%	0.8
Early childcare coverage in the area of residence	41% (750)	43% (425)	38% (325)	5.3%	0.071*
Gender of the child				0.03	
Boy	48% (723)	49% (400)	48% (323)		
Girl	52% (774)	51% (417)	53% (357)		
Applied to any early childcare facility at endline	76% (1,104)	81% (652)	70% (452)	11%	<0.001***
Applied to any daycare center at endline	49% (898)	53% (521)	44% (377)	8.9%	<0.001***
Accessed any early childcare facility at endline	56% (817)	64% (515)	47% (302)	17%	<0.001***
Accessed any daycare center at endline	18% (327)	20% (193)	16% (134)	4.0%	0.083*

[1]% (n); Mean (SD)

[2]3-sample test for equality of proportions without continuity correction; Welch Two Sample t-test; Standardized Mean Difference

[3]*p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01

		Temporal Orientation			
Variable	Overall[1]	Not present biased[1]	Present biased[1]	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]

Sources: Baseline database. Proportions and number of observations in parentheses for categorical and dichotomous variables and Pearson's Chi-squared test.
We report averages and standard deviations in parentheses for continuous variables and use a Kruskal-Wallis rank sum test.

2.1.0.6 Distribution of all variables by previous childcare usage

Table 2.6: Differences by previous childcare usage across the variables used in this study

		Previous Childcare Usage			
Variable	Overall[1]	Never used[1]	Already used[1]	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
High-SES	61% (1,120)	60% (658)	62% (462)	-2.4%	0.6
Single-parent family	8.6% (159)	9.3% (103)	7.5% (56)	1.8%	0.4
Age of the mother	32.3 (5.6)	31.2 (5.7)	33.9 (5.0)	-2.7	<0.001***
The household is primiparous	42% (784)	71% (784)	0% (0)	71%	<0.001***
Number of children in the household	1.0 (1.2)	0.5 (1.0)	1.7 (1.0)	-1.2	<0.001***
The mother has a migration background	47% (865)	49% (544)	43% (321)	6.2%	0.033**
The household earns less than €2,500 per month	36% (606)	39% (395)	31% (211)	8.8%	<0.001***
The mother is present biased	47% (861)	46% (512)	47% (349)	-0.47%	>0.9
Mother s knowledge about early childcare	12% (227)	19% (206)	2.8% (21)	16%	<0.001***

		Previous Childcare Usage			
Variable	Overall[1]	Never used[1]	Already used[1]	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
The mother is active at the baseline	70% (1,291)	67% (735)	75% (556)	-8.1%	0.001***
The mother wants to work after the maternity leave	89% (1,641)	88% (971)	90% (670)	-2.0%	0.4
The mother wants to use early childcare	81% (1,491)	74% (814)	91% (677)	-17%	<0.001***
The household has access to a computer	85% (1,564)	82% (910)	88% (654)	-5.4%	0.007***
The mother lives in Paris	37% (692)	35% (384)	41% (308)	-6.6%	0.017**
Early childcare coverage in the area of residence	41% (750)	40% (439)	42% (311)	-2.0%	0.7
Gender of the child				0.06	
Boy	48% (723)	49% (439)	47% (284)		
Girl	52% (774)	51% (449)	53% (325)		
Applied to any early childcare facility at endline	76% (1,104)	72% (613)	82% (491)	-10%	<0.001***
Applied to any daycare center at endline	49% (898)	47% (514)	52% (384)	-5.0%	0.11
Accessed any early childcare facility at endline	56% (817)	51% (432)	64% (385)	-14%	<0.001***

		Previous Childcare Usage			
Variable	Overall[1]	Never used[1]	Already used[1]	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
Accessed any daycare center at endline	18% (327)	15% (164)	22% (163)	-7.0%	<0.001***

[1]% (n); Mean (SD)

[2]3-sample test for equality of proportions without continuity correction; Welch Two Sample t-test; Standardized Mean Difference

[3]*p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01

Sources: Baseline database. Proportions and number of observations in parentheses for categorical and dichotomous variables and Pearson's Chi-squared test.
We report averages and standard deviations in parentheses for continuous variables and use a Kruskal-Wallis rank sum test.

2.1.0.7 Distribution of all variables by activity status

Table 2.7: Differences by baseline activity status across the variables used in this study

		Activity Status			
Variable	Overall[1]	Inactive[1]	Active[1]	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
High-SES	61% (1,120)	40% (225)	69% (895)	-29%	<0.001***
Single-parent family	8.6% (159)	12% (69)	7.0% (90)	5.4%	<0.001***
Age of the mother	32.3 (5.6)	30.9 (5.8)	32.9 (5.5)	-1.9	<0.001***
The household is primiparous	42% (784)	35% (193)	46% (591)	-11%	<0.001***
Number of children in the household	1.0 (1.2)	1.2 (1.2)	0.9 (1.1)	0.30	<0.001***
The mother has a migration background	47% (865)	70% (388)	37% (477)	33%	<0.001***
The household earns less than €2,500 per month	36% (606)	71% (346)	22% (260)	49%	<0.001***

		Activity Status			
Variable	Overall[1]	Inactive[1]	Active[1]	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
The mother is present biased	47% (861)	62% (344)	40% (517)	22%	<0.001***
Mother s knowledge about early childcare	12% (227)	25% (139)	6.8% (88)	18%	<0.001***
The mother wants to work after the maternity leave	89% (1,641)	79% (441)	93% (1,200)	-14%	<0.001***
The household has already used early childcare	40% (745)	34% (189)	43% (556)	-9.2%	0.001***
The mother wants to use early childcare	81% (1,491)	65% (365)	87% (1,126)	-22%	<0.001***
The household has access to a computer	85% (1,564)	69% (387)	91% (1,177)	-22%	<0.001***
The mother lives in Paris	37% (692)	35% (196)	38% (496)	-3.3%	0.4
Early childcare coverage in the area of residence	41% (750)	39% (216)	41% (534)	-2.7%	0.6
Gender of the child				0.08	
Boy	48% (723)	51% (222)	47% (501)		
Girl	52% (774)	49% (213)	53% (561)		
Applied to any early childcare facility at endline	76% (1,104)	49% (194)	86% (910)	-38%	<0.001***

Variable	Activity Status				
	Overall[1]	Inactive[1]	Active[1]	Difference[2]	p-value[3]
Applied to any daycare center at endline	49% (898)	31% (171)	56% (727)	-26%	<0.001***
Accessed any early childcare facility at endline	56% (817)	23% (91)	69% (726)	-46%	<0.001***
Accessed any daycare center at endline	18% (327)	8.6% (48)	22% (279)	-13%	<0.001***

[1]% (n); Mean (SD)

[2]3-sample test for equality of proportions without continuity correction; Welch Two Sample t-test; Standardized Mean Difference

[3]*p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01

Sources: Baseline database. Proportions and number of observations in parentheses for categorical and dichotomous variables and Pearson's Chi-squared test.
We report averages and standard deviations in parentheses for continuous variables and use a Kruskal-Wallis rank sum test.

2.1.0.8 Distribution of all variables by province

To perform the equality tests, we break down the comparison across provinces in three parts: Paris vs. other provinces, Seine-Saint-Denis vs. other provinces, and Val de Marne.

2.1.0.8.1 Paris vs. other provinces

Table 2.8: Differences by province across the variables used in this study

Variable	Province: Paris comparison				
	Overall[1]	Paris[1]	Other provinces	Difference[2]	p-value[3]
High-SES	61% (1,120)	60% (690)	62% (430)	-2.5%	0.6
Single-parent family	8.6% (159)	7.7% (89)	10% (70)	-2.4%	0.2
Age of the mother	32.3 (5.6)	31.9 (5.4)	33.0 (5.9)	-1.1	<0.001***

		Province: Paris comparison			
Variable	Overall[1]	Paris[1]	Other provinces	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
The household is primiparous	42% (784)	41% (471)	45% (313)	-4.5%	0.2
Number of children in the household	1.0 (1.2)	1.0 (1.1)	0.9 (1.2)	0.07	0.2
The mother has a migration background	47% (865)	46% (529)	49% (336)	-2.8%	0.5
The household earns less than €2,500 per month	36% (606)	37% (398)	33% (208)	3.8%	0.3
The mother is present biased	47% (861)	47% (545)	46% (316)	1.4%	0.8
Mother s knowledge about early childcare	12% (227)	12% (144)	12% (83)	0.45%	>0.9
The mother is active at the baseline	70% (1,291)	69% (795)	72% (496)	-3.0%	0.4
The mother wants to work after the maternity leave	89% (1,641)	87% (1,008)	91% (633)	-4.4%	0.016**
The household has ever used early childcare	40% (745)	38% (437)	45% (308)	-6.7%	0.017**
The mother wants to use early childcare	81% (1,491)	78% (906)	85% (585)	-6.2%	0.005***
The household has access to a computer	85% (1,564)	86% (993)	83% (571)	3.3%	0.2
Early childcare coverage in the area of residence	41% (750)	50% (578)	25% (172)	25%	<0.001***

		Province: Paris comparison			
Variable	Overall[1]	Paris[1]	Other provinces	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
Gender of the child				0.03	
Boy	48% (723)	48% (445)	49% (278)		
Girl	52% (774)	52% (488)	51% (286)		
Applied to any early childcare facility at endline	76% (1,104)	72% (655)	82% (449)	-10%	<0.001***
Applied to any daycare center at endline	49% (898)	44% (505)	57% (393)	-13%	<0.001***
Accessed any early childcare facility at endline	56% (817)	50% (455)	66% (362)	-16%	<0.001***
Accessed any daycare center at endline	18% (327)	11% (129)	29% (198)	-17%	<0.001***

[1]% (n); Mean (SD)

[2]3-sample test for equality of proportions without continuity correction; Welch Two Sample t-test; Standardized Mean Difference

[3]*p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01

Sources: Baseline database. Proportions and number of observations in parentheses for categorical and dichotomous variables and Pearson's Chi-squared test.
We report averages and standard deviations in parentheses for continuous variables and use a Kruskal-Wallis rank sum test.

2.1.0.8.2 Seine-Saint-Denis

Table 2.9: Differences by province across the variables used in this study

		Province: Seine-Saint-Denis comparison			
Variable	Overall[1]	Seine-Saint-Denis[1]	Other provinces[1]	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
High-SES	61% (1,120)	61% (849)	60% (271)	0.64%	>0.9
Single-parent family	8.6% (159)	8.2% (114)	10.0% (45)	-1.8%	0.5
Age of the mother	32.3 (5.6)	32.4 (5.7)	31.8 (5.5)	0.65	0.032**
The household is primiparous	42% (784)	43% (597)	41% (187)	1.3%	0.9
Number of children in the household	1.0 (1.2)	1.0 (1.1)	1.0 (1.2)	-0.03	0.6
The mother has a migration background	47% (865)	47% (655)	47% (210)	0.29%	>0.9
The household earns less than €2,500 per month	36% (606)	35% (447)	39% (159)	-4.3%	0.3
The mother is present biased	47% (861)	45% (634)	50% (227)	-5.0%	0.2
Mother s knowledge about early childcare	12% (227)	12% (163)	14% (64)	-2.5%	0.4
The mother is active at the baseline	70% (1,291)	71% (992)	66% (299)	4.7%	0.2
The mother wants to work after the maternity leave	89% (1,641)	90% (1,260)	84% (381)	5.6%	0.004***

		Province: Seine-Saint-Denis comparison			
Variable	Overall[1]	Seine-Saint-Denis[1]	Other provinces[1]	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
The household has ever used early childcare	40% (745)	41% (580)	37% (165)	4.9%	0.2
The mother wants to use early childcare	81% (1,491)	82% (1,145)	77% (346)	5.2%	0.053*
The household has access to a computer	85% (1,564)	85% (1,188)	83% (376)	1.6%	0.7
Early childcare coverage in the area of residence	41% (750)	32% (451)	66% (299)	-34%	<0.001***
Gender of the child				0.03	
Boy	48% (723)	49% (558)	47% (165)		
Girl	52% (774)	51% (588)	53% (186)		
Applied to any early childcare facility at endline	76% (1,104)	77% (861)	72% (243)	5.3%	0.13
Applied to any daycare center at endline	49% (898)	51% (709)	42% (189)	8.8%	0.005***
Accessed any early childcare facility at endline	56% (817)	58% (648)	50% (169)	8.1%	0.031**
Accessed any daycare center at endline	18% (327)	20% (273)	12% (54)	7.6%	0.001***

[1]% (n); Mean (SD)

		Province: Seine-Saint-Denis comparison			
Variable	Overall[1]	Seine-Saint-Denis[1]	Other provinces[1]	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]

[2]3-sample test for equality of proportions without continuity correction; Welch Two Sample t-test; Standardized Mean Difference

[3]*p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01

Sources: Baseline database. Proportions and number of observations in parentheses for categorical and dichotomous variables and Pearson's Chi-squared test.
We report averages and standard deviations in parentheses for continuous variables and use a Kruskal-Wallis rank sum test.

2.1.0.8.3 Val de Marne

Table 2.10: Differences by province across the variables used in this study

		Province: Val-de-Marne comparison			
Variable	Overall[1]	Val-de-Marne[1]	Other provinces	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
High-SES	61% (1,120)	61% (701)	59% (419)	2.0%	0.7
Single-parent family	8.6% (159)	10% (115)	6.2% (44)	3.8%	0.017**
Age of the mother	32.3 (5.6)	32.5 (5.7)	31.9 (5.4)	0.61	0.021**
The household is primiparous	42% (784)	44% (500)	40% (284)	3.4%	0.3
Number of children in the household	1.0 (1.2)	1.0 (1.2)	1.0 (1.1)	-0.05	0.4
The mother has a migration background	47% (865)	48% (546)	45% (319)	2.6%	0.6
The household earns less than €2,500 per month	36% (606)	36% (367)	36% (239)	-0.40%	>0.9
The mother is present biased	47% (861)	48% (543)	45% (318)	2.5%	0.6

		Province: Val-de-Marne comparison			
Variable	Overall[1]	Val-de-Marne[1]	Other provinces	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
Mother s knowledge about early childcare	12% (227)	13% (147)	11% (80)	1.5%	0.6
The mother is active at the baseline	70% (1,291)	70% (795)	70% (496)	-0.70%	>0.9
The mother wants to work after the maternity leave	89% (1,641)	89% (1,014)	89% (627)	-0.10%	>0.9
The household has ever used early childcare	40% (745)	41% (473)	39% (272)	2.9%	0.5
The mother wants to use early childcare	81% (1,491)	81% (931)	79% (560)	2.1%	0.5
The household has access to a computer	85% (1,564)	83% (947)	87% (617)	-4.5%	0.032**
Early childcare coverage in the area of residence	41% (750)	41% (471)	40% (279)	1.7%	0.8
Gender of the child				0.01	
Boy	48% (723)	48% (443)	48% (280)		
Girl	52% (774)	52% (472)	52% (302)		
Applied to any early childcare facility at endline	76% (1,104)	78% (692)	72% (412)	6.1%	0.030**
Applied to any daycare center at endline	49% (898)	51% (582)	45% (316)	6.2%	0.036**

Province: Val-de-Marne comparison					
Variable	Overall[1]	Val-de-Marne[1]	Other provinces	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
Accessed any early childcare facility at endline	56% (817)	60% (531)	50% (286)	10%	<0.001***
Accessed any daycare center at endline	18% (327)	22% (252)	11% (75)	11%	<0.001***

[1]% (n); Mean (SD)

[2]3-sample test for equality of proportions without continuity correction; Welch Two Sample t-test; Standardized Mean Difference

[3]*p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01

Sources: Baseline database. Proportions and number of observations in parentheses for categorical and dichotomous variables and Pearson's Chi-squared test.
We report averages and standard deviations in parentheses for continuous variables and use a Kruskal-Wallis rank sum test.

2.1.0.9 Distribution of all variables by compliance to the support treatment

Table 2.11: Differences by compliance status to the support

Compliance					
Variable	Overall[1]	Non-Compliers[1]	Compliers[1]	**Difference**[2]	**p-value**[3]
Single-parent family	7.5% (46)	4.2% (11)	9.8% (35)	-5.6%	0.033**
Age of the mother	32.3 (5.6)	32.4 (5.5)	32.3 (5.7)	0.10	0.8
Number of children in the household				0.15	
0	43% (264)	39% (101)	46% (163)		
1	31% (188)	33% (87)	28% (101)		
2 or more	27% (163)	28% (72)	26% (91)		

Compliance					
Variable	Overall[1]	Non-Compliers[1]	Compliers[1]	**Difference[2]**	**p-value[3]**
The mother has a migration background	50% (307)	41% (106)	56% (201)	-16%	<0.001***
The mother has a post-secondary education (high-SES)	61% (373)	63% (165)	58% (208)	5.0%	0.5
The household earns less than €2,500 per month	36% (207)	37% (91)	36% (116)	0.41%	>0.9
The mother is present orientated	48% (296)	45% (117)	50% (179)	-5.3%	0.4
The mother is active at baseline	68% (417)	68% (177)	67% (240)	0.66%	>0.9
The mother wants to work after maternity leaves	88% (544)	84% (219)	91% (325)	-7.1%	0.027**
The household has ever used early childcare	42% (256)	44% (115)	40% (141)	4.6%	0.5
The mother wants to use early childcare	81% (498)	73% (191)	86% (307)	-13%	<0.001***
The household has access to a computer	83% (509)	87% (226)	79% (283)	7.4%	0.056*
The mother lives in Paris	38% (234)	36% (94)	39% (140)	-3.2%	0.7
Early childcare coverage is high	40% (249)	43% (111)	39% (138)	3.9%	0.6
Child is a girl	52% (260)	52% (125)	52% (135)	0.34%	>0.9

		Compliance			
Variable	Overall[1]	Non-Compliers[1]	Compliers[1]	**Difference[2]**	**p-value[3]**

[1]% (n); Mean (SD)

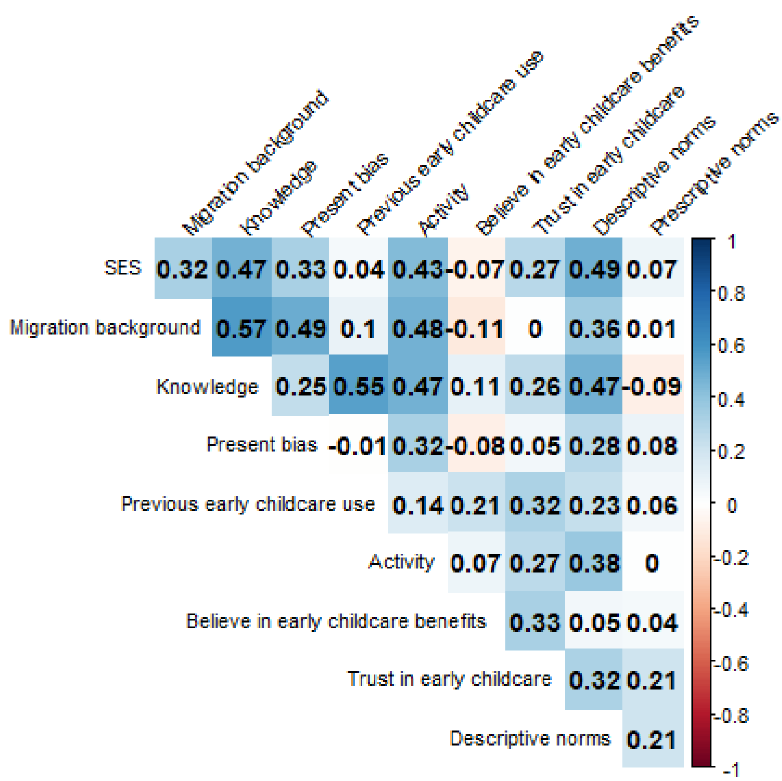
[2]3-sample test for equality of proportions without continuity correction; Welch Two Sample t-test; Standardized Mean Difference

[3]*p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01

Sources: Baseline database. Proportions and number of observations in parentheses for categorical and dichotomous variables and Pearson's Chi-squared test.
We report averages and standard deviations in parentheses for continuous variables and use a Kruskal-Wallis rank sum test.

2.2 Correlation matrix between the main variables

This plot shows the tetrachoric correlation coefficients of the different variables used in the article:



2.3 Descriptive results on intention, application and access to early childcare by SES in the control group

Table 2.12:

	Intention	***Application***	***Application Intention***	***Access***	***Access Apply***
Low-SES (ref = High-SES)	-0.153* [-0.321, 0.014]	-0.240*** [-0.357, -0.124]	-0.156*** [-0.231, -0.080]	-0.336*** [-0.449, -0.224]	-0.168*** [-0.244, -0.093]
	0.084 (0.073)	0.059 (<0.001)	0.038 (<0.001)	0.057 (<0.001)	0.038 (<0.001)
Intention to apply: Yes			0.516*** [0.426, 0.606]		
			0.045 (<0.001)		
Applied					0.699*** [0.638, 0.761]
					0.031 (<0.001)
R2	0.036	0.071	0.279	0.108	0.460
R2 Adj.	0.035	0.069	0.276	0.106	0.457
Num.Obs.	1849	494	494	494	494
Std.Errors	by: StrataWave	by: StrataWave	by: StrataWave	by: StrataWave	by: StrataWave

Coefficient, 95 % CI in brackets, standard errors, p-value or adjusted p-value in parenthesis

2.4 Descriptive results on intention, application and access to early childcare by migration background in the control group

Table 2.13:

	Intention	***Application***	***Application Intention***	***Access***	***Access Apply***
MigrationBackground: Yes	-0.068*** [-0.110, -0.027]	-0.139*** [-0.231, -0.047]	-0.118*** [-0.198, -0.039]	-0.246*** [-0.336, -0.157]	-0.146*** [-0.219, -0.072]
	0.021 (0.001)	0.046 (0.003)	0.040 (0.004)	0.045 (<0.001)	0.037 (<0.001)
Intention to apply: Yes			0.548*** [0.457, 0.639]		
			0.046 (<0.001)		
Applied					0.724*** [0.666, 0.782]

	Intention	*Application*	*Application Intention*	*Access*	*Access Apply*
					0.029 (<0.001)
R2	0.007	0.024	0.268	0.059	0.455
R2 Adj.	0.007	0.023	0.265	0.057	0.453
Num.Obs.	1849	494	494	494	494
Std.Errors	by: StrataWave	by: StrataWave	by: StrataWave	by: StrataWave	by: StrataWave

Coefficient, 95 % CI in brackets, standard errors, p-value or adjusted p-value in parenthesis

3 Part 3: Main results

All main results are based on the endline sample of 1453 participants.

3.1 Heterogeneous effects of the information-only treatment on early childcare applications and access

Table 3.1: Average gaps and heterogeneous treatment effects of the information-only treatment by SES and migration background

		Group	*Early childcare application*		*Early childcare access*	
			Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT
Information-only vs control	SES	High-SES	0.84*** (0.03)	-0.02 (0.02)	0.70*** (0.03)	-0.04 (0.03)
			[0.78, 0.90]	[-0.07, 0.03]	[0.62, 0.77]	[-0.12, 0.03]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.586	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.403
		Low-SES	0.60*** (0.05)	0.01 (0.05)	0.35*** (0.04)	0.02 (0.05)
			[0.49, 0.70]	[-0.09, 0.12]	[0.25, 0.44]	[-0.09, 0.13]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.772	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.725
	Migration background	Yes	0.66*** (0.05)	0.00 (0.04)	0.40*** (0.05)	-0.02 (0.05)

	Group	Early childcare application		Early childcare access	
		Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT
		[0.55, 0.77]	[-0.09, 0.09]	[0.28, 0.51]	[-0.15, 0.11]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.941	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.737
		0.82*** (0.03)	-0.01 (0.03)	0.69*** (0.04)	-0.03 (0.03)
	No	[0.75, 0.89]	[-0.07, 0.05]	[0.61, 0.77]	[-0.09, 0.04]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.834	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.631
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Adjusted standard errors robust to cluster-heteroskedasticity at the block level.
Adjusted p-values and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference using the Westfall method.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-values are reported at the bottom of the table.

3.2 Heterogeneous effects of the information-only treatment on daycare applications and access

Table 3.2: Average gaps and heterogeneous treatment effects of the information-only treatment by SES and migration background

	Variable	Group	Daycare application		Daycare access	
			Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT
Information-only vs control	SES	High-SES	0.66*** (0.03)	0.00 (0.04)	0.23*** (0.02)	0.00 (0.03)
			[0.59, 0.73]	[-0.08, 0.08]	[0.18, 0.28]	[-0.07, 0.07]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.999	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.945
		Low-SES	0.47*** (0.05)	0.02 (0.04)	0.18*** (0.03)	-0.03 (0.04)
			[0.37, 0.57]	[-0.08, 0.12]	[0.11, 0.25]	[-0.13, 0.07]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.635	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.690

Variable	Group	Daycare application		Daycare access	
		Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT
Migration background	Yes	0.54*** (0.04)	0.05 (0.04)	0.16*** (0.03)	0.02 (0.04)
		[0.44, 0.64]	[-0.05, 0.14]	[0.10, 0.22]	[-0.08, 0.12]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.241	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.656
	No	0.63*** (0.03)	0.00 (0.04)	0.24*** (0.03)	-0.01 (0.04)
		[0.55, 0.71]	[-0.09, 0.09]	[0.18, 0.30]	[-0.10, 0.08]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.974	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.827
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Adjusted standard errors robust to cluster-heteroskedasticity at the block level.
Adjusted p-values and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference using the Westfall method.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-values are reported at the bottom of the table.

4 Part 4: Mechanisms

4.1 Information Costs

4.1.1 Heterogeneous effects of the treatments by main dimensions of information costs presented in the manuscript

4.1.1.1 Application and access to early childcare

Table 4.1: Average gaps and heterogeneous treatment effects of the information + support treatlent on early childcare application and access

	Variable	Group	Early childcare application			Early childcare access		
			Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT
Information + support vs control	Descriptive Norms	Minority	0.55*** (0.05)	0.12*** (0.04)	0.22*** (0.08)	0.31*** (0.05)	0.10** (0.04)	0.18** (0.08)
			[0.44, 0.67]	[0.02, 0.22]	[0.04, 0.39]	[0.20, 0.41]	[0.00, 0.20]	[0.01, 0.36]

Variable	Group	Early childcare application			Early childcare access		
		Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.013	adj.p.val. = 0.010	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.052	adj.p.val. = 0.035
	Majority	0.86*** (0.02)	0.01 (0.02)	0.03 (0.05)	0.72*** (0.03)	-0.01 (0.03)	-0.02 (0.06)
		[0.81, 0.92]	[-0.04, 0.07]	[-0.08, 0.13]	[0.65, 0.79]	[-0.08, 0.06]	[-0.16, 0.11]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.584	adj.p.val. = 0.583	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.915	adj.p.val. = 0.915
Ever Used Early Childcare	Never used	0.69*** (0.05)	0.09*** (0.03)	0.16*** (0.05)	0.50*** (0.05)	0.06* (0.03)	0.10* (0.06)
		[0.59, 0.79]	[0.03, 0.16]	[0.05, 0.28]	[0.38, 0.62]	[-0.01, 0.13]	[-0.03, 0.23]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.002	adj.p.val. = 0.003	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.153	adj.p.val. = 0.141
	Already used	0.84*** (0.03)	0.01 (0.03)	0.01 (0.05)	0.69*** (0.04)	-0.04 (0.05)	-0.08 (0.09)
		[0.77, 0.92]	[-0.06, 0.07]	[-0.11, 0.13]	[0.59, 0.78]	[-0.15, 0.07]	[-0.28, 0.12]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.818	adj.p.val. = 0.817	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.664	adj.p.val. = 0.606
Level of knowledge	High knowledge	0.80*** (0.03)	0.01 (0.02)	0.02 (0.04)	0.63*** (0.03)	-0.01 (0.03)	-0.03 (0.05)
		[0.74, 0.87]	[-0.04, 0.06]	[-0.07, 0.11]	[0.55, 0.70]	[-0.08, 0.05]	[-0.15, 0.09]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.573	adj.p.val. = 0.572	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.624	adj.p.val. = 0.622
	Low knowledge	0.36*** (0.09)	0.24** (0.10)	0.42** (0.20)	0.05 (0.04)	0.27*** (0.06)	0.48*** (0.11)
		[0.15, 0.57]	[0.00, 0.49]	[-0.02, 0.86]	[-0.03, 0.14]	[0.13, 0.41]	[0.22, 0.73]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.056	adj.p.val. = 0.061	adj.p.val. = 0.132	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.000
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X	X	X

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Adjusted standard errors robust to cluster-heteroskedasticity at the block level.
Adjusted p-values and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference using the Westfall method.

Variable	Group	Early childcare application			Early childcare access		
		Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT

Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-values are reported at the bottom of the table.

4.1.1.2 Application and access to daycare

Table 4.2: Average gaps and heterogeneous treatment effects

	Variable	Group	Daycare application			Daycare access		
			Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT
Information + support vs control	Descriptive Norms	Minority	0.44*** (0.05)	0.13*** (0.05)	0.24*** (0.09)	0.14*** (0.03)	0.07* (0.04)	0.13* (0.07)
			[0.33, 0.55]	[0.02, 0.25]	[0.05, 0.44]	[0.07, 0.21]	[-0.02, 0.16]	[-0.03, 0.29]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.018	adj.p.val. = 0.011	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.139	adj.p.val. = 0.076
		Majority	0.66*** (0.03)	0.07** (0.04)	0.15** (0.07)	0.25*** (0.02)	0.05 (0.03)	0.10 (0.07)
			[0.60, 0.73]	[-0.01, 0.16]	[-0.01, 0.31]	[0.19, 0.31]	[-0.03, 0.13]	[-0.05, 0.25]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.094	adj.p.val. = 0.060	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.288	adj.p.val. = 0.220
	Ever Used Early Childcare	Never used	0.56*** (0.04)	0.12*** (0.03)	0.22*** (0.05)	0.19*** (0.03)	0.04* (0.03)	0.08* (0.05)
			[0.48, 0.65]	[0.05, 0.19]	[0.09, 0.34]	[0.13, 0.25]	[-0.01, 0.10]	[-0.02, 0.18]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.152	adj.p.val. = 0.087
		Already used	0.64*** (0.04)	0.05 (0.04)	0.10 (0.07)	0.26*** (0.03)	0.06* (0.04)	0.13 (0.08)
			[0.55, 0.73]	[-0.04, 0.14]	[-0.06, 0.26]	[0.19, 0.33]	[-0.02, 0.15]	[-0.04, 0.29]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.377	adj.p.val. = 0.308	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.168	adj.p.val. = 0.127
	Level of knowledge	High knowledge	0.62*** (0.03)	0.07** (0.03)	0.13** (0.05)	0.23*** (0.02)	0.04* (0.02)	0.08* (0.05)
			[0.56, 0.69]	[0.00, 0.14]	[0.01, 0.25]	[0.18, 0.28]	[-0.01, 0.10]	[-0.02, 0.18]

Variable	Group	Daycare application			Daycare access		
		Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.042	adj.p.val. = 0.026	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.157	adj.p.val. = 0.091
	Low knowledge	0.34*** (0.09)	0.18 (0.12)	0.31 (0.21)	0.03 (0.03)	0.21*** (0.06)	0.36*** (0.10)
		[0.12, 0.56]	[-0.10, 0.45]	[-0.17, 0.78]	[-0.04, 0.10]	[0.08, 0.34]	[0.13, 0.59]
		adj.p.val. = 0.001	adj.p.val. = 0.324	adj.p.val. = 0.274	adj.p.val. = 0.305	adj.p.val. = 0.001	adj.p.val. = 0.001
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X	X	X

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Adjusted standard errors robust to cluster-heteroskedasticity at the block level.
Adjusted p-values and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference using the Westfall method.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-values are reported at the bottom of the table.

4.1.2 Heterogeneous effects of the treatments on generic knowledge of the early childcare system (pre-registered intermediary outcomes)

4.1.2.1 Number of early childcare types known

Table 4.3: Heterogeneous treatment effects on the number of early childcare types known: SES & Migration background

	Group	Know that early childcare is subsidised					
		Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Information + Support vs Control	Migration background				1.91*** (0.12)	-0.18* (0.11)	-0.29* (0.18)
					[1.65, 2.17]	[-0.41, 0.06]	[-0.68, 0.10]
					adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.172	adj.p.val. = 0.173
	No Migration background				2.78*** (0.12)	0.09 (0.14)	0.20 (0.32)
					[2.51, 3.05]	[-0.22, 0.40]	[-0.50, 0.90]
					adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.527	adj.p.val. = 0.529

	Group	Know that early childcare is subsidised					
		Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
	High-SES	2.70*** (0.12)	-0.02 (0.13)	-0.04 (0.25)			
		[2.44, 2.96]	[-0.30, 0.25]	[-0.59, 0.50]			
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.970	adj.p.val. = 0.970			
	Low-SES	1.91*** (0.13)	-0.18 (0.14)	-0.32 (0.24)			
		[1.62, 2.20]	[-0.48, 0.12]	[-0.85, 0.22]			
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.313	adj.p.val. = 0.299			
Num.Obs.		1946	1946	1946	1946	1946	1946
R2		0.650	0.268	0.269	0.682	0.378	0.377
R2 Adj.		0.617	0.197	0.198	0.618	0.252	0.251
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X	X	X
Mean F-stat 1st stage				297			313

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-value are reported at the bottom of the table.

4.1.2.2 Knowledge that early childcare is subsidised

Table 4.4: Heterogeneous treatment effects on the number of early childcare types known: SES & Migration background

	Group	Number of early childcare types known					
		Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Information + Support vs Control	Migration background				0.83*** (0.03)	-0.02 (0.04)	-0.04 (0.06)
					[0.76, 0.90]	[-0.10, 0.05]	[-0.17, 0.09]
					adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.503	adj.p.val. = 0.503

	Group	Number of early childcare types known					
		Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
	No Migration background				0.97*** (0.01)	-0.01 (0.01)	-0.02 (0.03)
					[0.95, 0.99]	[-0.04, 0.02]	[-0.10, 0.05]
					adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.697	adj.p.val. = 0.702
	High-SES	0.96*** (0.01)	-0.02 (0.02)	-0.05 (0.04)			
		[0.93, 0.99]	[-0.06, 0.02]	[-0.13, 0.03]			
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.320	adj.p.val. = 0.324			
	Low-SES	0.83*** (0.03)	-0.03 (0.04)	-0.06 (0.07)			
		[0.77, 0.90]	[-0.11, 0.05]	[-0.21, 0.09]			
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.583	adj.p.val. = 0.585			
Num.Obs.		1946	1946	1946	1946	1946	1946
R2		0.864	0.172	0.170	0.878	0.301	0.299
R2 Adj.		0.850	0.092	0.090	0.853	0.159	0.157
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X	X	X
Mean F-stat 1st stage				297			313

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-value are reported at the bottom of the table.

4.2 Psychological and social costs

4.2.1 Heterogeneous effects of the treatments by main dimensions of psychological costs presented in the manuscript

4.2.1.1 Application and access to early childcare

Table 4.5: Average gaps and heterogeneous treatment effects

	Variable	***Group***	***Early childcare application***			***Early childcare access***		
			Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT
Information + support vs control	Present biased	Yes	0.66*** (0.04)	0.08** (0.04)	0.14** (0.07)	0.44*** (0.05)	0.05 (0.05)	0.09 (0.09)
			[0.56, 0.75]	[-0.01, 0.16]	[-0.01, 0.29]	[0.34, 0.55]	[-0.06, 0.16]	[-0.11, 0.28]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.105	adj.p.val. = 0.066	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.502	adj.p.val. = 0.497
		No	0.83*** (0.03)	0.02 (0.03)	0.03 (0.05)	0.68*** (0.04)	0.00 (0.03)	0.00 (0.07)
			[0.77, 0.90]	[-0.04, 0.08]	[-0.08, 0.15]	[0.59, 0.76]	[-0.08, 0.08]	[-0.15, 0.16]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.507	adj.p.val. = 0.506	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.968	adj.p.val. = 0.968
	Trust	High	0.81*** (0.03)	0.05** (0.02)	0.09** (0.04)	0.63*** (0.03)	0.00 (0.03)	0.01 (0.05)
			[0.75, 0.87]	[0.00, 0.10]	[0.00, 0.18]	[0.55, 0.71]	[-0.06, 0.07]	[-0.11, 0.13]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.048	adj.p.val. = 0.037	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.902	adj.p.val. = 0.871
		Low	0.34*** (0.08)	0.11 (0.09)	0.26 (0.21)	0.12** (0.05)	0.16** (0.07)	0.36** (0.16)
			[0.16, 0.52]	[-0.10, 0.32]	[-0.21, 0.73]	[0.00, 0.24]	[-0.01, 0.32]	[0.02, 0.71]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.463	adj.p.val. = 0.354	adj.p.val. = 0.022	adj.p.val. = 0.065	adj.p.val. = 0.037
	Activity	Active	0.88*** (0.02)	0.01 (0.02)	0.01 (0.04)	0.71*** (0.03)	0.00 (0.03)	0.00 (0.06)
			[0.83, 0.93]	[-0.04, 0.06]	[-0.08, 0.10]	[0.64, 0.79]	[-0.07, 0.07]	[-0.13, 0.13]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.943	adj.p.val. = 0.778	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.992	adj.p.val. = 0.990

Variable	Group	Early childcare application			Early childcare access		
		Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT
	Inactive	0.40*** (0.06)	0.16*** (0.05)	0.32*** (0.10)	0.21*** (0.05)	0.05 (0.05)	0.09 (0.11)
		[0.27, 0.53]	[0.05, 0.27]	[0.09, 0.54]	[0.10, 0.32]	[-0.08, 0.17]	[-0.15, 0.33]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.002	adj.p.val. = 0.004	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.612	adj.p.val. = 0.400
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X	X	X

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Models are jointly estimating conditional averages in each pair of treatment arm.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference across treatment arms.

4.2.1.2 Application and access to daycare

Table 4.6: Average gaps and heterogeneous treatment effects

	Variable	Group	Daycare application			Daycare access		
			Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT
Information + support vs control	Present biased	Yes	0.54*** (0.04)	0.08* (0.04)	0.15** (0.07)	0.18*** (0.03)	0.10** (0.05)	0.18** (0.09)
			[0.44, 0.64]	[-0.01, 0.17]	[-0.01, 0.31]	[0.11, 0.25]	[-0.01, 0.21]	[-0.01, 0.37]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.117	adj.p.val. = 0.081	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.105	adj.p.val. = 0.075
		No	0.64*** (0.03)	0.08* (0.04)	0.15* (0.08)	0.25*** (0.03)	0.01 (0.03)	0.02 (0.06)
			[0.56, 0.71]	[-0.02, 0.17]	[-0.02, 0.33]	[0.19, 0.31]	[-0.07, 0.09]	[-0.12, 0.16]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.103	adj.p.val. = 0.050	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.730	adj.p.val. = 0.731
	Trust	High	0.64*** (0.03)	0.10*** (0.03)	0.19*** (0.05)	0.23*** (0.02)	0.07*** (0.02)	0.13*** (0.05)
			[0.57, 0.70]	[0.04, 0.16]	[0.08, 0.29]	[0.18, 0.28]	[0.01, 0.12]	[0.03, 0.23]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.011	adj.p.val. = 0.011

Variable	Group	Daycare application			Daycare access		
		Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT
	Low	0.27*** (0.07)	0.10 (0.08)	0.22 (0.19)	0.08** (0.04)	0.06 (0.06)	0.14 (0.13)
		[0.11, 0.43]	[-0.09, 0.28]	[-0.20, 0.65]	[-0.01, 0.17]	[-0.07, 0.19]	[-0.15, 0.43]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.374	adj.p.val. = 0.392	adj.p.val. = 0.080	adj.p.val. = 0.292	adj.p.val. = 0.301
Activity	Active	0.68*** (0.03)	0.06* (0.03)	0.10* (0.06)	0.26*** (0.02)	0.05 (0.03)	0.09 (0.06)
		[0.62, 0.74]	[-0.02, 0.13]	[-0.03, 0.24]	[0.21, 0.32]	[-0.02, 0.12]	[-0.04, 0.22]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.201	adj.p.val. = 0.141	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.222	adj.p.val. = 0.162
	Inactive	0.34*** (0.05)	0.16*** (0.05)	0.31*** (0.11)	0.12*** (0.04)	0.04 (0.05)	0.08 (0.09)
		[0.22, 0.47]	[0.04, 0.28]	[0.07, 0.55]	[0.03, 0.20]	[-0.07, 0.15]	[-0.13, 0.29]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.006	adj.p.val. = 0.007	adj.p.val. = 0.003	adj.p.val. = 0.597	adj.p.val. = 0.403
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X	X	X

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block level.
Models are jointly estimating conditional averages in each pair of treatment arm.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference across treatment arms.

4.2.2 Interaction effects Active X SES

Table 4.7: Average effects on application and access to early childcare by level of education and employment status at baseline

	Activity	SES	Early childcare application			Early childcare access		
			Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Information + Support vs Control	Active	High	0.92*** (0.02)	0.01 (0.02)	0.01 (0.04)	0.80*** (0.03)	0.00 (0.03)	0.00 (0.06)
			[0.88, 0.97]	[-0.04, 0.06]	[-0.08, 0.10]	[0.74, 0.86]	[-0.07, 0.08]	[-0.14, 0.14]

Activity	SES	Early childcare application: Control mean	Early childcare application: ITT	Early childcare application: ATT	Early childcare access: Control mean	Early childcare access: ITT	Early childcare access: ATT
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.873	adj.p.val. = 0.870	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.956	adj.p.val. = 0.956
	Low	0.76*** (0.05)	0.01 (0.05)	0.01 (0.10)	0.48*** (0.05)	0.00 (0.07)	-0.01 (0.14)
		[0.66, 0.87]	[-0.11, 0.12]	[-0.21, 0.23]	[0.36, 0.59]	[-0.16, 0.15]	[-0.31, 0.29]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.903	adj.p.val. = 0.903	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.998	adj.p.val. = 0.998
Inactive	High	0.44*** (0.08)	0.14* (0.08)	0.36* (0.21)	0.22*** (0.07)	0.05 (0.09)	0.12 (0.21)
		[0.26, 0.62]	[-0.03, 0.31]	[-0.11, 0.83]	[0.07, 0.38]	[-0.14, 0.24]	[-0.35, 0.60]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.125	adj.p.val. = 0.163	adj.p.val. = 0.001	adj.p.val. = 0.758	adj.p.val. = 0.739
	Low	0.38*** (0.07)	0.17*** (0.06)	0.30** (0.12)	0.20*** (0.06)	0.04 (0.07)	0.08 (0.12)
		[0.22, 0.54]	[0.03, 0.30]	[0.04, 0.56]	[0.06, 0.34]	[-0.11, 0.20]	[-0.20, 0.35]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.010	adj.p.val. = 0.019	adj.p.val. = 0.002	adj.p.val. = 0.525	adj.p.val. = 0.532
Num.Obs.		1946	1946	1946	1946	1946	1946
R2		0.778	0.509	0.515	0.647	0.451	0.452
R2 Adj.		0.733	0.410	0.416	0.576	0.340	0.340
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X	X	X
Mean F-stat 1st stage				141			141

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Adjusted standard errors robust to cluster-heteroskedasticity at the block level.
Adjusted p-values and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference using the Westfall method.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-values are reported at the bottom of the table.

4.2.3 Attitudes & SES

4.2.3.1 More on trust in early childcare facilities

4.2.3.1.1 Interaction SES and trust

As shown in Table 4.8, the effects on access among low-trust individuals are concentrated in the low-SES subgroup. In this group, where access was nearly non-existent in the control group, the treatment increased the probability of obtaining a spot by 68 percentage points ; average counterfactual = 0.04; ß = 0.68; SE = 0.23; 95% SCI, (0.17, 1.18); adjusted p-value = 0.006).

Table 4.8: Average effects on application and access to early childcare by level of education and Trusts towards early childcare

	Trust	SES	Early childcare application			Early childcare access		
			Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Information + Support vs Control	High	High	0.87*** (0.02)	0.04* (0.03)	0.08 (0.05)	0.73*** (0.03)	0.02 (0.04)	0.04 (0.07)
			[0.82, 0.92]	[-0.01, 0.10]	[-0.03, 0.20]	[0.66, 0.80]	[-0.06, 0.10]	[-0.12, 0.20]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.105	adj.p.val. = 0.098	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.601	adj.p.val. = 0.601
		Low	0.70*** (0.05)	0.07* (0.04)	0.11* (0.07)	0.43*** (0.04)	-0.03 (0.05)	-0.04 (0.08)
			[0.58, 0.81]	[-0.02, 0.15]	[-0.04, 0.26]	[0.33, 0.53]	[-0.14, 0.09]	[-0.23, 0.15]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.167	adj.p.val. = 0.176	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.849	adj.p.val. = 0.845
	Low	High	0.49*** (0.15)	-0.02 (0.11)	-0.04 (0.22)	0.23** (0.10)	0.00 (0.08)	0.00 (0.16)
			[0.16, 0.82]	[-0.26, 0.22]	[-0.52, 0.44]	[0.00, 0.45]	[-0.18, 0.18]	[-0.36, 0.35]
			adj.p.val. = 0.001	adj.p.val. = 0.851	adj.p.val. = 0.849	adj.p.val. = 0.023	adj.p.val. = 0.998	adj.p.val. = 0.998
		Low	0.24*** (0.07)	0.20 (0.13)	0.52 (0.33)	0.04 (0.04)	0.26*** (0.09)	0.68*** (0.23)
			[0.08, 0.40]	[-0.08, 0.48]	[-0.21, 1.25]	[-0.05, 0.14]	[0.05, 0.46]	[0.17, 1.18]
			adj.p.val. = 0.001	adj.p.val. = 0.197	adj.p.val. = 0.193	adj.p.val. = 0.318	adj.p.val. = 0.010	adj.p.val. = 0.006
Num.Obs.			1946	1946	1946	1946	1946	1946
R2			0.742	0.464	0.473	0.591	0.375	0.373
R2 Adj.			0.693	0.361	0.372	0.512	0.255	0.253
Fixed effects			X	X	X	X	X	X
Mean F-stat 1st stage					134			134

Trust	SES	Early childcare application			Early childcare access		
		Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT

*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference using themethod.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-value are reported at the bottom of the table.

4.2.3.2 Beliefs about the benefits of early childcare

Following Steinberg & Leinhart (2022), we inestigated heterogeneous effects according to parents' beliefs about the benefits of early childcare for children's development. Overall, our findings suggest that beliefs about the developmental benefits of early childcare are not a major driver of the observed inequalities in application and access. In the control group, there is less than a 10-percentage point difference in both application and access probabilities between those who believed in the benefits of early childcare and those who did not (see Table 4.9). Furthermore, we did not find evidence of differential treatment effects of the information + support treatment on application and access by beliefs in general, which aligns with this interpretation

4.2.3.2.1 Early childcare application and access

Table 4.9: Average effects on application and access to early childcare by beliefs in early childcare benefits for child development

	Group	Early childcare application			Early childcare access		
		Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Information + Support vs Control	Believe in benefits	0.79*** (0.03)	0.05* (0.03)	0.10* (0.06)	0.60*** (0.04)	-0.02 (0.04)	-0.03 (0.08)
		[0.71, 0.87]	[-0.02, 0.13]	[-0.03, 0.22]	[0.52, 0.69]	[-0.12, 0.09]	[-0.20, 0.14]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.214	adj.p.val. = 0.167	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.901	adj.p.val. = 0.901
	Don't believe	0.70*** (0.05)	0.03 (0.04)	0.06 (0.08)	0.53*** (0.05)	0.06 (0.04)	0.12 (0.07)
		[0.59, 0.81]	[-0.06, 0.11]	[-0.11, 0.22]	[0.41, 0.66]	[-0.03, 0.14]	[-0.05, 0.28]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.656	adj.p.val. = 0.457	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.196	adj.p.val. = 0.110
Num.Obs.		2906	2906	1946	2906	2906	1946
R2		0.723	0.441	0.453	0.552	0.371	0.364
R2 Adj.		0.668	0.329	0.343	0.462	0.244	0.237

	Group	Early childcare application			Early childcare access		
		Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X	X	X
Mean F-stat 1st stage				288			288

*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-value are reported at the bottom of the table.

4.2.3.2.2 Daycare application and access

As shown in Table 4.10, for daycare specifically, this treatment led to a 16-percentage point increase in probability that those who believe in the benefits of early childcare apply. Yet, we found similar point estimates among those who do not believe in these benefits, although the effects were not statistically significant, potentially due to limited statistical power. We found no effect on access.

Table 4.10: Average effects on application and access to daycare by beliefs in early childcare benefits for child development

	Group	Daycare application			Daycare access		
		Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Information + Support vs Control	Believe in benefits	0.63*** (0.03)	0.09** (0.04)	0.16** (0.06)	0.25*** (0.03)	0.04 (0.03)	0.08 (0.06)
		[0.55, 0.71]	[0.01, 0.17]	[0.02, 0.30]	[0.18, 0.31]	[-0.04, 0.13]	[-0.06, 0.22]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.031	adj.p.val. = 0.022	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.414	adj.p.val. = 0.347
	Don't believe	0.55*** (0.04)	0.07 (0.05)	0.14 (0.10)	0.18*** (0.03)	0.04 (0.03)	0.09 (0.07)
		[0.45, 0.65]	[-0.05, 0.19]	[-0.09, 0.36]	[0.11, 0.25]	[-0.03, 0.12]	[-0.05, 0.23]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.317	adj.p.val. = 0.177	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.285	adj.p.val. = 0.156
Num.Obs.		2906	2906	1946	2906	2906	1946
R2		0.552	0.307	0.334	0.267	0.196	0.189
R2 Adj.		0.462	0.169	0.201	0.120	0.035	0.028

	Group	Daycare application			Daycare access		
		Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X	X	X
Mean F-stat 1st stage				288			288

*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-value are reported at the bottom of the table.

4.2.3.2.3 Interaction SES and beliefs

This lack of significance likely arise frome considerable heterogeneity within this latter group, as shown in Table 4.11. When examining the interaction between SES and beliefs, we found that the effects of the information + support treatment are concentrated among low-SES households who do not initially believe in the benefits of early childcare for their child. Specifically, for compliers, the treatment increased by 78% probability of applying (average counterfactual Low-SES & no belief in benefits = 0.46; ß = 0.36 SE = 0.1; 95% SCI, (0.01, 0.71); adjusted p-value = 0.042), which translated into a 40-percentage point increase in access, therefore nearly doubling their probability of accessing a spot compared to the control group (average counterfactual Low-SES & no belief in benefits = 0.24; ß = 0.40 SE = 0.15; 95% SCI, (0.08, 0.72); adjusted p-value = 0.011).

Table 4.11: Average effects on application and access to early childcare by level of education and beliefs in the benefits of early childcare for child development

	Believe	SES	Early childcare application			Early childcare access		
			Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Information + Support vs Control	Yes	High	0.84*** (0.03)	0.05 (0.03)	0.09 (0.06)	0.70*** (0.03)	0.01 (0.05)	0.01 (0.09)
			[0.78, 0.91]	[-0.02, 0.12]	[-0.04, 0.22]	[0.62, 0.78]	[-0.10, 0.12]	[-0.20, 0.22]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.181	adj.p.val. = 0.196	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.944	adj.p.val. = 0.944
		Low	0.70*** (0.07)	0.06 (0.07)	0.10 (0.11)	0.44*** (0.06)	-0.05 (0.08)	-0.09 (0.13)
			[0.54, 0.85]	[-0.09, 0.21]	[-0.15, 0.35]	[0.30, 0.57]	[-0.23, 0.12]	[-0.38, 0.21]

	Believe	SES	Early childcare application			Early childcare access		
			Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.587	adj.p.val. = 0.589	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.733	adj.p.val. = 0.729
	No	High	0.83*** (0.05)	-0.05 (0.04)	-0.09 (0.08)	0.68*** (0.06)	-0.01 (0.04)	-0.02 (0.08)
			[0.73, 0.93]	[-0.13, 0.03]	[-0.27, 0.08]	[0.56, 0.81]	[-0.10, 0.08]	[-0.20, 0.15]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.200	adj.p.val. = 0.216	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.777	adj.p.val. = 0.778
		Low	0.46*** (0.07)	0.17** (0.08)	0.36** (0.16)	0.24*** (0.06)	0.19*** (0.06)	0.40*** (0.15)
			[0.29, 0.62]	[0.00, 0.34]	[0.01, 0.71]	[0.11, 0.38]	[0.05, 0.33]	[0.08, 0.72]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.047	adj.p.val. = 0.042	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.006	adj.p.val. = 0.011
Num.Obs.			1946	1946	1946	1946	1946	1946
R2			0.732	0.451	0.455	0.576	0.367	0.366
R2 Adj.			0.678	0.340	0.345	0.490	0.240	0.238
Fixed effects			X	X	X	X	X	X
Mean F-stat 1st stage					146			146

*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference using themethod.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-value are reported at the bottom of the table.

4.2.4 More on Norms

4.2.4.1 Descriptive norms

4.2.4.1.1 Effects of the Information-only treatment on early childcare application and access

Table 4.12: Average effects on application and access to early childcare by whether more than half of friends and relatives use early childcare

	Group	**Early childcare application**		**Early childcare access**	
		Control mean	ITT	Control mean	ITT
Information only vs Control	Minority	0.57*** (0.05)	0.00 (0.06)	0.31*** (0.04)	0.00 (0.05)
		[0.45, 0.68]	[-0.14, 0.14]	[0.21, 0.41]	[-0.13, 0.12]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.988	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.945
	Majority	0.88*** (0.02)	-0.03 (0.03)	0.72*** (0.03)	-0.03 (0.04)
		[0.83, 0.93]	[-0.09, 0.03]	[0.64, 0.79]	[-0.12, 0.05]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.386	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.598
Num.Obs.		2906	2906	2906	2906
R2		0.747	0.462	0.600	0.402
R2 Adj.		0.696	0.353	0.519	0.281
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X

*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-value are reported at the bottom of the table.

4.2.4.1.2 Effects of the Information + Support treatment on early childcare application and access

4.2.4.1.3 Effects of the Information-only treatment on daycare application and access

Table 4.13: Average effects on application and access to daycare by whether more than half of friends and relatives use early childcare

	Group	Daycare application		Daycare access	
		Control mean	ITT	Control mean	ITT
Information only vs Control	Minority	0.46*** (0.05)	0.04 (0.06)	0.15*** (0.03)	-0.05 (0.04)
		[0.35, 0.57]	[-0.11, 0.19]	[0.08, 0.22]	[-0.14, 0.03]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.527	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.150
	Majority	0.68*** (0.03)	-0.01 (0.04)	0.26*** (0.03)	0.00 (0.04)
		[0.61, 0.75]	[-0.11, 0.08]	[0.20, 0.32]	[-0.08, 0.08]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.792	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.938
Num.Obs.		2906	2906	2906	2906
R2		0.561	0.302	0.261	0.179
R2 Adj.		0.472	0.161	0.112	0.013
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X

*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-value are reported at the bottom of the table.

4.2.4.1.4 Effects of the Information + Support treatment on daycare application and access

Table 4.14: Average effects on application and access to daycare by whether more than half of friends and relatives use early childcare

	Group	Daycare application			Daycare access		
		Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Information + Support vs Control	Minority	0.44*** (0.05)	0.13*** (0.05)	0.24*** (0.09)	0.14*** (0.03)	0.07* (0.04)	0.13* (0.07)
		[0.33, 0.55]	[0.02, 0.25]	[0.05, 0.44]	[0.07, 0.21]	[-0.02, 0.16]	[-0.03, 0.29]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.018	adj.p.val. = 0.011	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.139	adj.p.val. = 0.076
	Majority	0.66*** (0.03)	0.07** (0.04)	0.15** (0.07)	0.25*** (0.02)	0.05 (0.03)	0.10 (0.07)
		[0.60, 0.73]	[-0.01, 0.16]	[-0.01, 0.31]	[0.19, 0.31]	[-0.03, 0.13]	[-0.05, 0.25]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.093	adj.p.val. = 0.060	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.289	adj.p.val. = 0.220
Num.Obs.		2906	2906	1946	2906	2906	1946
R2		0.561	0.302	0.331	0.261	0.179	0.176
R2 Adj.		0.472	0.161	0.196	0.112	0.013	0.010
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X	X	X
Mean F-stat 1st stage				293			293

*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-value are reported at the bottom of the table.

4.2.4.1.5 Interaction SES Descriptive Norms

Table 4.15: Average effects on application and access to early childcare by level of education and descriptive social norms

	Descriptiv eNorms	SES	Early childcare application			Early childcare access		
			Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Informatio n +	Minority	High	0.64*** (0.07)	0.06 (0.06)	0.12 (0.11)	0.45*** (0.07)	0.08 (0.06)	0.16 (0.11)

	Descriptiv eNorms	SES	Early childcare application			Early childcare access		
			Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Support vs Control								
			[0.48, 0.80]	[-0.07, 0.20]	[-0.13, 0.37]	[0.30, 0.59]	[-0.05, 0.21]	[-0.08, 0.39]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.500	adj.p.val. = 0.492	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.154	adj.p.val. = 0.136
		Low	0.49*** (0.07)	0.16*** (0.06)	0.28*** (0.10)	0.21*** (0.05)	0.11* (0.06)	0.20* (0.11)
			[0.35, 0.64]	[0.03, 0.28]	[0.05, 0.51]	[0.10, 0.33]	[-0.02, 0.24]	[-0.04, 0.44]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.013	adj.p.val. = 0.015	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.115	adj.p.val. = 0.122
	Majority	High	0.91*** (0.02)	0.00 (0.02)	0.01 (0.04)	0.78*** (0.03)	-0.01 (0.03)	-0.01 (0.07)
			[0.86, 0.96]	[-0.04, 0.05]	[-0.09, 0.11]	[0.71, 0.85]	[-0.08, 0.07]	[-0.16, 0.14]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.860	adj.p.val. = 0.860	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.980	adj.p.val. = 0.980
		Low	0.71*** (0.06)	0.04 (0.07)	0.08 (0.13)	0.52*** (0.05)	-0.03 (0.07)	-0.06 (0.14)
			[0.58, 0.84]	[-0.11, 0.19]	[-0.21, 0.38]	[0.40, 0.64]	[-0.18, 0.12]	[-0.36, 0.25]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.554	adj.p.val. = 0.547	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.891	adj.p.val. = 0.890
Num.Obs.			1946	1946	1946	1946	1946	1946
R2			0.748	0.474	0.487	0.610	0.402	0.407
R2 Adj.			0.697	0.367	0.383	0.531	0.280	0.286
Fixed effects			X	X	X	X	X	X
Mean F-stat 1st stage					147			147

*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference using themethod.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-value are reported at the bottom of the table.

4.2.4.2 Prescriptive norms

Following Steinberg & Kleinert (2021), we relied on a measure that assessed whether parents anticipated disapproval from friends and relatives if they used early childcare. Overall, our analyses suggest that the expectation of disapproval is not a significant determinant of observed disparities by SES and migration background, as shown in Table 4.16 and 4.18. Firstly, in the control group, we observed only small differences in the application and access to early childcare – never exceeding 6 percentage points – between households that expected social disapproval and those that did not. Secondly, we found no heterogeneous treatment effect of our interventions in relation to prescriptive norms, at least for early childcare as a whole.

4.2.4.3 Effects of the Information-only treatment on early childcare application and access

4.2.4.3.1 Effects of the Information + Support treatment on early childcare application and access

Table 4.16: Average effects on application and access to early childcare by whether the household expect friends and relatives to look at them askance if they use early childcare

	Group	***Early childcare application***			***Early childcare access***		
		Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Information + Support vs Control	Expect disapproval	0.72*** (0.05)	0.05 (0.04)	0.11 (0.08)	0.53*** (0.05)	0.02 (0.06)	0.04 (0.11)
		[0.61, 0.82]	[-0.05, 0.15]	[-0.08, 0.29]	[0.42, 0.64]	[-0.11, 0.15]	[-0.20, 0.27]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.333	adj.p.val. = 0.200	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.746	adj.p.val. = 0.746
	Don't expect disapproval	0.78*** (0.04)	0.05* (0.03)	0.10* (0.05)	0.61*** (0.05)	0.03 (0.03)	0.05 (0.06)
		[0.70, 0.87]	[-0.02, 0.12]	[-0.03, 0.22]	[0.50, 0.71]	[-0.05, 0.11]	[-0.09, 0.19]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.194	adj.p.val. = 0.145	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.685	adj.p.val. = 0.605
Num.Obs.		2906	2906	1946	2906	2906	1946
R2		0.718	0.432	0.446	0.553	0.383	0.386
R2 Adj.		0.661	0.316	0.334	0.462	0.257	0.261
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X	X	X
Mean F-stat 1st stage				297			297

*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Adjusted standard errors robust to cluster-heteroskedasticity at the block level.

Group	Early childcare application			Early childcare access		
	Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT

Adjusted p-values and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference using the Westfall method.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-values are reported at the bottom of the table.

4.2.4.3.2 Effects of the Information-only treatment on daycare application and access

Table 4.17: Average effects of the information only treatment on application and access to daycare by whether the household expect friends and relatives to look at them askance if they are using early childcare

	Group	Daycare application		Daycare access	
		Control mean	ITT	Control mean	ITT
Information only vs Control	Expect disapproval	0.57*** (0.05)	-0.04 (0.05)	0.20*** (0.03)	-0.01 (0.04)
		[0.46, 0.68]	[-0.15, 0.08]	[0.13, 0.27]	[-0.10, 0.08]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.469	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.839
	Don't expect disapproval	0.63*** (0.03)	0.05 (0.04)	0.23*** (0.02)	-0.01 (0.03)
		[0.55, 0.71]	[-0.05, 0.16]	[0.18, 0.28]	[-0.08, 0.06]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.361	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.695
Num.Obs.		2906	2906	2906	2906
R2		0.553	0.293	0.246	0.185
R2 Adj.		0.462	0.149	0.092	0.019
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X

*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-value are reported at the bottom of the table.

4.2.4.3.3 Effects of the Information + Support treatment on daycare application and access

Table 4.18: Average effects of the information only treatment on application and access to daycare by whether the household expect friends and relatives to look at them askance if they are using early childcare

	Group	***Daycare application***			***Daycare access***		
		Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Information + Support vs Control	Expect disapproval	0.59*** (0.05)	0.07 (0.05)	0.13 (0.09)	0.23*** (0.03)	0.02 (0.04)	0.04 (0.08)
		[0.48, 0.71]	[-0.04, 0.18]	[-0.07, 0.34]	[0.15, 0.30]	[-0.07, 0.12]	[-0.13, 0.22]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.261	adj.p.val. = 0.145	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.839	adj.p.val. = 0.608
	Don't expect disapproval	0.60*** (0.04)	0.10*** (0.04)	0.19*** (0.07)	0.22*** (0.02)	0.08** (0.03)	0.14** (0.06)
		[0.52, 0.68]	[0.01, 0.19]	[0.03, 0.34]	[0.16, 0.27]	[0.00, 0.15]	[0.01, 0.27]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.022	adj.p.val. = 0.014	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.030	adj.p.val. = 0.020
Num.Obs.		2906	2906	1946	2906	2906	1946
R2		0.553	0.293	0.314	0.246	0.185	0.186
R2 Adj.		0.462	0.149	0.175	0.092	0.019	0.020
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X	X	X
Mean F-stat 1st stage				297			297

*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block level.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-values are reported at the bottom of the table.

The observation that our intervention influenced daycare application and access, but not early childcare, indicates that our treatment facilitated households with favorable prescriptive norms in selecting their preferred type of early childcare facility, rather than merely enhancing access to any form of early childcare.

4.2.4.3.4 Interaction SES Prescriptive Norms

Table 4.19: Average effects on application and access to early childcare by level of education and perceived prescriptive norms

	Norms	SES	Early childcare application			Early childcare access		
			Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Information + Support vs Control	Yes	High	0.78*** (0.05)	0.04 (0.05)	0.07 (0.09)	0.61*** (0.06)	0.02 (0.07)	0.04 (0.14)
			[0.67, 0.89]	[-0.07, 0.14]	[-0.14, 0.27]	[0.48, 0.73]	[-0.13, 0.18]	[-0.26, 0.34]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.652	adj.p.val. = 0.635	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.753	adj.p.val. = 0.752
		Low	0.60*** (0.08)	0.09 (0.08)	0.17 (0.16)	0.39*** (0.07)	0.01 (0.09)	0.02 (0.18)
			[0.43, 0.77]	[-0.09, 0.27]	[-0.18, 0.53]	[0.23, 0.55]	[-0.19, 0.21]	[-0.38, 0.42]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.284	adj.p.val. = 0.279	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.908	adj.p.val. = 0.909
	No	High	0.89*** (0.03)	0.02 (0.03)	0.04 (0.07)	0.76*** (0.04)	0.00 (0.04)	-0.01 (0.08)
			[0.82, 0.96]	[-0.06, 0.10]	[-0.11, 0.19]	[0.67, 0.85]	[-0.09, 0.08]	[-0.18, 0.16]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.777	adj.p.val. = 0.775	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.975	adj.p.val. = 0.975
		Low	0.57*** (0.06)	0.11** (0.06)	0.19** (0.09)	0.31*** (0.05)	0.09 (0.06)	0.16 (0.10)
			[0.43, 0.72]	[-0.01, 0.24]	[-0.01, 0.40]	[0.20, 0.43]	[-0.04, 0.22]	[-0.07, 0.38]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.083	adj.p.val. = 0.074	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.206	adj.p.val. = 0.211
Num.Obs.			1946	1946	1946	1946	1946	1946
R2			0.728	0.439	0.448	0.577	0.387	0.388
R2 Adj.			0.671	0.323	0.334	0.489	0.260	0.262
Fixed effects			X	X	X	X	X	X
Mean F-stat 1st stage					154			154

*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference using themethod.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-value are reported at the bottom of the table.

4.3 Structural barriers

Overall, our findings indicated that accessibility barriers, particularly shortages of available slots, represented the primary obstacle encountered by households. As shown in Figure ??, the majority of households that applied yet did not use any early childcare reported that their applications were either rejected (47%), that they are still awaiting a response (23.4%), or that they are on a waiting list (14.8%). This suggests the presence of accessibility barriers. However, the reasons for their rejection on the supply-side remain unknown, presenting an opportunity for further investigation in future studies.

{r GraphReasonsNoECS, echo=FALSE,out.width='100%', results='asis', cache=TRUE, fig.cap="Households' perceived reasons for failing to secure an early childcare slot "}

Results for a second item in the endline questionnaire, which tackled the reasons why households did not use they preferred mode of childcare, are displayed in Figure 4.1 and Figure 4.2 below. We split answers by SES and migration background:

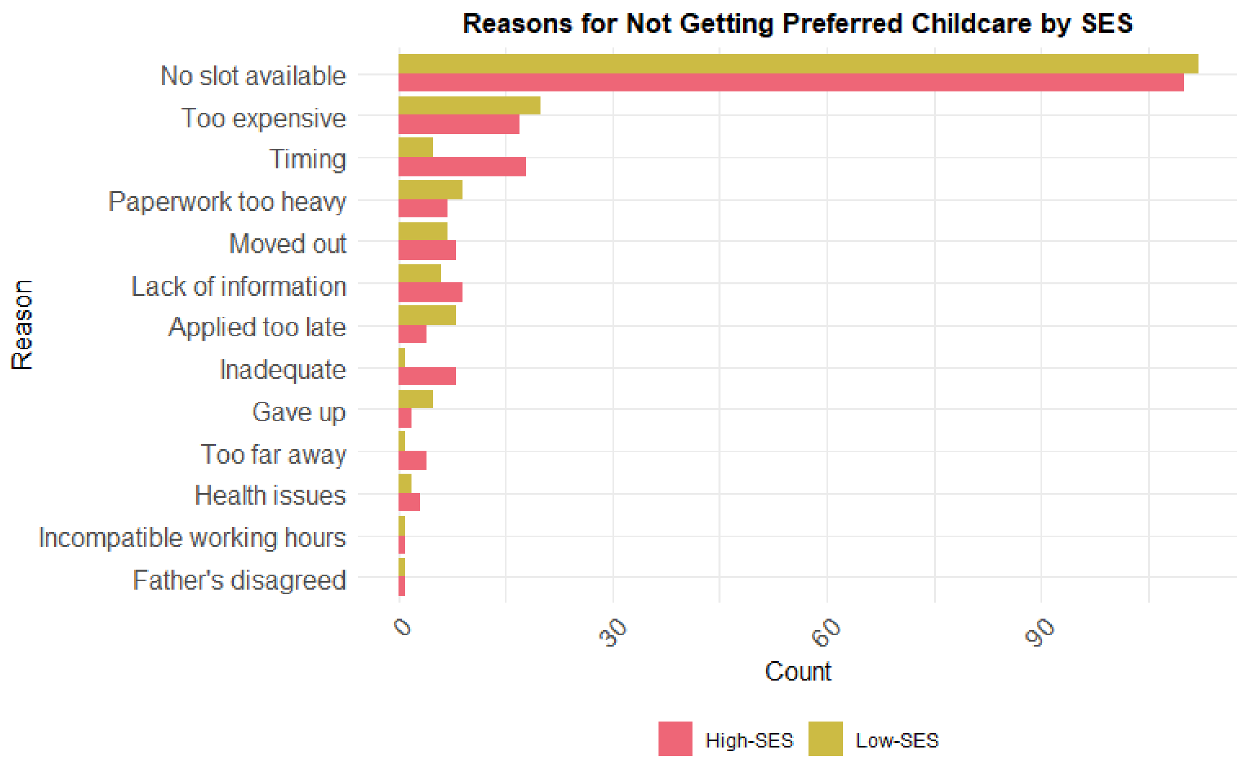


Figure 4.1: Main reasons why households did not use they preferred mode of childcare, by SES

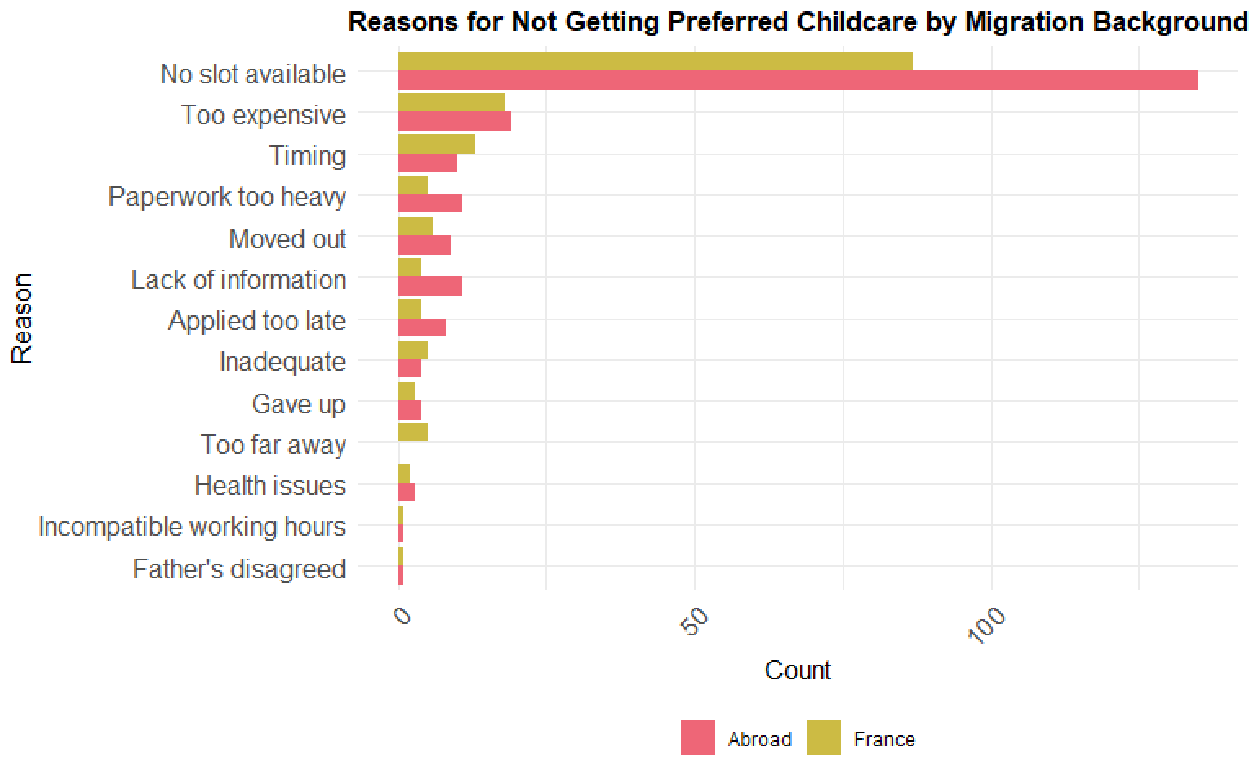


Figure 4.2: Main reasons why households did not use their preferred mode of childcare, by migration background

4.3.1 Average effects of the information + support treatment on early childcare and daycare application and access by province

The effectiveness of our interventions varies substantially according to the local context. On the one hand, all effects on applications for low-SES households are concentrated outside of Paris, which could be consistent with a ceiling effect. In Paris, where the supply of early childcare in general and daycare specifically are the highest in France, inequalities were found to be very low in our sample, and thus, we found no effects of our intervention on application. On the other hand, all effects on daycare access for high-SES households were concentrated in Paris

4.3.1.1 Early childcare

Table 4.20: Average effects on application and access to early childcare by level of education and province of residence at baseline (75: Paris, 93: Seine-Saint-Denis, 94: Val de Marne)

	Province	**Education**	***Early childcare application***			***Early childcare access***		
			Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Information + Support vs Control	94	High	0.80*** (0.05)	0.05 (0.03)	0.11 (0.07)	0.63*** (0.06)	0.04 (0.07)	0.07 (0.14)
			[0.69, 0.91]	[-0.02, 0.13]	[-0.05, 0.28]	[0.49, 0.77]	[-0.11, 0.18]	[-0.23, 0.38]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.110	adj.p.val. = 0.124	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.586	adj.p.val. = 0.592
		Low	0.54*** (0.08)	0.13* (0.07)	0.30* (0.16)	0.27*** (0.06)	0.09 (0.07)	0.20 (0.16)
			[0.36, 0.71]	[-0.03, 0.30]	[-0.06, 0.66]	[0.14, 0.40]	[-0.07, 0.25]	[-0.15, 0.56]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.120	adj.p.val. = 0.125	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.204	adj.p.val. = 0.206
	75	High	0.88*** (0.03)	0.02 (0.03)	0.04 (0.06)	0.78*** (0.05)	-0.02 (0.05)	-0.04 (0.10)
			[0.81, 0.95]	[-0.06, 0.09]	[-0.10, 0.18]	[0.67, 0.88]	[-0.13, 0.09]	[-0.26, 0.18]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.780	adj.p.val. = 0.772	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.796	adj.p.val. = 0.793
		Low	0.76*** (0.08)	0.02 (0.07)	0.03 (0.10)	0.52*** (0.09)	0.00 (0.09)	0.00 (0.14)
			[0.58, 0.95]	[-0.13, 0.17]	[-0.20, 0.26]	[0.33, 0.70]	[-0.19, 0.20]	[-0.29, 0.30]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.928	adj.p.val. = 0.929	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.996	adj.p.val. = 0.996
	93	High	0.84*** (0.06)	-0.03 (0.05)	-0.05 (0.08)	0.68*** (0.07)	0.01 (0.06)	0.01 (0.10)
			[0.71, 0.97]	[-0.14, 0.08]	[-0.24, 0.13]	[0.53, 0.82]	[-0.13, 0.14]	[-0.21, 0.23]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.538	adj.p.val. = 0.537	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.929	adj.p.val. = 0.929
		Low	0.44*** (0.09)	0.21* (0.12)	0.37* (0.21)	0.24*** (0.09)	0.03 (0.13)	0.05 (0.23)
			[0.23, 0.65]	[-0.05, 0.47]	[-0.10, 0.84]	[0.04, 0.44]	[-0.25, 0.31]	[-0.45, 0.55]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.142	adj.p.val. = 0.153	adj.p.val. = 0.008	adj.p.val. = 0.825	adj.p.val. = 0.829
Num.Obs.			1946	1946	1946	1946	1946	1946

	Province	Education	Early childcare application			Early childcare access		
			Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
R2			0.743	0.469	0.474	0.617	0.430	0.415
R2 Adj.			0.671	0.320	0.327	0.510	0.271	0.252
Fixed effects			X	X	X	X	X	X
Mean F-stat 1st stage					106			106

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Adjusted standard errors robust to cluster-heteroskedasticity at the block level.
Adjusted p-values and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference using the Westfall method.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-values are reported at the bottom of the table.

4.3.1.2 Daycare

Table 4.21: Average effects on application and access to daycare by level of education and province of residence at baseline (75: Paris, 93: Seine-Saint-Denis, 94: Val de Marne)

	Province	Education	Daycare application			Daycare access		
			Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Information + Support vs Control	94	High	0.58*** (0.05)	0.09* (0.05)	0.18* (0.11)	0.15*** (0.03)	0.03 (0.05)	0.07 (0.11)
			[0.46, 0.70]	[-0.03, 0.20]	[-0.06, 0.42]	[0.08, 0.22]	[-0.08, 0.15]	[-0.18, 0.32]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.170	adj.p.val. = 0.174	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.638	adj.p.val. = 0.633
		Low	0.34*** (0.07)	0.21** (0.09)	0.47** (0.22)	0.07** (0.03)	0.06 (0.05)	0.13 (0.12)
			[0.18, 0.49]	[0.01, 0.41]	[0.00, 0.95]	[0.00, 0.13]	[-0.06, 0.17]	[-0.14, 0.39]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.036	adj.p.val. = 0.051	adj.p.val. = 0.052	adj.p.val. = 0.324	adj.p.val. = 0.327
	75	High	0.72*** (0.04)	0.13** (0.06)	0.26** (0.10)	0.34*** (0.04)	0.12** (0.05)	0.23** (0.10)
			[0.63, 0.82]	[0.02, 0.25]	[0.05, 0.48]	[0.25, 0.43]	[0.00, 0.24]	[0.00, 0.46]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.025	adj.p.val. = 0.015	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.058	adj.p.val. = 0.052

	Province	Education	Daycare application			Daycare access		
			Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
		Low	0.66*** (0.08)	-0.01 (0.09)	-0.02 (0.13)	0.40*** (0.08)	-0.06 (0.09)	-0.09 (0.13)
			[0.48, 0.84]	[-0.21, 0.18]	[-0.31, 0.27]	[0.22, 0.57]	[-0.25, 0.14]	[-0.37, 0.20]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.870	adj.p.val. = 0.881	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.520	adj.p.val. = 0.509
	93	High	0.65*** (0.07)	0.04 (0.08)	0.07 (0.13)	0.16*** (0.06)	0.12 (0.09)	0.20 (0.16)
			[0.50, 0.80]	[-0.13, 0.21]	[-0.22, 0.35]	[0.03, 0.29]	[-0.09, 0.32]	[-0.15, 0.54]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.604	adj.p.val. = 0.602	adj.p.val. = 0.008	adj.p.val. = 0.221	adj.p.val. = 0.211
		Low	0.28*** (0.07)	0.22* (0.12)	0.39* (0.20)	0.09* (0.05)	0.03 (0.09)	0.05 (0.15)
			[0.11, 0.45]	[-0.04, 0.48]	[-0.06, 0.84]	[-0.02, 0.19]	[-0.16, 0.22]	[-0.29, 0.39]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.106	adj.p.val. = 0.105	adj.p.val. = 0.091	adj.p.val. = 0.928	adj.p.val. = 0.931
Num.Obs.			1946	1946	1946	1946	1946	1946
R2			0.595	0.351	0.366	0.336	0.266	0.257
R2 Adj.			0.482	0.170	0.189	0.151	0.061	0.050
Fixed effects			X	X	X	X	X	X
Mean F-stat 1st stage					106			106

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Adjusted standard errors robust to cluster-heteroskedasticity at the block level.
Adjusted p-values and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference using the Westfall method.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-values are reported at the bottom of the table.

5 Part 5: Robustness checks

5.1 Sensitivity analysis of the main results: SES measurment

To ensure the robustness of the findings, we tested alternative definitions of socioeconomic status. Specifically, we considered mother's occupation using the International Socio-Economic Index of Occupational Status (ISEI) and a composite SES score that accounts for the highest occupation score and the highest education level in the household. As depicted below, the patterns of results remain constant with these definitions of SES.

5.1.1 Information-only treatment

5.1.1.1 Heterogeneous effects of the information-only treatment on early childcare applications

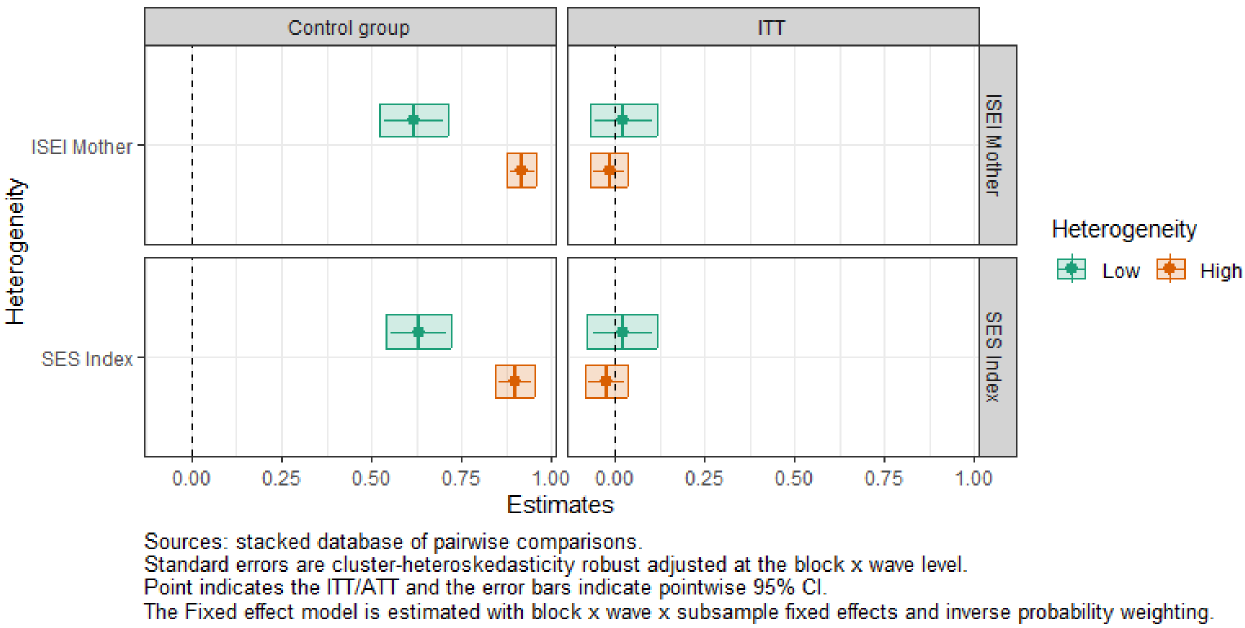


Figure 1: Heterogeneous effects of the information-only treatment on early childcare applications using ISEI of the Mother and the SES index.

5.1.1.2 Heterogeneous effects of the information-only treatment on early childcare access

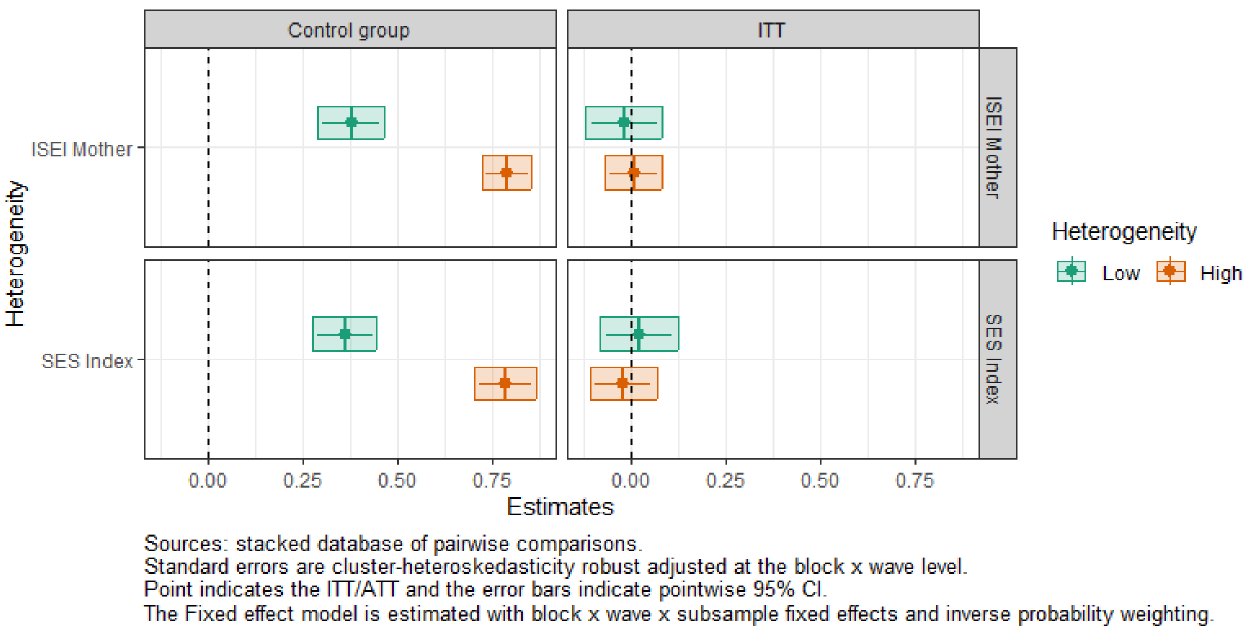
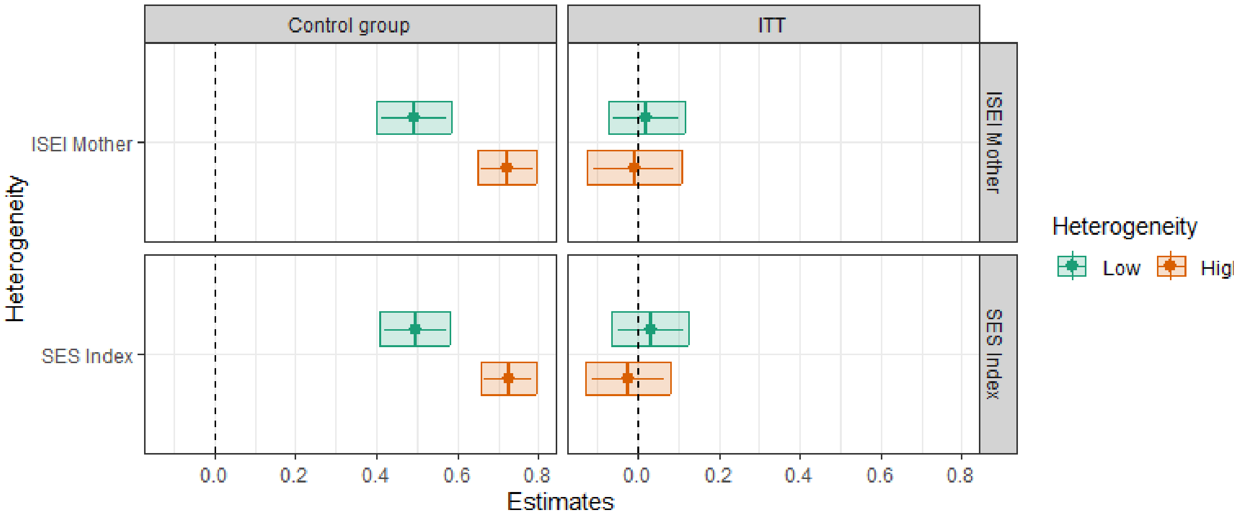


Figure 2: Heterogeneous effects of the information-only treatment on early childcare access using ISEI of the Mother and the SES index.

5.1.1.3 Heterogeneous effects of the information-only treatment on daycare applications



Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Point indicates the ITT and the error bars indicate pointwise 95% CI.
The Fixed effect model is estimated with block x wave x subsample fixed effects and inverse probability weighting.

Figure 3: Heterogeneous effects of the information-only treatment on daycare applications using ISEI of the Mother and the SES index.

5.1.1.4 Heterogeneous effects of the information-only treatment on daycare access

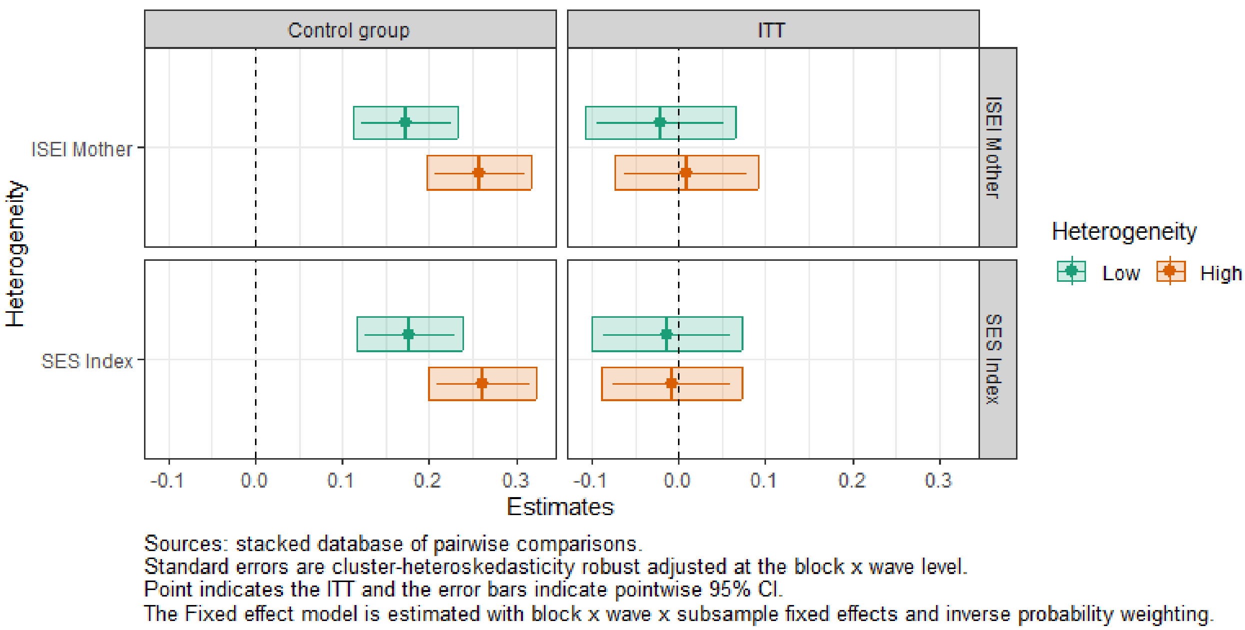


Figure 5: Heterogeneous effects of the information-only treatment on early childcare access using ISEI of the Mother and the SES index.

5.1.1.5 Table: Heterogeneous effects of the information-only treatment on early childcare and daycare applications and access by SES as measured by the occupation status of the mother (ISEI)

Table 5.1: Average effects on daycare application and access by ISEI Mother

	Group	***Application***				***Access***			
		Early childcare		*Daycare*		*Early childcare*		*Daycare*	
		Control mean	ITT	Control mean	ITT	Control mean	ITT	Control mean	ITT
Information-only vs Control	High	0.92*** (0.02)	-0.02 (0.02)	0.72*** (0.03)	-0.01 (0.05)	0.26*** (0.03)	0.01 (0.04)	0.26*** (0.03)	0.01 (0.04)
		[0.88, 0.96]	[-0.07, 0.03]	[0.65, 0.79]	[-0.13, 0.11]	[0.20, 0.32]	[-0.07, 0.09]	[0.20, 0.32]	[-0.07, 0.09]

Group		Application				Access			
		Early childcare		Daycare		Early childcare		Daycare	
		Control mean	ITT	Control mean	ITT	Control mean	ITT	Control mean	ITT
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.698	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.870	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.797	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.797
	Low	0.62*** (0.04)	0.02 (0.04)	0.49*** (0.04)	0.02 (0.04)	0.17*** (0.03)	-0.02 (0.04)	0.17*** (0.03)	-0.02 (0.04)
		[0.52, 0.71]	[-0.07, 0.12]	[0.40, 0.59]	[-0.07, 0.12]	[0.11, 0.23]	[-0.11, 0.06]	[0.11, 0.23]	[-0.11, 0.06]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.535	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.592	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.566	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.566
Num.Obs.		2854	2854	2854	2854	2854	2854	2854	2854
R2		0.732	0.432	0.558	0.294	0.259	0.173	0.259	0.173
R2 Adj.		0.682	0.325	0.474	0.161	0.119	0.017	0.119	0.017
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-value are reported at the bottom of the table.

5.1.1.6 Table: Heterogeneous effects of the information-only treatment on early childcare and daycare applications and access by SES as measured by the composite index of SES

Table 5.2: Average effects on daycare application and access by SES Index

Group		Application				Access			
		Early childcare		Daycare		Early childcare		Daycare	
		Control mean	ITT	Control mean	ITT	Control mean	ITT	Control mean	ITT
Information-only vs Control	High	0.90*** (0.02)	-0.02 (0.02)	0.73*** (0.03)	-0.02 (0.04)	0.78*** (0.03)	-0.02 (0.04)	0.26*** (0.03)	-0.01 (0.03)
		[0.84, 0.95]	[-0.08, 0.04]	[0.66, 0.79]	[-0.13, 0.08]	[0.70, 0.87]	[-0.11, 0.07]	[0.20, 0.32]	[-0.09, 0.07]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.689	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.602	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.787	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.820
	Low	0.63*** (0.04)	0.02 (0.04)	0.50*** (0.04)	0.03 (0.04)	0.36*** (0.04)	0.02 (0.04)	0.18*** (0.03)	-0.01 (0.04)

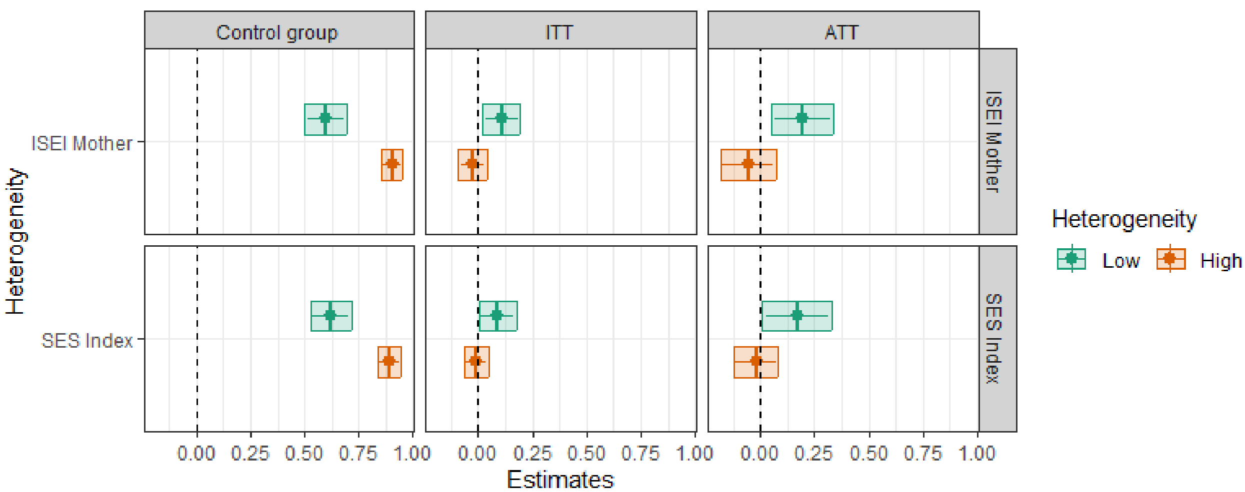
Group	Application				Access			
	Early childcare		*Daycare*		*Early childcare*		*Daycare*	
	Control mean	ITT	Control mean	ITT	Control mean	ITT	Control mean	ITT
	[0.54, 0.72]	[-0.08, 0.12]	[0.41, 0.58]	[-0.06, 0.13]	[0.28, 0.44]	[-0.08, 0.12]	[0.12, 0.24]	[-0.10, 0.07]
	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.606	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.429	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.628	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.710
Num.Obs.	2904	2904	2904	2904	2904	2904	2904	2904
R2	0.735	0.429	0.559	0.289	0.611	0.391	0.263	0.174
R2 Adj.	0.688	0.328	0.480	0.163	0.542	0.283	0.132	0.027
Fixed effects	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-value are reported at the bottom of the table.

5.1.2 Information + support treatment

5.1.2.1 Heterogeneous effects of the information + support treatment on early childcare applications

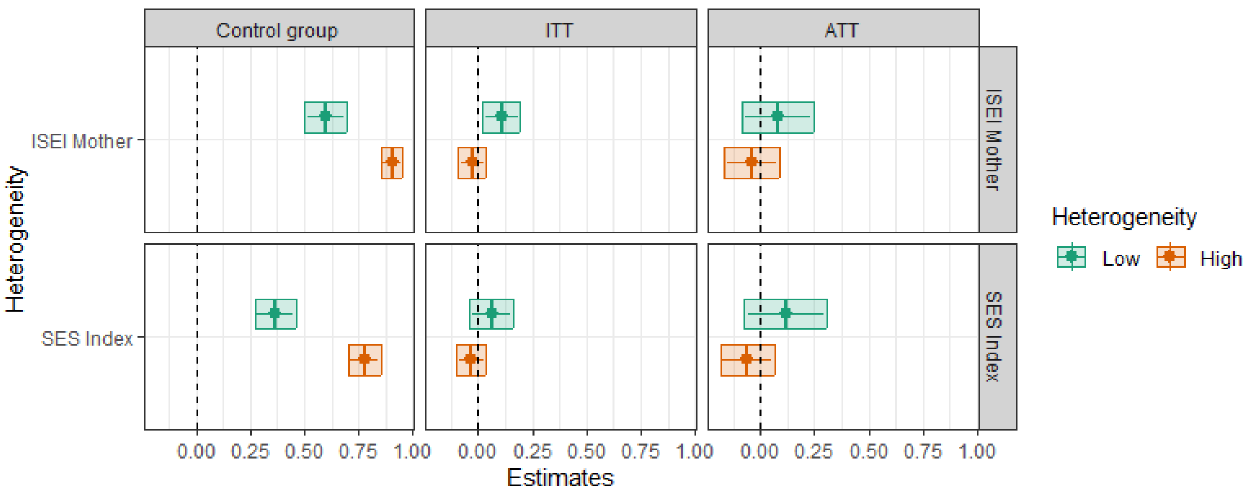
terogeneous ITT and ATT of the information + personalised administrative support treatment on early childcare application



Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Point indicates the ITT/ATT and the error bars indicate pointwise 95% CI.
The Fixed effect model is estimated with block x wave x subsample fixed effects and inverse probability weighting.

5.1.2.2 Heterogeneous effects of the information + support treatment on early childcare access

terogeneous ITT and ATT of the information + personalised administrative support treatment on early childcare access



Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Point indicates the ITT/ATT and the error bars indicate pointwise 95% CI.
The Fixed effect model is estimated with block x wave x subsample fixed effects and inverse probability weighting.

5.1.2.3 Table: heterogenous effects of the information + support treatment on early childcare applications and access using the occupation status of the mother (ISEI)

Table 5.3: Average effects on early childcare application and access by ISEI Mother

	Group	***Application***			***Access***		
		Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Information + Support vs Control	High	0.90*** (0.02)	-0.03 (0.03)	-0.06 (0.06)	0.78*** (0.03)	-0.02 (0.03)	-0.04 (0.06)
		[0.86, 0.95]	[-0.09, 0.04]	[-0.18, 0.07]	[0.71, 0.85]	[-0.08, 0.05]	[-0.17, 0.09]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.617	adj.p.val. = 0.523	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.796	adj.p.val. = 0.719
	Low	0.60*** (0.04)	0.11*** (0.04)	0.19*** (0.06)	0.36*** (0.04)	0.05 (0.04)	0.08 (0.08)
		[0.50, 0.69]	[0.02, 0.20]	[0.05, 0.34]	[0.28, 0.45]	[-0.05, 0.15]	[-0.09, 0.25]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.008	adj.p.val. = 0.006	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.448	adj.p.val. = 0.275

	Group	Application			Access		
		Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Num.Obs.		2854	2854	1914	2854	2854	1914
R2		0.732	0.432	0.438	0.606	0.408	0.401
R2 Adj.		0.682	0.325	0.332	0.532	0.296	0.288
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X	X	X
Mean F-stat 1st stage				296			296

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-value are reported at the bottom of the table.

5.1.2.4 Table: heterogenous effects of the information + support treatment on early childcare applications and access using the composite index of SES

Table 5.4: Average effects on early childcare application and access by SES Index

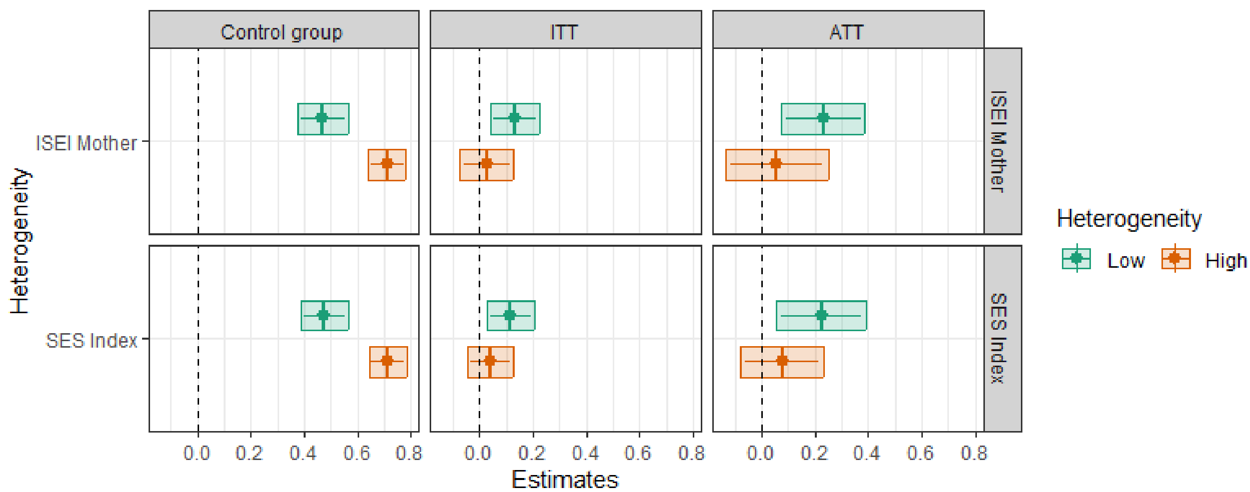
	Group	Application			Access		
		Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Information + Support vs Control	High	0.89*** (0.02)	-0.01 (0.02)	-0.02 (0.05)	0.78*** (0.03)	-0.03 (0.03)	-0.06 (0.06)
		[0.84, 0.95]	[-0.07, 0.05]	[-0.12, 0.09]	[0.70, 0.85]	[-0.10, 0.04]	[-0.18, 0.07]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.891	adj.p.val. = 0.892	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.562	adj.p.val. = 0.482
	Low	0.62*** (0.04)	0.09** (0.04)	0.17** (0.07)	0.37*** (0.04)	0.06 (0.04)	0.12 (0.09)
		[0.53, 0.72]	[0.00, 0.18]	[0.01, 0.33]	[0.27, 0.46]	[-0.04, 0.16]	[-0.07, 0.31]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.046	adj.p.val. = 0.036	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.359	adj.p.val. = 0.299
Num.Obs.		2904	2904	1944	2904	2904	1944
R2		0.735	0.429	0.435	0.611	0.391	0.377
R2 Adj.		0.688	0.328	0.335	0.542	0.283	0.267
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X	X	X

	Group	Application			Access		
		Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Mean F-stat 1st stage				288			288

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-value are reported at the bottom of the table.

5.1.2.5 Heterogeneous effects of the information + support treatment on daycare applications

terogeneous ITT and ATT of the information + personalised administrative support treatment on daycare application



Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Point indicates the ITT/ATT and the error bars indicate pointwise 95% CI.
The Fixed effect model is estimated with block x wave x subsample fixed effects and inverse probability weighting.

Figure 1: Heterogeneous effects of the information + support treatment on early childcare applications using ISEI of the Mother and the SES index.

5.1.2.6 Heterogeneous effects of the information + support treatment on daycare access

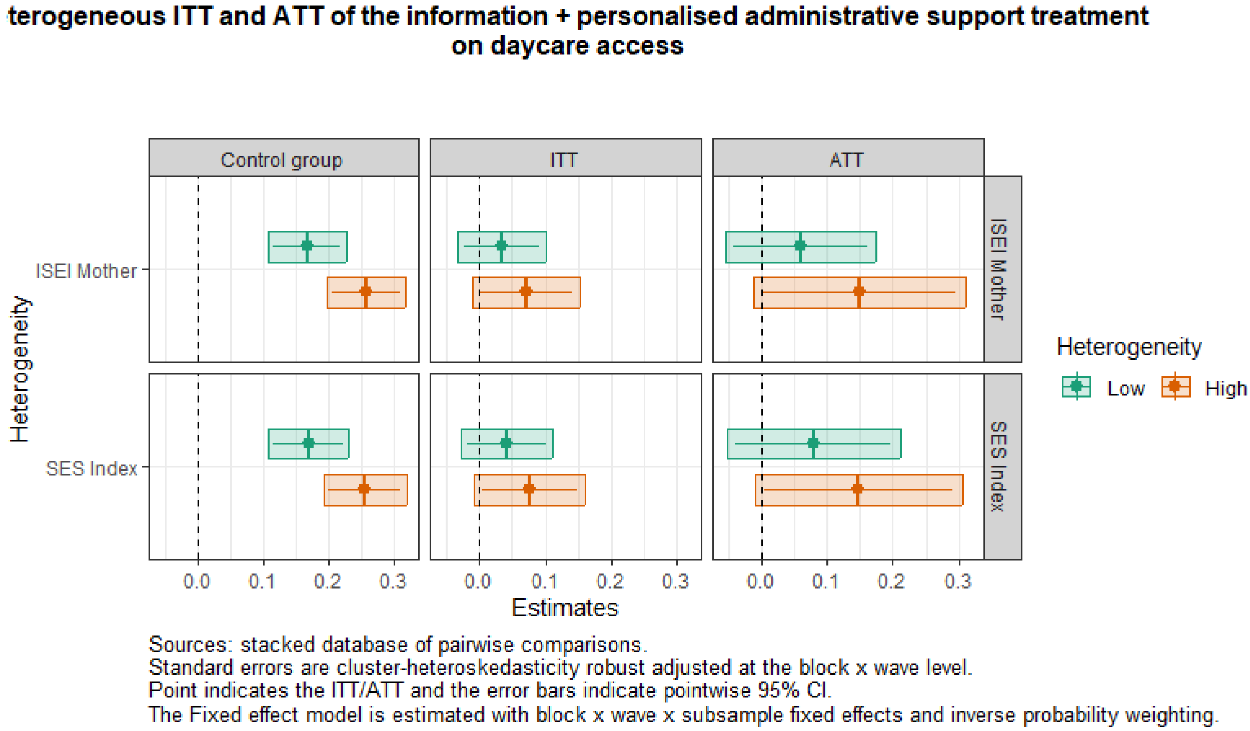


Figure 1: Heterogeneous effects of the information + support treatment on daycare access using ISEI of the Mother and the SES index.

5.1.2.7 Table: heterogenous effects of the information + support treatment on daycare applications and access using the occupation status of the mother (ISEI)

Table 5.5: Average effects on daycare application and access by ISEI Mother

	Group	***Application***			***Access***		
		Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Information + Support vs Control	High	0.71*** (0.03)	0.03 (0.04)	0.06 (0.09)	0.26*** (0.03)	0.07** (0.04)	0.15** (0.07)
		[0.64, 0.78]	[-0.07, 0.13]	[-0.14, 0.25]	[0.20, 0.32]	[-0.01, 0.15]	[-0.01, 0.31]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.754	adj.p.val. = 0.578	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.101	adj.p.val. = 0.077

	Group	Application			Access		
		Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
	Low	0.47*** (0.04)	0.13*** (0.04)	0.23*** (0.07)	0.17*** (0.03)	0.03 (0.03)	0.06 (0.05)
		[0.37, 0.56]	[0.04, 0.22]	[0.08, 0.39]	[0.11, 0.23]	[-0.03, 0.10]	[-0.06, 0.17]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.003	adj.p.val. = 0.002	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.393	adj.p.val. = 0.249
Num.Obs.		2854	2854	1914	2854	2854	1914
R2		0.558	0.294	0.310	0.259	0.173	0.172
R2 Adj.		0.474	0.161	0.180	0.119	0.017	0.016
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X	X	X
Mean F-stat 1st stage				296			296

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-value are reported at the bottom of the table.

5.1.2.8 Table: heterogenous effects of the information + support treatment on daycare applications and access using the composite index of SES

Table 5.6: Average effects on daycare application and access by SES Index

	Group	Application			Access		
		Daycare					
		Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Information + Support vs Control	High	0.71*** (0.03)	0.04 (0.04)	0.08 (0.07)	0.26*** (0.03)	0.08** (0.04)	0.15** (0.07)
		[0.64, 0.78]	[-0.05, 0.13]	[-0.08, 0.23]	[0.19, 0.32]	[-0.01, 0.16]	[-0.01, 0.30]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.455	adj.p.val. = 0.375	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.092	adj.p.val. = 0.069
	Low	0.48*** (0.04)	0.12*** (0.04)	0.22*** (0.08)	0.17*** (0.03)	0.04 (0.03)	0.08 (0.06)
		[0.39, 0.56]	[0.03, 0.20]	[0.06, 0.39]	[0.11, 0.23]	[-0.03, 0.11]	[-0.05, 0.21]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.006	adj.p.val. = 0.006	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.368	adj.p.val. = 0.326

Group	Application			Access		
	Daycare					
	Control mean	ITT	ATT	Control mean	ITT	ATT
Num.Obs.	2904	2904	1944	2904	2904	1944
R2	0.559	0.289	0.306	0.263	0.174	0.169
R2 Adj.	0.480	0.163	0.184	0.132	0.027	0.023
Fixed effects	X	X	X	X	X	X
Mean F-stat 1st stage			288			288

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust adjusted at the block x wave level.
Adjusted p-value and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-value are reported at the bottom of the table.

5.2 Sensitivity analysis of the main results: migration background measurment

5.2.1 Information-only treatment

5.2.1.1 Heterogeneous effects of the information-only treatment on early childcare applications and access

Table 5.7: Average gaps and heterogeneous treatment effects of the information-only treatment on early childcare application and access - Migration Background robustness checks

	Variable	Group	Early childcare application		Early childcare access	
			Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT
Information-only vs control	MigrationBackground	Yes	0.66*** (0.05)	0.00 (0.04)	0.40*** (0.05)	-0.02 (0.05)
			[0.55, 0.77]	[-0.09, 0.09]	[0.28, 0.52]	[-0.15, 0.11]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.941	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.737
		No	0.82*** (0.03)	-0.01 (0.03)	0.69*** (0.04)	-0.03 (0.03)
			[0.75, 0.89]	[-0.07, 0.05]	[0.61, 0.77]	[-0.09, 0.04]

Variable	Group	Early childcare application		Early childcare access	
		Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.834	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.631
MigrationBackgroundOneOfTheTwo	Yes	0.67*** (0.04)	-0.01 (0.03)	0.43*** (0.04)	-0.01 (0.04)
		[0.58, 0.76]	[-0.09, 0.07]	[0.33, 0.52]	[-0.11, 0.08]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.822	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.737
	No	0.86*** (0.03)	0.00 (0.03)	0.76*** (0.04)	-0.02 (0.04)
		[0.80, 0.93]	[-0.07, 0.07]	[0.67, 0.84]	[-0.11, 0.07]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.939	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.814
MigrationBackgroundParent2	Yes	0.64*** (0.05)	0.00 (0.04)	0.42*** (0.04)	-0.02 (0.04)
		[0.53, 0.75]	[-0.09, 0.09]	[0.31, 0.52]	[-0.11, 0.07]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.928	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.658
	No	0.86*** (0.03)	0.00 (0.03)	0.74*** (0.04)	-0.03 (0.04)
		[0.78, 0.93]	[-0.07, 0.06]	[0.65, 0.83]	[-0.12, 0.06]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.998	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.637
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Adjusted standard errors robust to cluster-heteroskedasticity at the block level.
Adjusted p-values and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference using the Westfall method.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-values are reported at the bottom of the table.

5.2.1.2 Heterogeneous effects of the information-only treatment on daycare applications and access

Table 5.8: Average gaps and heterogeneous treatment effects of the information-only treatment on daycare application and access - Migration Background robustness checks

	Variable	***Group***	***Daycare application***		***Daycare access***	
			Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT
Information-only vs control	MigrationBackground	Yes	0.54*** (0.04)	0.05 (0.04)	0.16*** (0.03)	0.02 (0.04)
			[0.44, 0.64]	[-0.05, 0.14]	[0.10, 0.22]	[-0.08, 0.12]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.241	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.656
		No	0.63*** (0.03)	0.00 (0.04)	0.24*** (0.03)	-0.01 (0.04)
			[0.55, 0.71]	[-0.09, 0.09]	[0.18, 0.30]	[-0.10, 0.08]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.974	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.827
	MigrationBackgroundOneOfTheTwo	Yes	0.55*** (0.04)	0.02 (0.04)	0.18*** (0.02)	-0.01 (0.03)
			[0.47, 0.63]	[-0.07, 0.11]	[0.13, 0.24]	[-0.09, 0.07]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.561	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.823
		No	0.66*** (0.04)	0.01 (0.04)	0.26*** (0.03)	-0.01 (0.04)
			[0.57, 0.75]	[-0.09, 0.12]	[0.18, 0.33]	[-0.11, 0.09]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.817	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.798
	MigrationBackgroundParent2	Yes	0.53*** (0.04)	0.03 (0.05)	0.17*** (0.03)	0.00 (0.04)
			[0.44, 0.62]	[-0.08, 0.14]	[0.11, 0.23]	[-0.09, 0.08]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.525	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.895
		No	0.64*** (0.04)	0.01 (0.04)	0.26*** (0.03)	-0.02 (0.04)

Variable	Group	Daycare application		Daycare access	
		Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT
		[0.56, 0.73]	[-0.09, 0.11]	[0.19, 0.33]	[-0.11, 0.06]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.812	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.512
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Adjusted standard errors robust to cluster-heteroskedasticity at the block level.
Adjusted p-values and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference using the Westfall method.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-values are reported at the bottom of the table.

5.2.1.3 Heterogeneous effects of the information + support treatment on early childcare applications and access

Table 5.9: Average gaps and heterogeneous treatment effects of the information + support treatment on early childcare application and access - Migration Background robustness checks

	Variable	Group	Early childcare application			Early childcare access		
			Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT
Information + support vs control	MigrationBackgroundBoth	Yes	0.67*** (0.05)	0.10** (0.04)	0.17** (0.07)	0.40*** (0.05)	0.08 (0.06)	0.13 (0.10)
			[0.55, 0.78]	[0.01, 0.20]	[0.01, 0.32]	[0.28, 0.51]	[-0.06, 0.22]	[-0.08, 0.35]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.035	adj.p.val. = 0.030	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.273	adj.p.val. = 0.168
		No	0.82*** (0.03)	-0.01 (0.03)	-0.02 (0.06)	0.68*** (0.03)	-0.03 (0.03)	-0.06 (0.06)
			[0.74, 0.89]	[-0.07, 0.05]	[-0.15, 0.10]	[0.60, 0.76]	[-0.10, 0.04]	[-0.20, 0.07]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.807	adj.p.val. = 0.705	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.486	adj.p.val. = 0.485
		Yes	0.68*** (0.04)	0.06** (0.03)	0.11** (0.05)	0.45*** (0.04)	0.04 (0.04)	0.07 (0.07)

Variable	Group	Early childcare application			Early childcare access		
		Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT
MigrationBackgroundOneOfTheTwo		[0.59, 0.76]	[-0.01, 0.14]	[-0.01, 0.23]	[0.36, 0.54]	[-0.06, 0.13]	[-0.09, 0.23]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.115	adj.p.val. = 0.085	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.529	adj.p.val. = 0.334
	No	0.85*** (0.03)	0.03 (0.03)	0.07 (0.07)	0.75*** (0.04)	-0.01 (0.04)	-0.02 (0.08)
		[0.78, 0.93]	[-0.04, 0.10]	[-0.09, 0.22]	[0.67, 0.84]	[-0.09, 0.07]	[-0.20, 0.16]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.665	adj.p.val. = 0.551	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.814	adj.p.val. = 0.772
MigrationBackgroundParent2	Yes	0.67*** (0.04)	0.07** (0.04)	0.14** (0.07)	0.44*** (0.04)	0.06 (0.05)	0.11 (0.09)
		[0.57, 0.77]	[-0.01, 0.16]	[-0.01, 0.29]	[0.34, 0.54]	[-0.05, 0.17]	[-0.08, 0.30]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.116	adj.p.val. = 0.083	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.359	adj.p.val. = 0.217
	No	0.86*** (0.03)	0.00 (0.03)	-0.01 (0.06)	0.74*** (0.04)	-0.05 (0.04)	-0.10 (0.08)
		[0.78, 0.93]	[-0.07, 0.07]	[-0.14, 0.13]	[0.66, 0.83]	[-0.14, 0.04]	[-0.26, 0.07]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.998	adj.p.val. = 0.986	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.444	adj.p.val. = 0.358
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X	X	X

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Adjusted standard errors robust to cluster-heteroskedasticity at the block level.
Adjusted p-values and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference using the Westfall method.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-values are reported at the bottom of the table.

5.2.1.4 Heterogeneous effects of the information + support treatment on daycare applications and access

Table 5.10: Average gaps and heterogeneous treatment effects of the information + support treatment on daycare application and access - Migration Background robustness checks

	Variable	Group	Daycare application			Daycare access		
			Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT
Information + support vs control	MigrationBackgroundBoth	Yes	0.57*** (0.05)	0.09* (0.05)	0.15* (0.08)	0.18*** (0.03)	0.06 (0.05)	0.10 (0.08)
			[0.45, 0.69]	[-0.02, 0.21]	[-0.02, 0.32]	[0.10, 0.27]	[-0.06, 0.18]	[-0.08, 0.27]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.134	adj.p.val. = 0.098	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.361	adj.p.val. = 0.221
		No	0.62*** (0.03)	0.05 (0.03)	0.12 (0.07)	0.23*** (0.02)	0.05* (0.03)	0.11* (0.06)
			[0.54, 0.69]	[-0.03, 0.14]	[-0.05, 0.28]	[0.18, 0.29]	[-0.01, 0.12]	[-0.02, 0.24]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.242	adj.p.val. = 0.164	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.139	adj.p.val. = 0.092
	MigrationBackgroundOneOfTheTwo	Yes	0.56*** (0.03)	0.07** (0.03)	0.12** (0.06)	0.21*** (0.03)	0.02 (0.03)	0.04 (0.06)
			[0.48, 0.64]	[-0.01, 0.15]	[0.00, 0.25]	[0.15, 0.27]	[-0.06, 0.10]	[-0.09, 0.17]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.085	adj.p.val. = 0.059	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.720	adj.p.val. = 0.505
		No	0.65*** (0.04)	0.10** (0.05)	0.22** (0.10)	0.24*** (0.03)	0.10** (0.04)	0.21** (0.09)
			[0.56, 0.74]	[-0.01, 0.21]	[-0.02, 0.45]	[0.17, 0.31]	[0.00, 0.19]	[0.01, 0.42]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.097	adj.p.val. = 0.058	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.043	adj.p.val. = 0.031
	MigrationBackgroundParent2	Yes	0.56*** (0.04)	0.07* (0.04)	0.13** (0.07)	0.20*** (0.03)	0.03 (0.04)	0.05 (0.07)
			[0.46, 0.65]	[-0.01, 0.16]	[-0.01, 0.28]	[0.14, 0.26]	[-0.06, 0.12]	[-0.10, 0.21]
			adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.122	adj.p.val. = 0.086	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.681	adj.p.val. = 0.500
		No	0.64*** (0.04)	0.08* (0.04)	0.15* (0.08)	0.24*** (0.03)	0.06* (0.03)	0.12* (0.07)

Variable	Group	Daycare application			Daycare access		
		Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT	Avg. control	Conditional ITT	Conditional ATT
		[0.56, 0.72]	[-0.02, 0.17]	[-0.03, 0.34]	[0.18, 0.30]	[-0.02, 0.14]	[-0.04, 0.27]
		adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.173	adj.p.val. = 0.126	adj.p.val. = 0.000	adj.p.val. = 0.159	adj.p.val. = 0.089
Fixed effects		X	X	X	X	X	X

Sources: stacked database of pairwise comparisons.
*= p<.1, **= p<.05, ***= p<.01 based on point-wise p-value.
Adjusted standard errors robust to cluster-heteroskedasticity at the block level.
Adjusted p-values and confidence intervals account for simultaneous inference using the Westfall method.
Joint significance test of null effect using Chi-2 test and p-values are reported at the bottom of the table.

5.3 Sensitivity analysis of the main results: models

5.3.1 Classical Ordinary-Least-Squares (OLS) models

We reproduce our results using classical OLS models instead of stacked regressions. The former are more common to analyse RCT results. However, they can introduce contamination bias in the estimates (Goldsmith-Pickham, 2024).

5.3.1.1 Main effects

Table 5.11: Main outcomes with classical OLS

	Early childcare		Daycare	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Information-only treatment	0.00 (0.02)	-0.02 (0.03)	0.01 (0.03)	-0.01 (0.02)
	[-0.05, 0.04]	[-0.07, 0.03]	[-0.05, 0.06]	[-0.06, 0.04]
Information + support treatment	0.04** (0.02)	0.02 (0.03)	0.08*** (0.02)	0.05** (0.02)
	[0.00, 0.08]	[-0.03, 0.07]	[0.03, 0.13]	[0.01, 0.09]
Num.Obs.	1453	1453	1453	1453
R2	0.345	0.297	0.207	0.103
R2 Adj.	0.304	0.253	0.158	0.047

	Early childcare		*Daycare*	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Mean of DV	0.76	0.56	0.62	0.23

Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust.

5.3.1.2 HTE

Table 5.12: HTE: Migration background (OLS)

	Early childcare		**Daycare**	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Information-only treatment	0.019 (0.035)	-0.008 (0.051)	0.038 (0.040)	-0.003 (0.041)
	[-0.051, 0.089]	[-0.110, 0.093]	[-0.041, 0.117]	[-0.085, 0.079]
NoMigrationBackground	0.090** (0.041)	0.187*** (0.044)	0.021 (0.045)	0.038 (0.037)
	[0.009, 0.172]	[0.099, 0.275]	[-0.067, 0.110]	[-0.037, 0.112]
Information + support	0.095** (0.036)	0.075 (0.051)	0.105** (0.040)	0.057 (0.038)
	[0.023, 0.167]	[-0.026, 0.177]	[0.026, 0.185]	[-0.019, 0.133]
Information-only treatment × NoMigrationBackground	-0.038 (0.044)	-0.013 (0.058)	-0.051 (0.059)	-0.009 (0.060)
	[-0.126, 0.050]	[-0.129, 0.103]	[-0.168, 0.066]	[-0.129, 0.111]
NoMigrationBackground × Information + support	-0.089* (0.046)	-0.086 (0.060)	-0.044 (0.055)	-0.005 (0.050)
	[-0.181, 0.003]	[-0.205, 0.034]	[-0.154, 0.066]	[-0.105, 0.095]
Num.Obs.	1453	1453	1453	1453
R2	0.349	0.319	0.208	0.104
R2 Adj.	0.307	0.275	0.156	0.046
FE: StrataWave	X	X	X	X
Mean of DV	0.76	0.56	0.62	0.23

Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust.

Table 5.12: HTE: Level of knowledge (OLS)

	Early childcare		**Daycare**	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Information-only treatment	0.126 (0.094)	0.029 (0.072)	0.140 (0.100)	-0.014 (0.062)
	[-0.060, 0.313]	[-0.115, 0.172]	[-0.058, 0.338]	[-0.136, 0.109]
High_knowledge	0.183** (0.079)	0.223*** (0.054)	0.048 (0.080)	0.031 (0.046)
	[0.026, 0.341]	[0.115, 0.332]	[-0.111, 0.206]	[-0.060, 0.123]

	Early childcare		*Daycare*	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Information + support	0.285*** (0.089)	0.243*** (0.070)	0.175* (0.098)	0.137** (0.065)
	[0.107, 0.462]	[0.104, 0.382]	[-0.019, 0.369]	[0.008, 0.266]
Information-only treatment × High_knowledge	-0.149 (0.097)	-0.059 (0.071)	-0.146 (0.107)	0.004 (0.066)
	[-0.343, 0.045]	[-0.200, 0.083]	[-0.359, 0.066]	[-0.126, 0.135]
High_knowledge × Information + support	-0.273*** (0.090)	-0.254*** (0.075)	-0.106 (0.107)	-0.095 (0.070)
	[-0.451, -0.094]	[-0.403, -0.104]	[-0.318, 0.107]	[-0.235, 0.045]
Num.Obs.	1453	1453	1453	1453
R2	0.352	0.306	0.209	0.104
R2 Adj.	0.310	0.261	0.158	0.046
FE: StrataWave	X	X	X	X
Mean of DV	0.76	0.56	0.62	0.23

Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust.

Table 5.12: HTE: Temporal orientation (OLS)

	Early childcare		*Daycare*	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Information-only treatment	-0.045* (0.025)	-0.077** (0.032)	-0.023 (0.039)	-0.053* (0.029)
	[-0.096, 0.005]	[-0.141, -0.013]	[-0.101, 0.054]	[-0.111, 0.005]
PresentOrientated	-0.084*** (0.030)	-0.137*** (0.043)	-0.029 (0.045)	-0.072* (0.040)
	[-0.144, -0.024]	[-0.222, -0.052]	[-0.118, 0.060]	[-0.151, 0.007]
Information + support	0.028 (0.024)	0.002 (0.034)	0.082** (0.037)	0.009 (0.031)
	[-0.020, 0.077]	[-0.065, 0.069]	[0.007, 0.156]	[-0.054, 0.071]
Information-only treatment × PresentOrientated	0.099** (0.046)	0.140*** (0.053)	0.073 (0.062)	0.104** (0.044)
	[0.008, 0.189]	[0.035, 0.244]	[-0.051, 0.197]	[0.016, 0.191]
PresentOrientated × Information + support	0.039 (0.043)	0.051 (0.062)	0.001 (0.058)	0.103 (0.062)
	[-0.047, 0.124]	[-0.072, 0.173]	[-0.114, 0.116]	[-0.021, 0.227]
Num.Obs.	1453	1453	1453	1453
R2	0.348	0.305	0.208	0.106
R2 Adj.	0.306	0.260	0.157	0.048
FE: StrataWave	X	X	X	X

	Early childcare		Daycare	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Mean of DV	0.76	0.56	0.62	0.23

Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust.

Table 5.12: HTE: Past use (OLS)

	Early childcare		Daycare	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Information-only treatment	-0.025 (0.034)	-0.034 (0.045)	-0.003 (0.052)	0.024 (0.040)
	[-0.093, 0.043]	[-0.122, 0.055]	[-0.107, 0.101]	[-0.056, 0.104]
UsedECECNever used	0.075 (0.091)	-0.073 (0.078)	0.070 (0.080)	0.049 (0.052)
	[-0.107, 0.256]	[-0.228, 0.082]	[-0.090, 0.230]	[-0.055, 0.152]
Information + support	-0.010 (0.028)	-0.037 (0.045)	0.042 (0.037)	0.067* (0.035)
	[-0.066, 0.046]	[-0.126, 0.052]	[-0.031, 0.116]	[-0.003, 0.138]
Information-only treatment × UsedECECNever used	0.034 (0.043)	0.021 (0.056)	0.019 (0.060)	-0.056 (0.049)
	[-0.052, 0.120]	[-0.091, 0.133]	[-0.100, 0.139]	[-0.154, 0.042]
UsedECECNever used × Information + support	0.093** (0.039)	0.092* (0.054)	0.069 (0.047)	-0.024 (0.043)
	[0.016, 0.169]	[-0.015, 0.199]	[-0.026, 0.163]	[-0.111, 0.062]
Num.Obs.	1453	1453	1453	1453
R2	0.349	0.299	0.209	0.104
R2 Adj.	0.306	0.253	0.158	0.046
FE: StrataWave	X	X	X	X
Mean of DV	0.76	0.56	0.62	0.23

Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust.

Table 5.12: HTE: Migration background (OLS)

	Early childcare		Daycare	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Information-only treatment	0.019 (0.035)	-0.008 (0.051)	0.038 (0.040)	-0.003 (0.041)
	[-0.051, 0.089]	[-0.110, 0.093]	[-0.041, 0.117]	[-0.085, 0.079]
NoMigrationBackground	0.090** (0.041)	0.187*** (0.044)	0.021 (0.045)	0.038 (0.037)
	[0.009, 0.172]	[0.099, 0.275]	[-0.067, 0.110]	[-0.037, 0.112]
Information + support	0.095** (0.036)	0.075 (0.051)	0.105** (0.040)	0.057 (0.038)
	[0.023, 0.167]	[-0.026, 0.177]	[0.026, 0.185]	[-0.019, 0.133]

	Early childcare		Daycare	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Information-only treatment × NoMigrationBackground	-0.038 (0.044)	-0.013 (0.058)	-0.051 (0.059)	-0.009 (0.060)
	[-0.126, 0.050]	[-0.129, 0.103]	[-0.168, 0.066]	[-0.129, 0.111]
NoMigrationBackground × Information + support	-0.089* (0.046)	-0.086 (0.060)	-0.044 (0.055)	-0.005 (0.050)
	[-0.181, 0.003]	[-0.205, 0.034]	[-0.154, 0.066]	[-0.105, 0.095]
Num.Obs.	1453	1453	1453	1453
R2	0.349	0.319	0.208	0.104
R2 Adj.	0.307	0.275	0.156	0.046
FE: StrataWave	X	X	X	X
Mean of DV	0.76	0.56	0.62	0.23

Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust.

Table 5.12: HTE: Level of knowledge (OLS)

	Early childcare		Daycare	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Information-only treatment	0.126 (0.094)	0.029 (0.072)	0.140 (0.100)	-0.014 (0.062)
	[-0.060, 0.313]	[-0.115, 0.172]	[-0.058, 0.338]	[-0.136, 0.109]
High_knowledge	0.183** (0.079)	0.223*** (0.054)	0.048 (0.080)	0.031 (0.046)
	[0.026, 0.341]	[0.115, 0.332]	[-0.111, 0.206]	[-0.060, 0.123]
Information + support	0.285*** (0.089)	0.243*** (0.070)	0.175* (0.098)	0.137** (0.065)
	[0.107, 0.462]	[0.104, 0.382]	[-0.019, 0.369]	[0.008, 0.266]
Information-only treatment × High_knowledge	-0.149 (0.097)	-0.059 (0.071)	-0.146 (0.107)	0.004 (0.066)
	[-0.343, 0.045]	[-0.200, 0.083]	[-0.359, 0.066]	[-0.126, 0.135]
High_knowledge × Information + support	-0.273*** (0.090)	-0.254*** (0.075)	-0.106 (0.107)	-0.095 (0.070)
	[-0.451, -0.094]	[-0.403, -0.104]	[-0.318, 0.107]	[-0.235, 0.045]
Num.Obs.	1453	1453	1453	1453
R2	0.352	0.306	0.209	0.104
R2 Adj.	0.310	0.261	0.158	0.046
FE: StrataWave	X	X	X	X
Mean of DV	0.76	0.56	0.62	0.23

Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust.

Table 5.12: HTE: Temporal orientation (OLS)

	Early childcare		**Daycare**	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Information-only treatment	-0.045* (0.025)	-0.077** (0.032)	-0.023 (0.039)	-0.053* (0.029)
	[-0.096, 0.005]	[-0.141, -0.013]	[-0.101, 0.054]	[-0.111, 0.005]
PresentOrientated	-0.084*** (0.030)	-0.137*** (0.043)	-0.029 (0.045)	-0.072* (0.040)
	[-0.144, -0.024]	[-0.222, -0.052]	[-0.118, 0.060]	[-0.151, 0.007]
Information + support	0.028 (0.024)	0.002 (0.034)	0.082** (0.037)	0.009 (0.031)
	[-0.020, 0.077]	[-0.065, 0.069]	[0.007, 0.156]	[-0.054, 0.071]
Information-only treatment × PresentOrientated	0.099** (0.046)	0.140*** (0.053)	0.073 (0.062)	0.104** (0.044)
	[0.008, 0.189]	[0.035, 0.244]	[-0.051, 0.197]	[0.016, 0.191]
PresentOrientated × Information + support	0.039 (0.043)	0.051 (0.062)	0.001 (0.058)	0.103 (0.062)
	[-0.047, 0.124]	[-0.072, 0.173]	[-0.114, 0.116]	[-0.021, 0.227]
Num.Obs.	1453	1453	1453	1453
R2	0.348	0.305	0.208	0.106
R2 Adj.	0.306	0.260	0.157	0.048
FE: StrataWave	X	X	X	X
Mean of DV	0.76	0.56	0.62	0.23

Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust.

Table 5.12: HTE: Past use (OLS)

	Early childcare		**Daycare**	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Information-only treatment	-0.025 (0.034)	-0.034 (0.045)	-0.003 (0.052)	0.024 (0.040)
	[-0.093, 0.043]	[-0.122, 0.055]	[-0.107, 0.101]	[-0.056, 0.104]
UsedECECNever used	0.075 (0.091)	-0.073 (0.078)	0.070 (0.080)	0.049 (0.052)
	[-0.107, 0.256]	[-0.228, 0.082]	[-0.090, 0.230]	[-0.055, 0.152]
Information + support	-0.010 (0.028)	-0.037 (0.045)	0.042 (0.037)	0.067* (0.035)
	[-0.066, 0.046]	[-0.126, 0.052]	[-0.031, 0.116]	[-0.003, 0.138]
Information-only treatment × UsedECECNever used	0.034 (0.043)	0.021 (0.056)	0.019 (0.060)	-0.056 (0.049)
	[-0.052, 0.120]	[-0.091, 0.133]	[-0.100, 0.139]	[-0.154, 0.042]
UsedECECNever used × Information + support	0.093** (0.039)	0.092* (0.054)	0.069 (0.047)	-0.024 (0.043)

	Early childcare		Daycare	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
	[0.016, 0.169]	[-0.015, 0.199]	[-0.026, 0.163]	[-0.111, 0.062]
Num.Obs.	1453	1453	1453	1453
R2	0.349	0.299	0.209	0.104
R2 Adj.	0.306	0.253	0.158	0.046
FE: StrataWave	X	X	X	X
Mean of DV	0.76	0.56	0.62	0.23

Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust.

5.3.2 Logit models

We reproduce our results using logit models. Note that logit models remove fixed effects with homogeneous outcomes (only 0 or only 1) from the analysis, which reduces power.

5.3.2.1 Main effects

Table 5.13: Replication of the outcomes with logit models

	Early childcare		Daycare	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Information-only treatment	0.96 (0.16)	0.89 (0.14)	1.05 (0.15)	0.94 (0.15)
	[0.69, 1.34]	[0.66, 1.20]	[0.79, 1.38]	[0.69, 1.29]
Information + support treatment	1.44** (0.26)	1.11 (0.17)	1.55*** (0.21)	1.38** (0.18)
	[1.01, 2.05]	[0.82, 1.50]	[1.19, 2.02]	[1.07, 1.78]
Num.Obs.	1381	1374	1437	1268
R2	0.267	0.194	0.151	0.058
R2 Adj.	0.168	0.116	0.065	-0.029
FE: StrataWave	X	X	X	X
Mean of DV	0.76	0.56	0.62	0.23

Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust.

5.3.2.2 HTE

Table 5.14: HTE: SES-Occupation (Logit-Odds Ratios)

	Early childcare		Daycare	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Information-only treatment	1.193 (0.287)	0.872 (0.191)	1.148 (0.231)	0.896 (0.262)

	Early childcare		Daycare	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
	[0.744, 1.913]	[0.567, 1.340]	[0.774, 1.703]	[0.505, 1.589]
HigherThanMeadianISEIMother	5.008*** (1.258)	4.563*** (1.095)	1.950*** (0.460)	1.330 (0.290)
	[3.061, 8.193]	[2.850, 7.303]	[1.228, 3.097]	[0.868, 2.040]
Information + support	2.017*** (0.497)	1.250 (0.276)	1.911*** (0.373)	1.260 (0.272)
	[1.245, 3.269]	[0.810, 1.928]	[1.304, 2.800]	[0.826, 1.923]
Information-only treatment × HigherThanMeadianISEIMother	0.597 (0.245)	1.055 (0.345)	0.803 (0.289)	1.125 (0.395)
	[0.266, 1.336]	[0.555, 2.002]	[0.397, 1.626]	[0.565, 2.238]
HigherThanMeadianISEIMother × Information + support	0.385** (0.175)	0.708 (0.199)	0.632 (0.207)	1.127 (0.331)
	[0.158, 0.938]	[0.409, 1.227]	[0.332, 1.201]	[0.634, 2.004]
Num.Obs.	1358	1347	1413	1243
R2	0.290	0.233	0.157	0.060
R2 Adj.	0.184	0.151	0.066	-0.031
FE: StrataWave	X	X	X	X
Mean of DV	0.76	0.56	0.62	0.23

Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust.

Table 5.14: HTE: SES composite index (Logit-Odds Ratios)

	Early childcare		Daycare	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Information-only treatment	1.140 (0.301)	1.031 (0.232)	1.255 (0.253)	0.986 (0.275)
	[0.680, 1.912]	[0.663, 1.603]	[0.846, 1.862]	[0.571, 1.703]
HigherThanMeadianSESIndex	2.467*** (0.823)	4.412*** (1.161)	1.687** (0.396)	1.273 (0.300)
	[1.282, 4.744]	[2.634, 7.391]	[1.065, 2.672]	[0.803, 2.019]
Information + support	1.835** (0.463)	1.407 (0.320)	1.785*** (0.339)	1.297 (0.280)
	[1.119, 3.009]	[0.901, 2.198]	[1.230, 2.589]	[0.849, 1.980]
Information-only treatment × HigherThanMeadianSESIndex	0.711 (0.319)	0.779 (0.281)	0.705 (0.230)	0.930 (0.308)
	[0.295, 1.714]	[0.385, 1.578]	[0.372, 1.337]	[0.486, 1.779]
HigherThanMeadianSESIndex × Information + support	0.549 (0.214)	0.566* (0.170)	0.749 (0.215)	1.100 (0.343)
	[0.256, 1.177]	[0.314, 1.020]	[0.427, 1.314]	[0.598, 2.025]
Num.Obs.	1381	1374	1437	1268

	Early childcare		Daycare	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
R2	0.275	0.225	0.154	0.060
R2 Adj.	0.171	0.143	0.065	-0.031
FE: StrataWave	X	X	X	X
Mean of DV	0.76	0.56	0.62	0.23

Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust.

Table 5.14: HTE : SES (logit-Odds Ratios)

	Early childcare		Daycare	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Information-only treatment	1.106 (0.297)	1.046 (0.262)	1.132 (0.242)	0.800 (0.274)
	[0.653, 1.874]	[0.641, 1.709]	[0.745, 1.721]	[0.409, 1.565]
Information + support	1.781** (0.476)	1.260 (0.324)	1.631** (0.327)	1.027 (0.235)
	[1.055, 3.007]	[0.761, 2.085]	[1.101, 2.415]	[0.656, 1.607]
Information-only treatment × High_SES	0.759 (0.259)	0.761 (0.241)	0.880 (0.250)	1.266 (0.487)
	[0.389, 1.480]	[0.410, 1.415]	[0.504, 1.536]	[0.595, 2.691]
High_SES × Information + support	0.650 (0.237)	0.806 (0.257)	0.917 (0.249)	1.530 (0.419)
	[0.317, 1.330]	[0.431, 1.507]	[0.539, 1.561]	[0.894, 2.617]
Num.Obs.	1381	1374	1437	1268
R2	0.268	0.195	0.151	0.059
R2 Adj.	0.166	0.114	0.063	-0.030
FE: StrataWave	X	X	X	X
Mean of DV	0.76	0.56	0.62	0.23

Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust.

Table 5.14: HTE: Migration background (Logit-Odds Ratios)

	Early childcare		Daycare	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Information-only treatment	1.146 (0.270)	0.930 (0.253)	1.218 (0.251)	0.965 (0.299)
	[0.722, 1.819]	[0.546, 1.585]	[0.814, 1.824]	[0.526, 1.773]
NoMigrationBackground	1.987** (0.626)	2.864*** (0.714)	1.113 (0.255)	1.291 (0.330)
	[1.072, 3.683]	[1.758, 4.668]	[0.711, 1.744]	[0.783, 2.130]
Information + support	2.007*** (0.524)	1.473 (0.415)	1.762*** (0.379)	1.468 (0.387)

	Early childcare		Daycare	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
	[1.203, 3.348]	[0.849, 2.558]	[1.155, 2.687]	[0.876, 2.462]
Information-only treatment × NoMigrationBackground	0.729 (0.250)	0.917 (0.300)	0.771 (0.232)	0.961 (0.400)
	[0.372, 1.427]	[0.483, 1.741]	[0.427, 1.390]	[0.425, 2.174]
NoMigrationBackground × Information + support	0.532 (0.205)	0.628 (0.218)	0.792 (0.237)	0.917 (0.300)
	[0.250, 1.131]	[0.318, 1.242]	[0.441, 1.423]	[0.483, 1.740]
Num.Obs.	1381	1374	1437	1268
R2	0.273	0.218	0.152	0.060
R2 Adj.	0.169	0.136	0.062	-0.031
FE: StrataWave	X	X	X	X
Mean of DV	0.76	0.56	0.62	0.23

Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust.

Table 5.14: HTE: Level of knowledge (Logit-Odds Ratios)

	Early childcare		Daycare	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Information-only treatment	2.067 (1.171)	1.479 (0.786)	2.195 (1.210)	0.948 (0.689)
	[0.680, 6.277]	[0.522, 4.193]	[0.745, 6.468]	[0.228, 3.938]
High_knowledge	3.022** (1.416)	4.572*** (1.939)	1.307 (0.571)	1.490 (0.823)
	[1.206, 7.571]	[1.991, 10.500]	[0.555, 3.078]	[0.505, 4.396]
Information + support	5.356*** (2.915)	5.258*** (2.631)	2.597* (1.400)	3.588** (2.182)
	[1.843, 15.564]	[1.972, 14.017]	[0.903, 7.468]	[1.089, 11.819]
Information-only treatment × High_knowledge	0.400 (0.242)	0.570 (0.296)	0.441 (0.258)	0.996 (0.739)
	[0.122, 1.308]	[0.206, 1.577]	[0.140, 1.391]	[0.233, 4.262]
High_knowledge × Information + support	0.209*** (0.117)	0.179*** (0.094)	0.561 (0.330)	0.358 (0.224)
	[0.070, 0.627]	[0.064, 0.500]	[0.177, 1.778]	[0.105, 1.222]
Num.Obs.	1381	1374	1437	1268
R2	0.274	0.205	0.153	0.061
R2 Adj.	0.171	0.123	0.064	-0.031
FE: StrataWave	X	X	X	X
Mean of DV	0.76	0.56	0.62	0.23

	Early childcare		Daycare	
	Application	Access	Application	Access

Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust.

Table 5.14: HTE: Temporal orientation (Logit-Odds Ratios)

	Early childcare		Daycare	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Information-only treatment	0.659* (0.149)	0.634** (0.120)	0.887 (0.177)	0.723* (0.132)
	[0.423, 1.028]	[0.437, 0.919]	[0.599, 1.313]	[0.505, 1.034]
PresentOrientated	0.527*** (0.122)	0.459*** (0.111)	0.866 (0.199)	0.599* (0.170)
	[0.334, 0.830]	[0.285, 0.738]	[0.552, 1.358]	[0.344, 1.046]
Information + support	1.337 (0.343)	1.021 (0.218)	1.576** (0.333)	1.056 (0.194)
	[0.809, 2.212]	[0.673, 1.551]	[1.042, 2.385]	[0.736, 1.515]
Information-only treatment × PresentOrientated	2.209** (0.776)	2.227*** (0.655)	1.457 (0.467)	2.010** (0.635)
	[1.110, 4.399]	[1.251, 3.963]	[0.778, 2.731]	[1.082, 3.733]
PresentOrientated × Information + support	1.206 (0.444)	1.309 (0.471)	0.980 (0.308)	2.010* (0.816)
	[0.586, 2.482]	[0.646, 2.652]	[0.529, 1.814]	[0.907, 4.455]
Num.Obs.	1381	1374	1437	1268
R2	0.273	0.203	0.152	0.062
R2 Adj.	0.169	0.122	0.063	-0.029
FE: StrataWave	X	X	X	X
Mean of DV	0.76	0.56	0.62	0.23

Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust.

Table 5.14: HTE: Past early childcare use (Logit-Odds Ratios)

	Early childcare		Daycare	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Information-only treatment	0.780 (0.260)	0.835 (0.202)	0.984 (0.255)	1.139 (0.257)
	[0.405, 1.500]	[0.519, 1.343]	[0.593, 1.634]	[0.732, 1.771]
UsedECECNever used	1.360 (0.819)	0.565 (0.399)	1.619 (0.939)	1.507 (1.305)
	[0.418, 4.427]	[0.141, 2.259]	[0.519, 5.046]	[0.276, 8.231]
Information + support	0.894 (0.258)	0.824 (0.203)	1.243 (0.229)	1.437* (0.283)
	[0.507, 1.574]	[0.508, 1.336]	[0.866, 1.783]	[0.977, 2.113]

	Early childcare		Daycare	
	Application	Access	Application	Access
Information-only treatment × UsedECECNever used	1.362 (0.524)	1.113 (0.353)	1.108 (0.333)	0.689 (0.216)
	[0.641, 2.895]	[0.598, 2.072]	[0.614, 1.998]	[0.373, 1.274]
UsedECECNever used × Information + support	2.165** (0.774)	1.698* (0.521)	1.507 (0.385)	0.930 (0.241)
	[1.074, 4.364]	[0.931, 3.097]	[0.913, 2.487]	[0.560, 1.545]
Num.Obs.	1381	1374	1437	1268
R2	0.272	0.196	0.154	0.059
R2 Adj.	0.168	0.115	0.064	-0.032
FE: StrataWave	X	X	X	X
Mean of DV	0.76	0.56	0.62	0.23

Standard errors are cluster-heteroskedasticity robust.

5.3.3 Lasso estimates

Table 1: Early childcare application - Intention-to-treat estimates

	Information + support vs. Control		*Information + support vs. Information-only*		*Information-only vs. Control*	
	Basic	Post-Lasso	Basic	Post-Lasso	Basic	Post-Lasso
Z	0.044** (0.021)	0.045** (0.020)	0.046** (0.022)	0.025 (0.019)	-0.006 (0.021)	-0.009 (0.020)
	[0.001, 0.086]	[0.006, 0.085]	[0.001, 0.090]	[-0.013, 0.062]	[-0.048, 0.035]	[-0.047, 0.030]
Num.Obs.	987	987	959	959	960	960
R2	0.371	0.390	0.368	0.488	0.354	0.623
R2 Adj.	0.312	0.373	0.307	0.460	0.293	0.571

The dependent variable equals 1 if the household applied for at least one early childcare facility at endline.
Basic specification run OLS on a treatment dummy and block fixed effects.
Post-lasso use coefficients of an OLS regression of the outcome on a treatment dummy, the demeaned covariates and interactions. Covariates were selected by a lasso regression with lambda minimising the RMSE chosen by 10-fold cross-validation.
Cluster-robust standard errors adjusted at the block level in parenthesis; pointwise 95% confidence intervals in brackets.

Early childcare access- Intention-to-treat estimates

	Information + support vs. Control		*Information + support vs. Information-only*		*Information-only vs. Control*	
	Basic	Post-Lasso	Basic	Post-Lasso	Basic	Post-Lasso
Z	0.015 (0.026)	0.015 (0.021)	0.041 (0.028)	0.014 (0.023)	-0.020 (0.027)	-0.016 (0.021)
	[-0.037, 0.068]	[-0.026, 0.057]	[-0.014, 0.096]	[-0.032, 0.060]	[-0.075, 0.034]	[-0.057, 0.025]
Num.Obs.	987	987	959	959	960	960
R2	0.328	0.533	0.299	0.539	0.319	0.603
R2 Adj.	0.265	0.488	0.232	0.485	0.254	0.539

The dependent variable equals 1 if the household accessed early childcare at endline.
Basic specification run OLS on a treatment dummy and block fixed effects.
Post-lasso use coefficients of an OLS regression of the outcome on a treatment dummy, the demeaned covariates and interactions. Covariates were selected by a lasso regression with lambda minimising the RMSE chosen by 10-fold cross-validation.
Cluster-robust standard errors adjusted at the block level in parenthesis; pointwise 95% confidence intervals in brackets.

Daycare application - Intention-to-treat estimates

	Information + support vs. Control		*Information + support vs. Information-only*		*Information-only vs. Control*	
	Basic	Post-Lasso	Basic	Post-Lasso	Basic	Post-Lasso
Z	0.081*** (0.025)	0.081*** (0.024)	0.071** (0.029)	0.074*** (0.028)	0.007 (0.027)	0.029 (0.028)
	[0.030, 0.131]	[0.034, 0.127]	[0.013, 0.130]	[0.020, 0.129]	[-0.047, 0.062]	[-0.026, 0.084]
Num.Obs.	987	987	959	959	960	960
R2	0.229	0.414	0.233	0.379	0.218	0.183
R2 Adj.	0.157	0.363	0.160	0.335	0.144	0.165

The dependent variable equals 1 if the household applied to at least one daycare centre at endline. Basic specification runs OLS on a treatment dummy and block fixed effects. Post-lasso use coefficients of an OLS regression of the outcome on a treatment dummy, the demeaned covariates and interactions. Covariates were selected by a lasso regression with lambda, minimising the RMSE chosen by 10-fold cross-validation. Cluster-robust standard errors adjusted at the block level in parenthesis; pointwise 95% confidence intervals in brackets.

Daycare access - Intention-to-treat estimates

	Information + support vs. Control		*Information + support vs. Information-only*		*Information-only vs. Control*	
	Basic	Post-Lasso	Basic	Post-Lasso	Basic	Post-Lasso
Z	0.050** (0.021)	0.034* (0.018)	0.066** (0.026)	0.047* (0.027)	-0.009 (0.024)	-0.006 (0.024)
	[0.008, 0.092]	[-0.001, 0.069]	[0.015, 0.117]	[-0.005, 0.099]	[-0.057, 0.038]	[-0.052, 0.040]
Num.Obs.	987	987	959	959	960	960
R2	0.117	0.344	0.117	0.180	0.132	0.051
R2 Adj.	0.035	0.286	0.032	0.153	0.049	0.044

The dependent variable equals 1 if the household accessed daycare at endline. Basic specification runs OLS on a treatment dummy and block fixed effects.

Post-lasso uses coefficients of an OLS regression of the outcome on a treatment dummy, the demeaned covariates and interactions. Covariates were selected by a lasso regression with lambda, minimising the RMSE chosen by 10-fold cross-validation. Cluster-robust standard errors adjusted at the block level in parenthesis; pointwise 95% confidence intervals in brackets.

Part 6: Detailed Methods section

Detailed Design

a) Study setting

The French early childcare system

France operates a dual early childhood education and care system that differentiates between early childcare services for children aged 0-3 years and preschool education for those aged 3-6 years. Preschool (*école maternelle*) is free of charge, universal, and mandatory from the age of three, ensuring nearly universal access for children in this age group. In contrast, early childcare services for children under three years comprise diverse facilities. Formal care options, referred to as "early childcare" in this article, encompass regulated childminders *(assistantes maternelles*), collective daycare centres (*crèches*), and private nannies. Local administrations may operate daycare centres -typically municipalities- non-profit organisations, or private enterprises.

Early childcare quality is regarded as high by international standards in this country, yet notable heterogeneity exists between childminders and daycare centres[60,61]. Care provision begins significantly earlier than in many other countries, and evidence concerning the effects of very early care remains mixed within the international literature[9,62]. Analyses examining the effects of early childcare in France are limited. Some correlational studies indicate positive associations between access to daycare before age one and improved language skills by age two[63]. A study employing panel data and variations in birth quarters, along with relative local childcare supply as an instrument for access to daycare at age one, reports substantial positive effects on language proficiency at age two, particularly for children from low-SES backgrounds and those from immigrant households[9]. The study also indicates overall positive effects on motor skills for these subgroups, although some of these effects are non-significant; furthermore, it reveals smaller and negative impacts on behaviour—albeit mostly non-significant for these subgroups—contrasting with correlational studies that demonstrate fewer behavioural difficulties in children who attended early childcare during middle school[24]. These latter discrepancies may reflect that children experience increased behavioural problems in the short term due to the novel situation of being cared for by strangers. However, these effects tend to become positive in the long term compared to children who did not experience formal education and care before school entry[24,61].

Despite France’s relatively high rates of early childcare provision compared to other OECD countries, significant access disparities exist, mainly according to SES and migration background. High-income households are more likely to access early childcare than low-SES households, with 70% of high-income families using early childcare in 2021 compared to only 23% of low-income families[64]. Similarly, the enrolment rate for recently arrived non-EU migrant children aged 0–2 in formal childcare was only 18%, compared to 38% for the general population in 2018[19]. These disparities are further exacerbated by the decentralised and fragmented nature of the childcare system, which varies significantly across municipalities regarding availability, allocation criteria, and access to information.

While formal childcare services are available as early as 2.5 months after birth—coinciding with the end of statutory maternity leave—parents who have worked for at least two years can opt for parental leave. The duration of this leave varies based on the number of children: from six months for the first child to up to forty-eight months from the third child onwards. However, the low flat-rate compensation (approximately 448 EUR, equivalent to

467 USD, per month in 2024) renders this option primarily accessible to low-income households or secondary earners, as it constitutes a substantial income loss for most working parents[65]. Approximately 50% of children under three years of age in 2021 were in parental or informal care[64]. Enrolment rates in early childcare substantially increase between six months and one year. While 17% of children under six months are enrolled in early childcare, this proportion quickly rises to 52% between six months and one year after birth. It then remains relatively constant throughout the following two years[59,65].

Indeed, childcare slots are allocated predominantly before the age of one. Therefore, parents should submit their application very early—preferably during the early stages of pregnancy. Additionally, parents are often required to reapply to keep their position on waiting lists if they do not receive a slot initially. While it is technically possible to get a slot after age one, it is much more difficult because most slots are filled by younger babies, who then stay in the system. The daycare application process is also synchronised with the academic year, which means that a substantial number of slots for infants under one-year-old are allocated in June for enrolment starting in September. This timing significantly limits opportunities for mid-year enrolment and generates disparities in access based on the month of birth[66]. This specific context underscores the necessity of our intervention being as early as during pregnancy.

Due to excess demand relative to supply, facilities often have long waiting lists[67], and in most municipalities, providers distribute the existing spots based on priority rules. These rules are not mandatory and are left to the discretion of the municipalities. Thus, they may or may not be publicly available to parents[59,68]. The law only mandates higher priority for applicants with disabled children, those involved in social and professional integration processes, and families referred by social services (Article L.214-7 of the French Family and Social Action Code). Beyond that, each municipality determines its own priority rules. Although recent national policy guidelines discourage employment status as a priority rule, it is currently unclear to what extent it is still a common practice to prioritise dual-earner households—a criterion historically implemented to support work-family balance. This employment-based prioritisation can systematically disadvantage low-income families, who often face unstable employment situations. The government has introduced financial mechanisms to promote socioeconomic diversity, including the Social Mixity Bonus (*Bonus Mixité Sociale*) and the AVIP certification (*Aide à la Vocation d'Insertion Professionnelle*), which provide additional funding to facilities that enrol higher proportions of low-SES children. However, since facilities maintain considerable autonomy in their selection processes, implementing these diversity-promoting measures may vary substantially across locations.

Local supply-side dynamics

Our study takes place in the Paris metropolitan area and includes 84 municipalities across three provinces, called *Départments* in France (Paris, Val de Marne, and Seine Saint Denis). Despite being geographically close and having similar high population densities, these three provinces differ regarding the availability of early childcare slots and application processes. In Paris, daycare slots are allocated at the district level (*arrondissement*), and the availability of early childcare slots is the highest in the country. In 2021, there were, on average, 80 early childcare slots available per 100 children aged 0-3 years[64]. Val-de-Marne often centralise the application process at the city level, and the availability of early childcare slots is about the same as the national average. In 2021, there were 52.6 slots per 100 children aged 0-3 years in this province, while the national average was 59.1. Importantly, in this region, most applications for public daycare go through a website with no mobile version. Seine-Saint-Denis has one of the country's lowest coverage rates of early childhood services. In 2021, there were, on average, 35 early childcare slots per 100 children aged 0-3 years in this province. Seine Saint Denis primarily organises application processes at the municipality level, with sharp territorial inequalities. In Supplementary Information Section 1, we provide a more detailed description of the early childcare supply in these areas and compare it to national averages.

Notably, the relative proportions of the various childcare options differ in our study compared to other regions in France, particularly rural areas. In 2021, childminders provided an average of 27.3 slots per 100 children aged 0-3 years in France, while daycare centres accounted for 26 slots. However, within the context of our study, daycare centres are the primary providers of formal childcare, thereby justifying our specific focus on this type of service in both the treatment design and analyses. In Paris, where total childcare coverage is the highest, there was an average of 54.5 daycare slots per 100 children aged 0-3 years in 2021, in contrast to only 4.9 slots per 100 children for childminders. Similarly, in Val-de-Marne, daycare centres constitute most of early childcare coverage (30.5 slots per 100 children), with childminders having a more secondary role (13.8 slots per 100 children). In Seine-Saint-Denis, where childcare coverage is the lowest, daycare centres dominate the formal care landscape, offering 22.2 slots per 100 children compared to 12.1 for childminders.

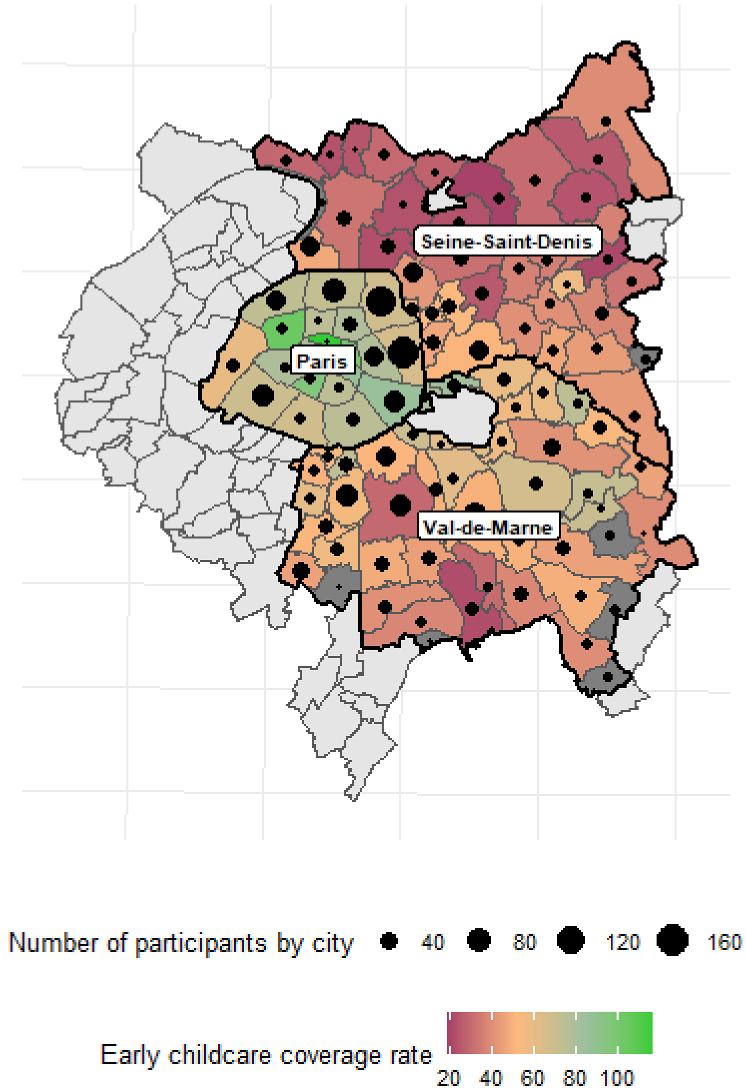
b) Research design

Between September 17th and December 16th, 2022, we contacted pregnant mothers (four to nine months of pregnancy) during their visits to maternity wards of hospitals in the Paris metropolitan area. We administered a baseline questionnaire to collect information on socio-demographic characteristics, knowledge of the French early childcare system, and intentions to use early childcare. 2027 questionnaires were administered, but only 1849 were retained for the study because of inclusion criteria: 103 respondents were undocumented and did not have a partner allowed to stay on the French territory, meaning that they could not access early childcare services even with our support, and 70 declined to provide their phone number. We excluded nine additional participants due to various reasons, such as non-functioning phone numbers.

One year later, between October 16th and December 23rd, 2023, participants were called back to answer the endline questionnaire through assisted telephone interviews. Of the 1849 households that had been randomised, 79% of them completed the Endline survey

(1455 out of 1849). Robustness analyses and balance checks show that selective attrition does not affect the experimental results (see Extended Data Table 10).

Map 1 illustrates the distribution of the endline sample across the Paris metropolitan area.



Map 1: Distribution of the sample across the Paris metropolitan area

c) Intervention design

Neither the information-only nor the information + support treatments were prescriptive about childcare choices. The goal of the intervention was to help households make informed choices on their own, with or without guidance and assistance with formal applications. The treatment arms are as follows:

- ***Information treatment***: *October-December 2022*: this treatment involves two clusters of contents

    - *Information about early childcare types*: information aimed at helping households to identify which type of early childcare fits best with their preferences and constraints. Treated households received a text message linking to a short video presenting information about the availability and characteristics of different early childcare options and how they fit different preferences and needs. In the following days, a second text message linked to a second short video presenting early childcare eligibility criteria and costs and a third video presenting less well-known early childcare options (*halte-garderies*), which may be particularly well-suited to low-SES households (collective but less intensive care, less restrictive criteria of access, easier application procedures and more flexible time schedules).
    - *Information about the application process*: information aimed at understanding the application process. As for the information about early childcare types, this involved sending text messages linking to videos presenting information on the calendar of applications, application procedures, and tips to maximise one's chances of success, such as applying for multiple early childcare options. The content of the first video was tailored to the area in which households live because each area has a specific application process. We also gave households access to a website with resources to help them navigate the application process (e.g. checklists, detailed information on the application process at the city level, contract templates).
    - *Reminders*: Reminders were sent by text messages in the third week of treatment. Around February 2023, households received a personalised reminder to watch the video and our content to maximise applications for the June commission, where most slots are allocated. The content of the message was personalised according to their planned early childcare choices (if and when they were willing to use early childcare) collected at Baseline. We also sent generic reminders to apply shortly before the deadline for the 2023 applications to early childcare (May 2023).
- ***Information + support treatment***: *February-April 2023*: This treatment involved the same intervention as the information-only treatment according to the same timeline, but also one or several phone calls with parents between February and April 2023 to deliver personalised assistance, as well as personalised application reminders. Between February and April, every two weeks, we randomly allocated the household of this treatment arm to one of the seven trained research assistants for personalised assistance. Research assistants then called each household as many times as necessary to reach them. They delivered the personalised administrative support in French, English or Arabic according to a systematic procedure. The first step was to present the various support types we could offer parents. When parents showed interest, we first established a diagnosis of their choices, intentions, and needs after birth. Households were at very different stages of their decision-making, and we adapted the intervention accordingly. When they had not decided yet, we helped them identify the early childcare solution that best fitted their needs, including how

accessible each solution was given their situation and how affordable each solution was through cost simulations. When they had identified the type of early childcare they wanted, we assisted them according to their demands. Some parents needed help identifying the early childcare facilities they could apply to, while others needed us to fill out the application forms with them.

- ***Control group***: Households assigned to the control group received a placebo treatment. Our goal was to maintain some contact with these households to minimise attrition at endline. Placebo messages were also sent to the two intervention groups for the same reason. The placebo messages were about events throughout the year (e.g. welcoming text, winter and summer holidays, new year) and useful tips not affecting the outcomes of interest (e.g. flea markets around Paris). Moreover, the households in the control group also received videos, but not about early childcare. The content of these videos referred to emotions and well-being during pregnancy and other health-related topics.

Sample characteristics

In France, early childcare services welcome children from 3 months to 3 years, and many settings accept registrations long before birth. We thus targeted pregnant women in their fourth through ninth months of pregnancy. We recruited expectant mothers through face-to-face interviews in 8 maternity wards in the Paris metropolitan area. Figure 6 shows the distribution of our endline sample across the Paris region. Our sampling strategy resulted in a low refusal rate, with 99.5% of mothers agreeing to participate in the study. To be eligible, parents needed to be at least 18 years old (99.7% of the interviewed individuals), have at least one partner allowed to stay on French territory (96%), possess a smartphone (98.9%), and demonstrate a basic level of comprehension and communication in French, English, or Arabic (98% of the population in these areas). Even among low-SES and immigrant families, possessing a smartphone and having a basic level of comprehension and communication in French is not particularly restrictive[69]. More than nine low-SES families out of ten have a smartphone, and more than nine immigrant individuals understand French[69,70].

Table 2: Baseline balance by treatment groups

		Assigned Treatment				
Variable	Overall[1]	Information only[1]	Information + support	Control[1]	**p-value**[2]	**q-value**[3]
Single-parent family	8.6% (159)	9.0% (56)	9.3% (57)	7.5% (46)	0.501	0.974
Age of the mother	32.28 (5.62)	32.39 (5.66)	32.11 (5.60)	32.32 (5.61)	0.831	0.974
Number of children					0.834	0.974
0	42% (784)	42% (263)	42% (257)	43% (264)		
1	31% (573)	32% (199)	30% (186)	31% (188)		
The mother is born in France	47% (865)	45% (279)	46% (279)	50% (307)	0.167	0.672
Mother has a post-secondary education (high-SES)	61% (1,120)	60% (376)	61% (371)	61% (373)	0.986	0.974
Household earns less than €2,500 per month	36% (606)	34% (195)	37% (204)	36% (207)	0.658	0.760
Mother is present orientated	47% (861)	43% (268)	49% (297)	48% (296)	0.091*	0.672
Mother wants to work after maternity leaves	89% (1,641)	91% (565)	87% (532)	88% (544)	0.142	0.672
Household has ever used early childcare	40% (745)	40% (247)	40% (242)	42% (256)	0.735	0.672
Mother wants to use early childcare	81% (1,491)	80% (499)	81% (494)	81% (498)	0.914	0.974
Mother lives in Paris	37% (692)	38% (239)	36% (219)	38% (234)	0.631	0.974
Early childcare coverage is high	41% (750)	40% (252)	41% (249)	40% (249)	0.988	0.974
Child is a girl	52% (774)	50% (257)	53% (257)	52% (260)	0.655	0.974

[1]% (n); Mean (SD)

		Assigned Treatment				
Variable	Overall[1]	Information only[1]	Information + support	Control[1]	**p-value**[2]	**q-value**[3]

[2]*p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01
[3]False discovery rate correction for multiple testing

Sources: Baseline database. Proportions and number of observations in parentheses for categorical and dichotomous variables and Pearson's Chi-squared test. We report averages and standard deviations in parentheses for continuous variables and use a Kruskal-Wallis rank sum test. Q-value control for the false discovery rate (FDR) using the Benjamini and Hochberg method.

Variable description

3. a) Main outcomes

The endline survey included our primary outcome variable, a binary variable that takes the value 1 if the household has applied to at least one early childcare facility and 0 otherwise. Our secondary outcome variable is access to early childcare. This variable takes the value 1 if the family has secured a slot in any early childcare facility, indicating that the child is enrolled or about to enrol in a facility. To ensure the reliability of our findings, we asked parents to provide the name(s) and address(es) of the early childcare facilities to which they had applied or in which their child had enrolled. Additionally, we incorporated the questions on early childcare access within a broader questionnaire that covered various aspects of maternal and newborn care unrelated to early childcare, such as breastfeeding, health behaviours during pregnancy, newborn health, and maternal mental health.

3. b) Heterogeneity

All treatment heterogeneity variables were measured during the baseline survey. SES was primarily assessed based on mother's level of education. Our main indicator of SES was a binary variable indicating whether the mother had completed tertiary education. We conducted robustness checks using alternative measures of SES, including: 1) Mother's occupation, coded according to the International Standard Classification of Occupations (ISCO-08) using the 3-digit level and then recoded into a numerical score using the International Socio-Economic Index of Occupational Status (ISEI) with the R software package *occupar*[71,72]. Finally, we constructed a variable that takes the value 1 if the ISEI score of the mother is above the median ISEI score in the sample and 0 otherwise; 2) A composite SES score that takes into account the highest occupation level in the households and the highest education level in the household, using a method similar to the one used by the OECD for the PISA survey[73]. Each mother and father's level of education was converted into equivalent years of education ranging from 0 (no degree) to 17 (Master's degree and above). Mothers' and fathers' occupations were both coded according to the aforementioned procedure.

Migration background was measured by a variable that takes the value 1 if the mother was born outside French territory and 0 otherwise. The baseline level of knowledge was initially coded as a categorical variable with four levels: poor, fair, good or excellent level of knowledge. As pre-registered, we used this initial variable to create a binary variable that takes the value 1 if the family has a poor level of knowledge at baseline and 0 otherwise. The activity level of the mother was also measured using a binary variable, with a value of 1 indicating that she was employed, regardless of whether she was on parental leave for a previous child or a student at the time of the baseline interview, and a value of 0 indicating otherwise. Another binary variable was used to assess previous early childcare access, with a value of 1 indicating that one of the parents had accessed early childcare services in the past for any of their children and a value of 0 indicating otherwise.

Lastly, following the approach of Reimers et al. (2009), temporal orientation was measured by asking mothers to choose between a hypothetical reward of 50€ in three days or 80€ in three months. The resulting variable, present orientation, was coded as 1 if the mother chose the 50€ reward[74].

To measure descriptive norms, we asked participants to report the proportion of their friends and relatives who use early childcare services. To ensure sufficient observations in each category, we combined responses indicating that "all" of their friends and relatives use early childcare with those indicating that "most" of their friends and relatives do so. We then created a dummy variable that takes the value 1 if the household fell into one of these two categories and 0 otherwise. Lastly, to assess trust in early childcare facilities, participants were asked to indicate their level of agreement with the statement, "In general, I trust early childcare facilities to take care of my child," using a five-point scale ranging from "strongly disagree" to "strongly agree." We then recoded this question into a dummy variable that takes the value of 1 if participants answered "agree" or "strongly agree".

Analysis plan

Randomisation protocol

To improve precision and ensure balance on a set of characteristics likely to affect our main outcomes, we used block-random assignment based on the cross-product of i) Education of the mother ("tertiary"/"secondary or lower"), ii) Intention to use early childcare ("no"/"yes but has never used early childcare before"/"yes and already has used early childcare before"), and iii) Supply (early childcare coverage rate higher/lower than the average in the department).

We collected data over three months, during which we defined "waves" as two-week intervals for implementing the assignment procedure. Ultimately, our design comprised six randomisation waves, each containing three assignment conditions across the 12 blocks of each lottery, resulting in 72 block-wave fixed effects, hereinafter referred to as "blocks".

Assignment probabilities

Each household from the baseline sample had a 1/3 probability of being assigned to one of three groups: control, information-only, or information + support. We employed a single-blind experimental design, ensuring no participant was aware of their treatment status or the alternative treatments. Since our analyses compared pairs of assignment conditions (e.g. in*formation-only* vs. *control*), we relied on conditional assignment probabilities that excluded one treatment arm. However, some blocks had a small or odd number of observations, potentially resulting in slight variations in assignment probabilities across groups. To account for this, we followed Hirano et al. (2003) and estimated a probit assignment model on block-fixed effects in subsamples of pairwise comparisons[75]. We then used the predicted probabilities from these models as propensity scores, denoted as p_{ibs}, where *ibs* denotes the household i of block b in the subsample of pairwise comparison s. With these, we define inverse propensity score weights $w_{ibs} = \frac{Z_{ibs}}{p_{ibs}} + \frac{(1-Z_{ibs})}{(1-p_{ibs})}$ and centred assignment $\tilde{Z}_{ibs} = Z_{ibs} - p_{ibs}$ where Z_{ibs} is a dummy that equals 1 when household i of block b has been assigned to the treatment group in subsample s.

Intention to treat, main average effects

Because we have two treatment arms, we followed Goldsmith-Pickham (2024) and used stacked regressions to estimate the average difference between each pair of assignment conditions[76]. Formally, we estimated the following equation using OLS with inverse propensity score weighting for double robustness:

$$Y_{ibs} = \sum_{s}\sum_{b} \alpha_{bs} B_{is} + \sum_{s} \beta_{s} Z_{ibs} + \varepsilon_{ibs}$$

Where Y denotes the outcome of household i of block b in subsample s (information-only vs control; information + support vs control; information-only vs information + support); B_{ibs}denotes block dummies in subsample s, and α_{bs} the associated coefficient in each subsample. Z_{ibs} is a dummy that equals 1 when the household i of block b has been assigned to the treatment group in subsample s. The estimates of β_s correspond to the average intention to treat effect[77]. Following Chaisemartin-Ramirez (2022) and Abadie et al. (2022), we used cluster-heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors adjusted at the block level[78,79]. With many clusters (blocking variables) and few units per cluster, this adjustment is conservative, as shown by Abadie et al. (2022), and inference most likely under-rejects the null.

Robustness checks

As pre-registered, we assessed the robustness of our results using a data-driven selection of potential confounders with post-lasso method, i.e. 1) tuning lasso regressions of the outcome on the full set of demeaned covariates and their interactions using 10-fold cross-validation, 2) running a lasso regression with the cross-validated penalty parameter, 3) collecting covariates with non-zero coefficients, and 4) estimating treatment effect models with these covariates in the right-hand side. For that, we estimated the so-called "pooled regression":

$$Y_{ibs} = \sum_{b} \alpha_{sb} B_{is} + \beta_{s} Z_{ibs} + \bar{X}'\theta_{s} + \varepsilon_{ibs}$$

Where $\bar{X}'$ denotes the transposed matrix of demeaned covariates selected by the lasso method. Lasso selection and estimations were performed separately for each comparison pair, and inference was based on point-wise standard errors clustered at the block level. As the recent work of Negi and Wooldridge (2021) emphasised, adding the variables $\bar{X}$ does not change the probability limit given random assignment[80]. Therefore, pooled regressions are not meant to correct bias or improve consistency but to improve efficiency.

We also replicated our primary analyses using a linear probability model with one dummy for each treatment arm, strata fixed effects, and logistic regressions.

Local average treatment effect of administrative support

Out of the households that were offered support, 52% opted for it on average (See Extended Data Table 2). Thus, assuming that offering support has no effect on outcomes but through the provided support (*exclusion restriction)*, using assignment to the information + support treatment as an instrument for compliance with support can retrieve the Local average treatment effect (LATE) of this treatment[81]. Besides, administrative support was only offered to those assigned to the information + support treatment, making non-compliance one-sided. Therefore, the monotonicity assumption holds, allowing an "average treatment effect on the treated" (ATT) interpretation of the instrumental variable estimand[45,60].

Denoting $D_{ib} = 1(received\ support)$ the compliance status, we estimated the following system of equations using weighted TSLS:

$$Y_{ibs} = \sum_b \gamma_{sb} B_{ib} + \delta_s D_{ib} + \mu_{ibs}$$

$$D_{ib} = \sum_b \eta_{sb} B_{ib} + \pi_s \tilde{Z}_{ib} + \epsilon_{ibs}$$

Where the instrument $\tilde{Z}_{ib}$ is the centred assignment previously defined. The coefficient π_s is the average first-stage effect. As Borusyak et al. (2024) showed, this model retrieved a weighted average of block-specific treatment effects[82]. We used cluster-robust standard errors adjusted at the block level. The coefficient *s* retrieves the ATT under the exclusion restriction.

Average potential outcome of untreated compliers

We estimated the average potential outcomes of untreated compliers using results from Abadie (2003) and Frölich and Melly (2013)[53,83]. Under the same set of hypotheses, the average potential outcome for untreated compliers is identified, and so is any measurable function $g(\cdot)$ of that potential outcome, as long as $g(\cdot)$ has a finite first moment [@FrolichMelly2013a]. Formally:

$$E(g(Y(0))|D = 1) = \frac{\int E(g(Y(0))|\mathbf{B}=b,Z=0)dFB(b) - E(g(Y(0))\times(1-D))}{Pr(D=1)}$$

Thus, to compute the probability that untreated compliers - parents who would have accepted administrative support had it been offered to them - applied to any childcare, we define $g(\cdot)=(1-D_i)Y_i$ and run the same TSLS as before with $(1-D_i)Y_i$ as outcome and $(1-D_i)$ instrumented by $\tilde{Z}_{ib}$ with block fixed-effects.

Conditional average treatment effects

As pre-registered, we conducted subgroup analyses to elucidate the underlying mechanisms and to assess whether different populations respond to the treatment in ways that align with our theoretical framework. We estimated average treatment effects for pre-specified subgroups using the same estimation strategy that was employed in the main models presented above. We obtained conditional average effects by employing fully saturated stacked regressions, which involved interacting all right-hand side variables with subgroup dummy variables[76]. We estimated a first stage for each subgroup in the two-stage least squares models. While these estimations are widely used in the literature, they cannot be interpreted as causal effects due to the non-random manipulation of the subgroups. Rather, they provide valuable insights into potential mechanisms.

Inference and tests

In the main analyses, we jointly estimated the differences in the three pairwise comparisons of treatment arms for each outcome, along with cluster-heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors adjusted at the block level to account for the correlation in potential outcomes within blocks. We adjusted p-values and confidence intervals to account for the Family-Wise Error Rates (FWER) using the Young-Westfall method implemented by the R package *multcomp*[84]. For each outcome, our multiple testing procedure adjusted the p-values and confidence intervals for simultaneous inference on the three comparisons (*information-only* vs*. control, information + support* vs*. control,* and *information-only* vs*. information + support*).

We also ran Chi-2 tests (also called Wald tests) with the null hypothesis that there was no association between treatment assignment and outcomes against at least one significant difference. We reported the test statistics and associated p-values at the bottom of regression tables[85,86]. The Chi-2 is slightly more conservative than the F-test (which converges to the Chi-2 test in large samples).

In the heterogeneous treatment effect analyses, we adjusted p-values and confidence intervals using the same method for simultaneous inference on all conditional treatment effects.

In the balance checks, we did not control for the FWER but for the false discovery rate (FDR) using the Benjamini & Yekutieli method[87].

Pre-registration

This project was pre-registered on the AEA Social Science Registry (RCT ID AEARCTR-0009901; www.socialscienceregistry.org/trials/9901). The initial pre-registration was completed on September 27th, 2022. The detailed analysis plan was uploaded on October

18th, 2023, with further details on the theory of change, hypotheses and predictions, the main dimensions of heterogeneity, and the chosen correction for multiple hypothesis testing.

Deviations from the pre-analysis plan

First, our pre-analysis plan specified examining intervention effects on application behaviours, including the number of applications submitted and their temporal distribution. However, we encountered significant measurement issues during the endline data collection, as parents demonstrated considerable difficulty in accurately recalling their applications' precise timing and quantity. Given these data quality concerns, we followed Lakens (2024) and focused on more reliably measured outcomes to ensure the robustness of our findings[88]. Second, we initially pre-registered mothers' activity as a robustness check for our heterogeneity analyses based on SES. However, in light of the relevance of mothers' activity status in the slot allocation process (see Study Setting in the Methods section), we ultimately conceptualised it as a distinct dimension of heterogeneity. Third, our pre-analysis plan emphasised the necessity for stronger assumptions in instrumental variable estimations when using the control group as the reference group rather than the information-only treatment group. In particular, one must assume that potential compliance with the support does not depend on the information treatment. Nonetheless, due to the absence of any observed effect from the information-only treatment—which renders this additional exclusion restriction more plausible—we chose to mainly concentrate on the comparison between the information + support treatment group and the control group in the main text for the sake of conciseness, which also facilitates interpretation.

Power calculations

We conducted ex-ante power calculations derived from the existing literature and the PowerUp software. Based on these calculations, we determined that a minimum sample size of 1687 families was necessary to achieve a Minimum Detectable Effect Size (MDES) of d = 0.15, with a 5% first-type error rate, 80% statistical power, and a 25% attrition rate, which is what we pre-registered. This MDES corresponded to a 6-percentage point increase in application rates. However, we were able to randomise more participants than initially anticipated (N = 1,849) and experienced a lower attrition rate of 21%. Consequently, we ultimately achieved an average sample size per treatment arm twice as large as that of Hermes et al. (2021), the only comparable experiment in the literature, while achieving similar effect sizes.

Nevertheless, these preliminary power computations did not account for certain design features. Therefore, we conducted more realistic power calculations using estimates derived from the baseline sample and control groups. We estimated the same models using simulated data across 500 iterations (see Supplementary Power Analyses in the next sub-). Using average treatment effects of .02 for the information-only arm and .06 for the information + support arm, our estimated power was slightly below .8 after considering simultaneous inference and within-block cluster effects. It is important to note that these further power computations were rather conservative since they included fewer blocks and exhibited a lower R^2 than the actual sample. Overall, this indicates that our study was adequately powered to detect the effects of our treatments.

5. Supplementary power analyses

5.1 Basic power calculations, preregistered in 2022

- Sample size: 1687 families minimum.

This was based on power calculations using the PowerUp software with the following parameters:

a) minimum detectable effect size for the main effect: 0.15;
b) randomisation procedure as implemented;
c) R2=40%, owing mainly to baseline information on intention to apply for early childcare;
d) T1=33%, T2=33% C=34%;
e) blocks: 9;
f) two-tailed alpha level: 5%;
g) statistical power: 80%;
h) attrition at endline: 25%.

In the original preregistration, we assumed a .15 effect size (*Cohen D*) *i.e.*, $\frac{\beta}{\sigma_{y|X}}$ with "applied to any childcare" as the main outcome. We anticipated 75% rate of application, thus a variance $p(1-p) = 0.1875$ and a sample size of 1687 families with 25% attrition at endline. This would allow us to detect a equivalent minimum treatment effect of $.15 \times SD \approx$ 6pp increase in application rate.

However, we were able to randomise more participants than expected (172 extra households) and experienced a lower attrition rate.

5.2 Power through simulation with realistic parameters

Given our design, we ran extra power simulations to better understand the minimum detectable effect size that we can detect. Computing power ex-post is usually a bad idea, but computing the minimal detectable effect using conditional variance estimates from the control group is still a valid approach. To do so, we simulated a data-generating process that closely mimics our data, with heterogeneous baseline intentions by education and heterogeneous application rates. We used Monte Carlo simulations of data and assignments multiple times to estimate treatment effects, precisely as described in the paper. We used the distribution of estimated treatment effects and simulated "true" treatment effects to calculate power, bias and other metrics.

High-SES households represent 61% of the population, and 87% of them intend to use childcare, while only 71% of low-SES households do. Using data from the control group, we can estimate the conditional means of the outcome for these subgroups:

Table 5.1: Conditional means and standard errors estimated in the control group

	Application
Intend = 0 × Educ2 = High-SES	0.375
	(0.077)
Intend = 0 × Educ2 = Low-SES	0.236
	(0.058)
Intend = 1 × Educ2 = High-SES	0.903
	(0.018)
Intend = 1 × Educ2 = Low-SES	0.742
	(0.038)
R2	0.278
RMSE	0.37
Num.Obs.	494

5.2.1 Simulation parameters

We drew an education variable from Bernoulli trials with probability given by the share of High SES in the sample. The realisation of education generated an intention from a Bernoulli trial with a probability depending on SES status. Lastly, potential outcomes without treatment are generated from Bernoulli trials with probabilities given by the conditional means in the control group and their standard errors. We then generated blocks based on intention and SES status and used the same assignment mechanisms as in the paper. We generated potential outcomes for each treatment, adding a constant treatment effect for simplicity. As an illustration, we reported a single simulation and compared the estimates with those using actual data. Table 7.2 shows that the conditional average outcomes in simulated and actual data are very close. Table 7.3 shows that our models on simulated data closely mimic the actual data.

Table 5.2: Comparison of conditional average outcomes in simulated and actual data

	Simulate d	Observed
Educ2 = 0 × factor(Intend) = 0	0.247	0.243
	(0.034)	(0.035)

	Simulated	Observed
Educ2 = 0 × factor(Intend) = 1	0.747	0.780
	(0.022)	(0.021)
Educ2 = 1 × factor(Intend) = 0	0.365	0.345
	(0.045)	(0.045)
Educ2 = 1 × factor(Intend) = 1	0.901	0.908
	(0.011)	(0.010)
R2	0.274	0.292
RMSE	0.37	0.36
Num.Obs.	1453	1453

Table 5.3: Comparison of average treatment effects estimates between simulated and actual data

	Simulation	Real estimates
Information-only vs. control	0.009	-0.006
	(0.015)	(0.021)
Information + support vs. control	0.044	0.044
	(0.017)	(0.021)
Information + support vs. information only	0.036	0.046
	(0.017)	(0.022)
Control mean	0.743	0.748
	(0.119)	(0.031)
R2	0.315	0.364
RMSE	0.35	0.34
Num.Obs.	2896	2906

Our simulations ran 500 times, with an ATE for information only of 0.02 and an ATE for information plus offer support of 0.06. As a first diagnosis, we plotted the density of each treatment effect estimate from the 500 simulations. The filled densities represent the estimates, while the line represents the distribution of the simulated estimand.

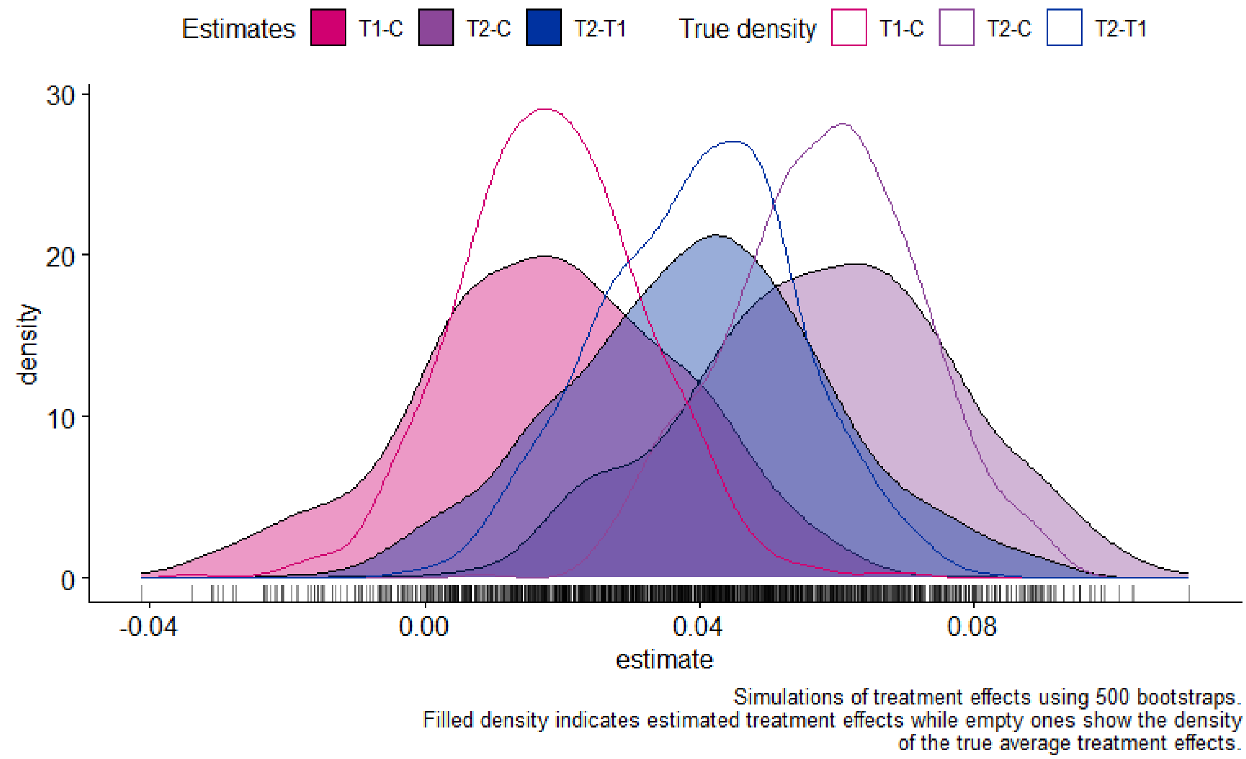


Figure 5.1: Distribution of the density of the simulated treatment effects

These distributions indicated that the estimates were unbiased but with a broader variance than the true distribution. To obtain a more aggregated parameter, we computed power using the share of adjusted p-values below 5%. We also measured the coverage rate using the adjusted confidence intervals.

Table 5.4: Comparison of output of the simulations for each treatment arm (T1: Information-only; T2: Information + Support)

term	bias	rmse	power	coverage
T1-C	-0.0004	0.0144	0.236	0.960
T2-C	-0.0002	0.0145	0.766	0.958
T2-T1	0.0000	0.0145	0.506	0.972

In a constant treatment effect framework and a more straightforward, yet similar, data-generating process, we have 24% power for 2pp in one arm and 76.6% for 6pp in the information + support arm The coverage rate is good, although it tends to be too conservative for comparisons with the information + support arm (which is what we expected and explained in the methodology section). Cluster-robust SE are also too conservative concerning design-based variations. Despite all this, we have a power of approximately 80% for the information + support vs. control comparison with FWER adjustments for a model with a constant ITT. Using data from the baseline and control groups, these power simulations indicate that we may be slightly underpowered but not significantly so. However, these simulations are conservative because they included fewer blocks and that we have higher R^2 in the actual experiment than in these simulations. Therefore, overall, this indicates that our study was reasonably powered to detect the effects of our treatments.